Module One

2 Timothy & the Pastoral Epistles

Preaching the Gospel & Godly Leadership

Manual for Trainers

January 2024

"Do your best to present yourself to God as one approved, a worker who does not need to be ashamed and who correctly handles the word of truth."

2 Timothy 2:15

Introducing BUILD

'Building leaders, building churches, building the kingdom'

Most church leaders in the world today serve the growing churches of the majority world. It is impossible to overstate the significance of these local leaders for the current health and future prospects of the worldwide church, but most have received little or no training. In response, BUILD equips leaders to grow healthy churches. It does so with confidence because Jesus made a promise: "I will build my church" (Matthew 16:18).

BUILD stands for 'Biblical Understanding for In-service Leadership Development' and grew out of the Church of Uganda's (COU) response to its training needs. BUILD is first and foremost a grassroots church leadership training initiative, but it is implemented locally as a training programme. BUILD has its own course and materials, designed and developed in Uganda, which help deliver biblical, theological and practical education. It does so by training trainers to use its curriculum, which also forms the basis for an academic programme for some trainers.

This multiplication model means BUILD can have an extensive impact. This has been recognised and BUILD is used by other churches in similar contexts, particularly but not exclusively in East Africa. A regional BUILD network exists as a result.

The compiling of the BUILD curriculum has primarily been the work of Canon Dr Jem Hovil with Canon Stephen Ssenyonjo Kewaza. But due to the nature of the design and development process the materials capture the input and perspectives of many individuals. The bulk of the work was carried out through ten participatory curriculum development workshops hosted by Uganda Martyrs Seminary, Namugongo from 2009 to 2014. Those brought together participants from Uganda, South Sudan, Rwanda, Tanzania and Kenya, while others from Burundi and Congo contributed later. The workshops were based on earlier research that included 573 survey responses. That lengthy list of voices is representative of the many at the grassroots who continue to use the materials and provide feedback.

Special mention also goes to Mr Daniel Mukiibi Muwanguzi in Uganda who was instrumental in shaping the training there, and seeing it through the accreditation process. Canon Capt Benjamin Kibara Wathituni was key to a similar process in Kenya, and critical in both the ongoing revision and translation of materials. BUILD has grown under the watchful eye of a number of COU Archbishops. These include the Most Reverend Henry Luke Orombi, the COU's seventh Archbishop, who wrote these words to commend and launch the programme:

"The COU is very grateful for the BUILD initiative, which has given us simple, practical and effective tools for equipping our multitude of workers on the ground. Many leaders need training brought to them and on-going encouragement in the midst of the challenges of serving Jesus Christ today. BUILD is meeting those needs with its faithfulness to the truth and teaching of the Bible, and is bringing change to people's lives, churches and communities. All this is in keeping with the COU's core values, such as selfless service. The COU is very proud of this home grown resource, which we have had such a hand in developing. And we now praise God for the way in which he is using BUILD to strengthen and multiply church leaders in our neighbouring countries and beyond. We trust that you will find BUILD as useful and instructive as we do, and may God continue to bless this work and build his church, to the praise and glory of his name."

To echo that, we pray that you will be built up through BUILD and go on to build up many others in their faith and in their faithfulness as leaders in God's Church.

Abbreviations

Old Testament books

Gen	Genesis	Song	Song of Songs
Exod	Exodus	Isa	Isaiah
Lev	Leviticus	Jer	Jeremiah
Num	Numbers	Lam	Lamentations
Deut	Deuteronomy	Ezek	Ezekiel
Josh	Joshua	Dan	Daniel
Judg	Judges	Hos	Hosea
Ruth	Ruth	Joel	Joel
1-2 Sam	1-2 Samuel	Amos	Amos
1-2 Kgs	1-2 Kings	Obad	Obadiah
1-2 Chr	1-2 Chronicles	Jonah	Jonah
Ezra	Ezra	Mic	Micah
Neh	Nehemiah	Nah	Nahum
Esth	Esther	Hab	Habakkuk
Job	Job	Zeph	Zephaniah
Ps/Pss	Psalms	Hag	Haggai
Prov	Proverbs	Zech	Zechariah
Eccl	Ecclesiastes	Mal	Malachi

New Testament books

Matt	Matthew	1-2 Thess	1-2 Thessalonians
Mark	Mark	1-2 Tim	1-2 Timothy
Luke	Luke	Titus	Titus
John	John	Phlm	Philemon
Acts	Acts	Heb	Hebrews
Rom	Romans	Jas	James
1-2 Cor	1-2 Corinthians	1-2 Pet	1-2 Peter
Gal	Galatians	1-2-3 John	1-2-3 John
Eph	Ephesians	Jude	Jude
Phil	Philippians	Rev	Revelation
Col	Colossians		

Other abbreviations

NT	New Testament	v. (vv.)	verse (verses)
OT	Old Testament	ch. (chs)	chapter (chapters)
		p. (pp.)	page (pages)

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Introductory notes for trainers

Who is this manual for? *The manual has been designed to help church leaders strengthen other church leaders. For example, it will help those who lead parishes with a number of local congregations and leaders within them. Or those who have wider responsibility for churches and leaders in their area. In Anglican churches that includes vicars, archdeacons and diocesan education coordinators. And Bishops should be familiar with the programme. If you want help in training others, this manual is for you.*

In what ways is this manual different to the manual for participants? *The main difference is that there are notes for Trainers in italics. These provide additional material, which will help you to use the manual. The notes have been designed to build your training skills over time and through the course of the modules. However, you will need to 'own' the manual by adding your own comments, notes, questions and insights as you prepare and use the material. Finally, because of the additional notes, the page numbers are different. The section numbers and titles remain the same however. Use those section numbers and titles to guide your participants.*

How much time should be given to each learning unit? *The learning achieved is more important than the time allotted. And units may take less time to cover as the module progresses. However, two hours per unit is a good guideline, and six hours per day a good limit if you are able to have a residential or day workshop. However, the modules and their units can be taught in a variety of different ways. For example a day a week; or a day or two a month; or through evening classes. The following timings can guide you as you discuss them with the participants:*

8.00 a.m. - 8.45 a.m.	*Devotions (including preaching practice)*
9.00 a.m. - 11.00 a.m.	*Session I (2 hours, followed by a 30 minute break)*
11.30 a.m. - 1.00 p.m.	*Session II (1½ hours, followed a 1 hour break)*
2.00 p.m. - 3.30 p.m.	*Session IIII (1½ hours, followed by a 30 minute break)*
4.00 p.m. - 5.00 p.m.	*Session IV (1 hour, followed by the evening break)*

The evening break can include time for learners to review the days' units, as well as to look ahead and prepare for the next day. It can also include recreation time.

What Bible passages can be used for the talk in the devotions? *The devotions and the preaching practice they include are an integral part of the training. Some of the following passages, which are not covered directly in the module, can be used: 1 Tim 1:12-17; 1 Tim 4:6-11; 1 Tim 4:11-16; 2 Tim 2:8-10; 2 Tim 2:22-26.*

How should the talk given in the devotions be evaluated? *Encourage discussion of the talk after it has been given, and after any response of prayer or worship that might follow. This must lead to the sort of feedback that will help preachers to grow in their confidence and ability. Use these three questions to guide the process:*

*(1) Was the talk **true** to the Bible passage of Scripture (evaluate the preacher's understanding of the Bible)? (2) Was it **relevant** to the listeners (evaluate their application)? (3) Was it **clear** in its presentation (evaluate their communication)?*

See Unit 13 of Module One for further guidelines.

What responsibilities need to be delegated? *This is important for a successful workshop. Share duties out early on. It is helpful to have someone in charge of the devotions; a timekeeper; a head of welfare; a person to liaise over any catering etc.*

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Unit 1. Introducing BUILD (Reflection)

Overview

Welcome to the first Module of the BUILD course – *2 Timothy & the Pastoral Epistles: Preaching the Gospel & Godly Leadership*. This unit will introduce you to BUILD and help you to catch its vision for *'Building leaders, building churches, building the kingdom'*. It will also help you to understand the BUILD course you are beginning and the BUILD programme you are a part of.

Outline

- BUILD's logo or symbol
- BUILD's aim and anchor verse
- The five words that BUILD stands for
- The five challenges we face as leaders
- BUILD's vision, mission and values
- The structure of a BUILD programme
- Introducing the BUILD course
- Conclusion

Outcomes

By the end of the unit you will be able to

1. Explain the importance of BUILD to another church leader
2. Make an informed commitment to continuing with BUILD learning
3. Recall a verse that expresses what BUILD stands for
4. Demonstrate an awareness of the challenges you face in your ministry
5. List and describe the key features of the BUILD curriculum

Throughout the manual notes for Trainers are in italics. These will help you to facilitate the learning. The Participant Manual does not have these notes and the page numbers are different. Use the section numbers to guide the participants through the manual ("turn with me to section 1.1").

This first unit contains information that the Participants can return to later. It is a reference point and not all of it needs to be covered in detail.

Explain that the first four units are hard work but that they are foundational for all the learning. You can draw a picture or word-picture to illustrate this, for example:

> *"The module is like a journey over a hill that is steep and difficult on one side but has a gentle slope on the far side. The first few units are the steep hill. We need to get up that hill, by pushing our bicycles up it, in order to enjoy the gentle ride down the other side through the remainder of the units."*

Parts of this first unit can be used for sensitisation purposes: to introduce the programme.

1.1 BUILD'S LOGO OR SYMBOL

Welcome the participants and explain the exercise below. Depending on the group size this is usually best done all together, a step at a time, gently welcoming contributions.

A logo is a picture or symbol that communicates what something stands for. BUILD's logo will help us to see what BUILD stands for.

- Look at the BUILD logo below and discuss the questions that follow.

- When you look at the picture above, what things do you see?

  Participants will see different things. Encourage them to share, welcoming their ideas rather than being critical in any way. They will have all sorts of helpful insights. These ideas might include: a cross; a roof or hill the cross is on top of; a simple church or a house; a Bible and a dove or bird; walls and open space; a word at the centre.

- What do you think these mean and what might they tell us about BUILD, and about a good church?

  Guide them to see some of the following:

1. *The cross towers over the church, reminding us that the message of Christ crucified, the gospel, must control and direct its life. BUILD helps us to put God's gospel first.*

2. *The Bible is at the base of the logo, which shows that the Church must be built on the foundation of the Word of God. BUILD encourages us to build God's church on God's word.*

3. *The way in which the Bible has been drawn suggests that the Holy Spirit, pictured as a dove, must be allowed to lead us into the truth of Scripture and to fill our churches and our lives (see for example 2 Tim 1:14). BUILD encourages us to welcome, celebrate and trust God's presence with his people.*

4. *The church is symbolised by a simple building, which reminds us of the importance of believers meeting week by week to encourage one another. BUILD encourages us to help God's people to build one another up.*

5. *That building is open to the world, which reminds us that the Church is on a mission and everything about it must serve Christ's mission to his world. BUILD helps God's people to focus not only on maintenance but on mission.*

6. *The word 'BUILD' stands at the centre. BUILD is all about building God's Church, growing healthy churches. BUILD's anchor or memory verse is Matt 16:18 and it reinforces that. There Jesus says, "I will build my church". We want to join Jesus in building his church; we can be committed because he is.*

7. *All the above depends on good leadership within the Church and churches. Leaders who put the gospel first; who trust and teach the Bible; who rely on God's Holy Spirit; who love the local church and its members; who are mission minded; who are committed to building God's Church hand in hand with Christ their Lord.*

- Think about your church. To what extent does it display these marks or fail to?

  Some of our churches and some aspects of our church life will reflect the ideal:
  - *We seek to live under the message of the cross and see the gospel touching people's lives;*
  - *We aim to build our churches and our lives on the word of God;*
  - *We believe in God's Holy Spirit and depend on him;*
  - *We gather together regularly and are encouraged by that;*
  - *We reach out in love to the world around us and our local communities.*

  However, some of our churches and some aspects of church life do not:
  - *We preach works rather than grace (leaving people trapped and guilty);*
  - *We fail to build our churches on the word of God because we mishandle it;*
  - *We do not believe in the presence of God with us and rely on our own efforts;*
  - *We gather together, but our meetings do not build people up;*
  - *We do not invite others into our church community, and we treat our church as a religious club.*

In looking at BUILD's logo we have seen some of the things that are important to BUILD:

- The centrality of God's gospel;
- The foundation of God's word;
- The presence of God's Holy Spirit;
- The value of God's people;
- The priority of God's mission;
- The importance of godly leaders who encourage all of the above.

1.2 BUILD'S AIM AND ANCHOR VERSE

The word BUILD sums up **the aim of the BUILD programme**, which is:

"To BUILD God's Church through helping to grow and multiply healthy local churches."

Everything else about the programme serves that purpose. Keeping God's true gospel central; building on the foundation of God's word; welcoming the presence of his Holy Spirit; loving God's people; prioritising his mission; training local leaders to facilitate this.

Our ambition to build God's Church is endorsed by **the BUILD anchor verse**, Matthew 16:18. There Jesus says:

> "I will BUILD my church"

That is the key phrase, but learn the whole verse:

> "And I tell you that you are Peter,
> and on this rock I will build my church,
> and the gates of Hades will not overcome it."

Peter was the first disciple to recognise and proclaim that Jesus is the Christ "the Messiah, the Son of the living God" (Matt 18:16). Christ's church is built on the witness of the apostles and the good news that they proclaimed.

God's church will grow because Jesus himself has promised to build it. He will nurture and protect it until it is firm and steadfast. In Module One we will see that those first leaders passed on the baton to others, who passed the message on to others… and it has now reached us (2 Tim 2:2).

In Christ's strength, with the same gospel, and motivated by his promise our job is to make sure that chain of witness and growth continues. We can be confident that Jesus will use us as builders in his great building project.

This means it is a great privilege to serve as a local church worker or church leader, whether as a volunteer, or part-time, or full-time. It is one of the greatest privileges on earth. BUILD will help us to become better builders with Christ and for him.

1.3 THE FIVE WORDS THAT BUILD STANDS FOR

Not only does the name BUILD have a meaning, but each letter in that name begins a word that is important to BUILD. For example, B stands for Biblical.

Those five words have been linked to five verses from 2 Timothy in the presentation below. This will help us to learn about the programme and its values. And 2 Timothy is the first book the BUILD course looks at; these verses will help introduce that book.

- Look at the letters, learn the words they stand for, and find the verses in your Bible and read them out loud.
- Why do you think these verses have been chosen? Explain the link between the word (e.g. Biblical) and the verse (e.g. 2 Tim 3:16-17).
- What do the words and Bible verses tell us about the training of local church leaders and about BUILD?
- Write your answers in the spaces between each letter, word and scripture below.

B is for **Biblical**… 2 Tim 3:16-17 “Scripture...”

The Bible and its gospel must be central to our training if personal development and local church growth is to be genuine.

U is for **Understanding**… 2 Tim 2:15 “Handles...”

Skilful and godly use of the Bible and its gospel are essential for the development and growth of true leaders.

I is for **In-service**… 2 Tim 2:7 “Reflect...”

Learning is best done in the midst of ministry and mission. This means that the training of local church leaders must be done in partnership with their local churches.

L is for **Leadership**… 2 Tim 2:2 “Entrust...”

Leaders who understand the gospel deeply and who then identify and invest in others are essential for healthy churches.

D is for **Development**… 2 Tim 3:14 “Continue...”

Every training course comes to an end, Christian discipleship does not: learning is for life. Our training must equip leaders to be life-long learners.

In summary, the name ‘BUILD’ stands for:

‘Biblical Understanding for In-service Leadership Development’

1.4 THE FIVE CHALLENGES WE FACE AS LEADERS

Following on from the above we can underline the importance of BUILD in terms of five challenges we face in local church leadership:

1. **Biblical** – "All Scripture..."

   The challenge of keeping the Bible central.

2. **Understanding** – "Correctly handles..."

   The challenge of explaining and applying the teaching of the Bible

3. **In-service** – "Reflect..."

   The challenge of remaining committed to mission.

4. **Leadership** – "Entrust..."

   The challenge of a lack of faithful leaders who can train others.

5. **Development** – "Continue..."

   The challenge of persevering with gospel ministry.

- In what ways do the challenges listed above affect you?

- How can we begin to overcome these challenges together?

BUILD aims to meet these challenges and it has a set of resources that we will keep returning to. Those resources include all the above. But they also include BUILD's **vision**, **mission** and **values**, together with the **structure** of every BUILD programme.

1.5 BUILD'S VISION, MISSION AND VALUES

We have already discovered BUILD's **aim**, which is to build God's Church through growing and multiplying healthy local churches.

It is also important for any ministry or project to have a clear **vision**, **mission** and **values**.

We will look at this subject in more detail in Module Four, but it is introduced here along with BUILD's own vision, mission and values.

1.5.1 BUILD's vision

A vision statement paints a picture of the future we hope to see as a result of the work we do in partnership with God and his people.

> "BUILD's vision is to see a multitude of well-equipped leaders at the grassroots building healthy churches across Africa's Great Lakes Region and beyond."

1.5.2 BUILD's mission

In addition to a vision, it is important to have a clear purpose. A mission statement captures how we aim to achieve our vision, as we work with God and his people.

> "BUILD's mission is to enable churches to train their own leaders with a practical understanding of the gospel, Scripture and theology."

1.5.3 BUILD's values

In addition to a vision and mission it is helpful for churches, organisations and projects to have a clear set of values. Values are the foundational principles we hold, which motivate and guide us.

BUILD has five values. They are convictions about Christian learning, which are rooted in the five words BUILD stands for.

1. Biblical – BUILD believes in <u>learning under Scripture</u>

The word 'biblical' (and "Scripture" in 2 Tim 3:16-17) reminds us that our learning must come under the authority of God's word. The Bible and its gospel must be central to our training if personal development and local church growth is to be genuine.

2. Understanding – BUILD believes in <u>learning with integrity</u>

The word 'understanding' (and "handle" in 2 Tim 2:15) reminds us that our learning must be conducted with integrity. Skilful and godly use of the Bible and its gospel are essential for the development and growth of true leaders.

3. In-service – BUILD believes in <u>learning in context</u>

The word 'in-service' (and "reflect" in 2 Tim 2:7) reminds us that learning is best done in the midst of ministry and mission. The training of local church leaders is to be done in partnership with their churches. BUILD was developed locally, which reflects this.

4. Leadership – BUILD believes in <u>learning and leadership</u>

The word 'leadership' (and "entrust" in 2 Tim 2:2) reminds us that leadership and learning belong together. Leaders who understand the gospel deeply and identify and invest in others are essential for healthy churches. This assumes teamwork and learning together.

5. Development – BUILD believes in <u>learning for life</u>

The word 'development' (and "continue" in 2 Tim 3:14) reminds us that while every training course comes to an end, Christian discipleship does not. Learning is for life and so our training must equip leaders to be life-long learners.

1.6 THE STRUCTURE OF A BUILD PROGRAMME

BUILD programmes look different in different places but they all have the same underlying structure. That structure is designed to help BUILD teams deliver training in partnership with churches. We will have a look at that structure now so that you can find out where you belong and how you can learn from and contribute to the programme.

In Module Four we will learn the importance of having clear goals to aim at when we are developing a training project, and of thinking through the activities that will help us to achieve those goals. Once we have described the activities we can identify the resources that are needed and create a schedule that we can follow.

BUILD's main goals and activities are embedded in the programme structure, so look closely for those.

1.6.1 The four-fold structure of BUILD

A BUILD programme has four key elements that work together to deliver training and to build healthy churches. Those key elements can be remembered through these words:

1. **FORCE**
2. **FOUNDATION**
3. **FOCUS**
4. **FRUIT**

Unpacking that:

1. The **FORCE** behind BUILD is **coordination and curriculum**
2. The **FOUNDATION** of BUILD is the **formal training-of-trainers**
3. The **FOCUS** of BUILD is the **non-formal training of local church leaders**
4. The **FRUIT** of BUILD is **informal training in churches and other impacts**

Before explaining those four areas in more detail it is helpful to imagine a BUILD programme as a tree. A healthy tree, with deep roots, a strong trunk and shady branches full of fruit is a good way of thinking about the BUILD programme and its structure.

The one in the picture below might be a mango tree, which provides shade to talk and work in, and fruit for people to enjoy. Your Trainer will explain this picture to you.

Explain the picture in the manual or, better, draw it on a flip-chart or blackboard. Begin by drawing a line a third of the way up to represent the ground level. You can talk about the need for good soil, for churches and leaders who recognise the need for local church leadership development and who will welcome and encourage the programme. That welcome needs to be from top to bottom (the overall leadership of the church) and from bottom to top (those at the grassroots who understand the need for training).

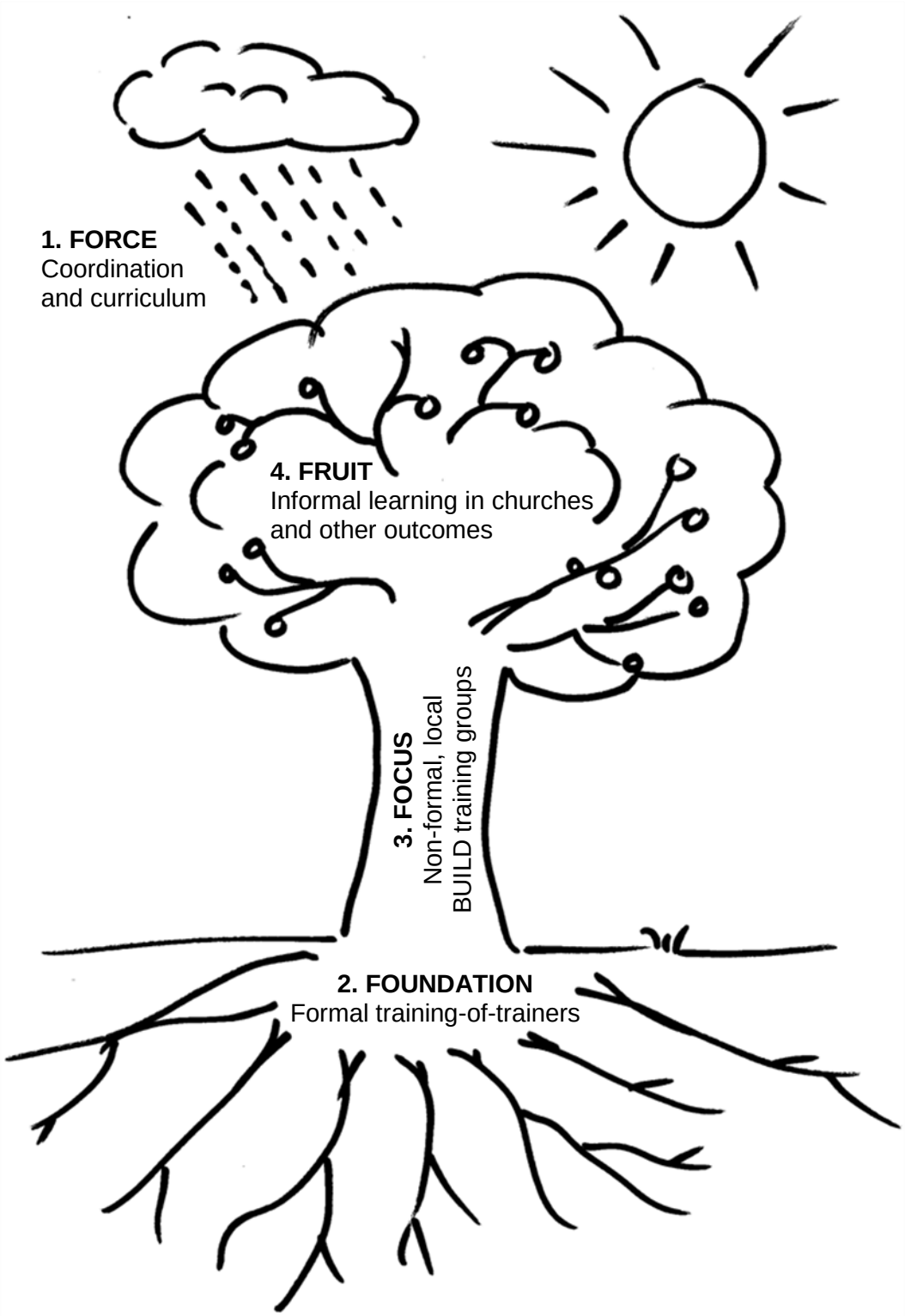
Next, draw the sun, the clouds and the rain at the top of the sheet or board. Explain that without water and light nothing will grow, and that coordination and curriculum development feeds and nourishes the growth of the programme.

Now draw in some strong roots below the soil, and label them to show that the foundation of the programme is the formal Training of Trainers. Talk about how these roots are vital for supporting and strengthening the programme. The roots are unseen, this training is not the main focus of BUILD, but without them local leaders cannot be reached so that the Church can be built up. There are great benefits to this formal training, but they are just that: additional benefits.

Then draw a strong trunk of the tree and explain that the central focus of the programme, its strength and main goal, is the non-formal training of Participants who are the more mature Christians, Lay Workers and others who lead, care for and teach those in local churches: this solid training is what builds the Church and expands the work of BUILD.

Finally, put on the branches and leaves with fruit and tell them that the informal training and other impacts, such as better pastoral care and evangelism and community transformation, is the fruit of the programme.

1.6.2 A BUILD programme pictured as a healthy tree



1.6.3 A BUILD programme and its four components

Now you can see how the four parts of a BUILD programme fit together, you will begin to understand how a BUILD programme helps to grow God's church. A typical programme is described below.

1. The FORCE behind a BUILD programme is…

…its curriculum and coordination

Programme coordination and BUILD's own course are essential for the health of any BUILD programme. These ensure that it is well-managed and well-resourced.

The BUILD course or curriculum is the key resource BUILD puts into the hands of its trainers to help them to equip others. It continues to be developed and translated.

Coordinators, trainers and local trainers coordinate the work in various ways, but the coordinators lead this work of oversight.

2. The FOUNDATION of a BUILD programme is…

…the formal training-of-trainers

BUILD's formal training-of-trainers produces grassroots educators for the local BUILD groups: trainers who can use the BUILD course and its training materials to equip others.

This training-of-trainers is sometimes done in partnership with a college, a training centre, or a network of churches using a formal BUILD-based course.

These trainers begin to train participants in local BUILD groups during the course itself. In the process they are equipped for more effective ministry themselves, an additional benefit of the programme.

3. The FOCUS of a BUILD programme is…

…the non-formal training of local church leaders

Non-formal BUILD training is done in the setting of a local BUILD group. The participants are church leaders at the grassroots: BUILD's target group (mature Christians, lay workers and others who lead within local congregations).

These groups are led by BUILD trainers or local trainers (promising local participants who emerge and help strengthen and multiply these local groups).

This group based learning is at the heart of the programme. Groups follow the BUILD course and any recognition of this non-formal training takes place at the local level.

4. The FRUIT of a BUILD programme is…

…informal training and other impacts

Informal training through relationships is a direct outcome of BUILD, together with healthy local ministry. This includes more effective preaching, teaching and care.

Those who have participated in the non-formal training might use the BUILD materials or they might simply use their Bible-based learning and the principles of BUILD.

Outreach is improved as a result, and lives, churches and communities are transformed as the gospel is proclaimed more effectively through both word and deed.

Look back through the description and discuss it with the Trainer and others in the group. Make sure you understand how the programme works.

You might want to discuss the sort of training have participants have received for ministry (whether formal, non-formal or informal), and what the strengths and weaknesses of that training have been. Explore the gaps in their training and the help they need.

If you are a Participant or Local Trainer you are at the heart of the programme in element 3: The FOCUS of BUILD – Non-formal training of local church leaders.

1.7 INTRODUCING THE BUILD COURSE

A course or curriculum is a pathway for learning. It is a pathway that has been designed to take you from one place to the next: from your current set of attitudes, skills and knowledge to a new level that will help you to build your church.

1.7.1 The BUILD course has 10 modules or manuals

Module One	2 Timothy & the Pastoral Epistles: Preaching the Gospel & Godly Leadership
Module Two	Genesis & the Pentateuch: Knowing God's Story & Leading by Faith
Module Three	Mark & the Gospels: The Servant King & Servant Leadership
Module Four	Nehemiah & the Historical Books: Building God's People & Strategic Leadership
Module Five	Acts & the New Testament Story: The Mission of the Church & Missional Leadership
Module Six	Psalms & Poetry: Worshipping the King & Wholehearted Leadership
Module Seven	Ephesians & the Epistles: God's Plan for the Church & Local Church Leadership
Module Eight	Proverbs & Wisdom: The Fear of the Lord & Practical Leadership
Module Nine	Isaiah & the Prophets: The Sovereign King & Prophetic Leadership
Module Ten	Revelation & Apocalyptic: The Victorious Christ & Leaders that Endure

You have the first of these in your hands.

NOTE: Not all BUILD courses cover all modules.

1.7.2 Each module has four main components

The titles above show that each module has four main components:

1. **A Bible book** as the focus. (2 Timothy in the case of Module One.)

2. **A group of Bible books** the Bible book is linked to. (Module One takes The Pastoral Epistles – 1 and 2 Timothy and Titus). NOTE: In some cases it is a type of writing or theme rather than a group of books.

3. **A theological theme** that is central to the book and to church leadership. ('Preaching the Gospel' is the theme of Module One.)

4. **A leadership issue** that flows from the book, the books, and the theme. ('Godly Leadership' is the big issue for Module One.)

This gives the following summary for Module One:

Bible book	Group of books	Theological theme	Leadership issue
2 Timothy	The Pastoral Epistles	Preaching the Gospel	Godly Leadership

Unit 11 explains how and why the Bible books and groups of books are arranged in the curriculum in the way that they are.

1.7.3 Each module has fifteen learning units and they are of four types

There are fifteen learning units or lessons in each module. And each of those is one of the following four kinds of learning unit:

1. **Tools** for encountering God's word in God's world. These units give you the knowledge and the skills you need for handling the Bible.

2. **Encounters** with God's word in God's world. These units put the tools you have gained to work as you look at passages of Scripture. They will help you to discover the meaning of different passages and to teach them to others.

3. **Reflection** for wisdom. These units help you to think for yourself about different issues, and they equip you to lead others in that process. In other words these units will develop your skills of theological reflection.

4. **Action** as leaders in mission. These units provide practical training in a number of areas such as preaching, pastoral care and leadership, which are essential for local church leaders.

1.7.4 Contents of Module One and the BUILD curriculum as a whole

The four types of learning unit feature in the Contents page of Module One.

Turn back to that and take a look at the contents of the module.

Your Trainer can guide you through an overview of the 15 units so that you understand the links between them.

All 150 units of the BUILD curriculum can be found in the contents at the beginning and end of this module, so that you can see everything that is covered and how it all fits together.

When introducing and teaching modules it is important and helpful to note the links between the individual units as well as the connections to the Bible book, corpus, theme and leadership issue of the module. This is a real aid to learning. For example in the case of Module One the following introductions and connections can be made:

Unit 1. Introducing BUILD (Reflection). *The first unit explains the nature and importance of the programme and introduces the content. Trainers can help participants grasp the way the module works by taking them through the flow of the module.*

Unit 2. How to hear God's voice today (Tools). *This unit explains how we can understand the Bible and hear God's voice today. It introduces and illustrates four main steps we can use to help us to understand any book of the Bible.*

Unit 3. Understanding 1 and 2 Timothy (Tools). *This unit develops the four steps of understanding the Bible and applies them to 1 Timothy. This leads on to an introduction to 2 Timothy too, through comparing and contrasting it with 1 Timothy.*

Unit 4. How to encounter a passage of the Bible (Tools). *This unit builds on Unit 3 because getting to know a Bible book is the first step in understanding a passage within it. It helps participants to learn how to discover the original message of a passage of Scripture. A later unit, unit 13, will help learners to preach or teach that message today.*

Unit 5. Encountering 2 Timothy 1:8-12 (Encounter). *Every module has a number of hands-on-studies so that Participants can be coached in their Bible handling skills. This study immediately applies the lessons of Unit 3.*

Unit 6. What is the gospel? (Reflection). *2 Timothy 1:8-12 is all about the nature of the gospel and so this unit of theological reflection considers the message of the gospel. But we also need to learn to share that message, which is why we then turn to…*

Unit 7. Sharing the gospel (Action). *This unit continues to focus on a critical issue for leadership and mission and teaches skills for our evangelism, and evangelistic aspects of our ministries.*

Unit 8. Encountering 2 Timothy 2:1-7 (Encounter). *As suggested above, this unit is a hands-on study of a passage that focuses on the ministry of the gospel – the work of evangelism.*

Unit 9. Gospel centred ministry (Reflection). *This unit builds on our study of 2 Timothy 2:1-7, which ends with Paul's words: "Reflect on what I am saying." This gives an opportunity to introduce the discipline of theological reflection and to apply it to the issues the passage raises: the way in which the gospel shapes the Christian life and ministry.*

Unit 10. Encountering 2 Timothy 3:14-17 (Encounter). *The true gospel is the Biblical gospel, the message of God's rescue that the Bible teaches. The Bible is central to the*

work of ministry and the passage that this unit tackles is on that central place that the Bible must occupy.

Unit 11. The Bible and biblical ministry (Reflection). *This unit of theological reflection explains and applies the nature and importance of the Bible. It leads into action at the end by applying the learning to our own, personal, Bible study and prayer.*

Unit 12. Encountering 2 Timothy 4:1-5 (Encounter). *Preaching and teaching is fundamental and foundational for ministry. This hands-on-study grapples with a text that focuses on this important discipline.*

Unit 13. How to preach a passage of the Bible (Action). *This unit completes the movement from passage to preaching. Unit 4 taught us how to understand the meaning of a Bible passage in its original context. This unit picks that up and teaches us how to communicate that message to a congregation or other group today. The two units combine to give a model of preparation and preaching that is used throughout the course.*

Unit 14. Encountering Titus 1:5-9 (Encounter). *This unit provides the learners with the opportunity to look at a passage from the remaining book of the Pastoral Epistles, Titus. It is not just an appetiser but an important passage in itself that leads into the final unit.*

Unit 15. Leaders of integrity (Action). *The module closes with a major emphasis of the pastorals, and one that is central to the BUILD programme.*

1.8 CONCLUSION

1.8.1 The word 'BUILD' in the New Testament

We will end the unit in our Bibles. We have looked at Matthew 16:18. Spend time together discussing these two questions.

- Can you think of other verses in the New Testament where the word 'BUILD' or the idea of building is used when talking about the life of the church?

  Some of the following, or other verses, may come up:
  - *"the word of his grace, which can build you up" (Acts 20:32)*
  - *"to build him up" (Rom 15:2)*
  - *"excel in gifts that build up the church" (1 Cor 14:12)*
  - *"build each other up" (1 Thess 5:11)*
  - *"build yourselves up in your most holy faith" (Jude 1:20)*

- What do these verses teach us and why is the word 'build' so important in the New Testament?

  They teach us that the idea of building ourselves and one another up is central to the idea of church and church leadership in the New Testament. The gospel, "the word of his grace" (Acts 20:32) is the foundation for that and as leaders we need to learn to "excel in gifts that build up the church" (1 Cor 14:12).

1.8.2 A commitment to learning

Don't worry if you haven't fully grasped all of this material. The rest of the module will build on this foundation. It will make more sense as we move through the training together. It took Jesus time to take his disciples and to build them into leaders.

- Make a commitment, together, to grow as leaders through committing to the BUILD programme, and close in prayer.

As you pray remember that important phrase and promise in the BUILD verse, "I will build my church" (Matt 16:18). Thank the Lord Jesus that he has promised to build his church, that he will nurture and protect it until it is firm and steadfast forever, and that he does so in partnership with us.

Unit 2. How to hear God's voice today (Tools)

Overview

This unit explores the topic of how God speaks today. It explains how we can understand the Bible and hear God's voice. In doing so it reveals that a proper understanding of the Bible is very important for church workers. It goes on to introduce and illustrate the four main steps we will use in understanding any book of the Bible.

Outline

- Introduction: The importance of understanding the Bible
- Romans 15:4 and hearing God's voice today
- The challenge of understanding the Bible
- The process of understanding the Bible
- Illustrating the four steps of understanding the Bible
- Conclusion

Outcomes

By the end of the unit you will be able to

1. Explain how someone can recognise God's voice today
2. Illustrate why God's speech in the past still speaks today
3. Point out the challenges we face in understanding the Bible
4. State the four steps for understanding a book of the Bible
5. Apply the four steps to a Bible verse

2.1 THE IMPORTANCE OF UNDERSTANDING THE BIBLE

In Unit 1 we learnt that in the word BUILD, the letter B stands for Biblical. We recognised the importance of keeping the Bible central in life and ministry. The letter U stands for Understanding. We discussed the challenge of using the Bible well.

That discussion was based on 2 Timothy 2:15: "Do your best to present yourself to God as one approved, a worker who does not need to be ashamed and who correctly handles the word of truth."

But why is it so important to understand the Bible? We will begin to answer that by asking a different question: How does God speak today?

Carry out these exercises in a group or groups:

- List the ways in which you and others think that God speaks to people today.

Take feedback from the participants and make a list of the ways in which they think God speaks today. They might mention "the Bible," "other Christians," "experiences," "dreams," "prophecy," "prayer," "in worship," "through the world around us," etc. Resist commenting on these or ranking them at this point.

- Arrange the 'sources' in your list in order of importance by numbering them.

Allow the participants to share their comments on these. It will become clear that some of these sources are more trustworthy than others. You can ask about the sorts of things different local Christian preachers say about their own preaching.

2.2 ROMANS 15:4 AND HEARING GOD'S VOICE TODAY

Read Romans 15:4 out loud together:

> "For everything that was written in the past was written to teach us, so that through the endurance taught in the Scriptures and the encouragement they provide we might have hope."

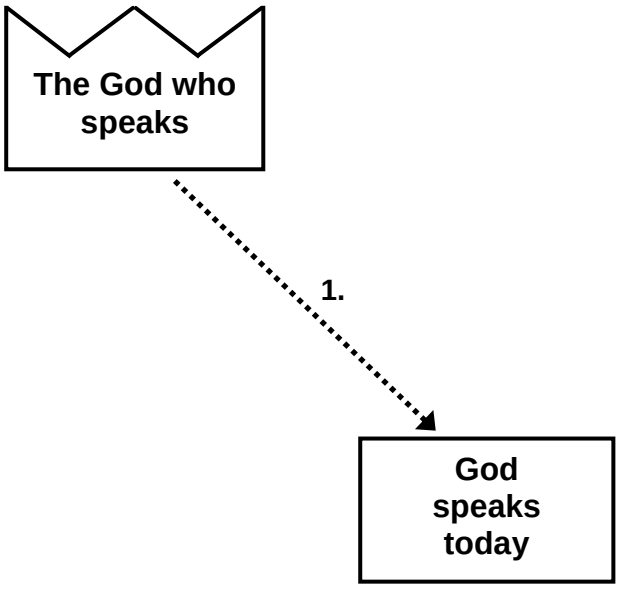
- What do you think this verse tells us about God and how he speaks today?

  Discuss the initial feedback briefly, explaining that we will now explore that question in some detail.

The principles Romans 15:4 contains are illustrated below. The shape at the top is a crown: a symbol for God's Kingship, which will be used elsewhere in the BUILD course.

2.2.1 The God who speaks today

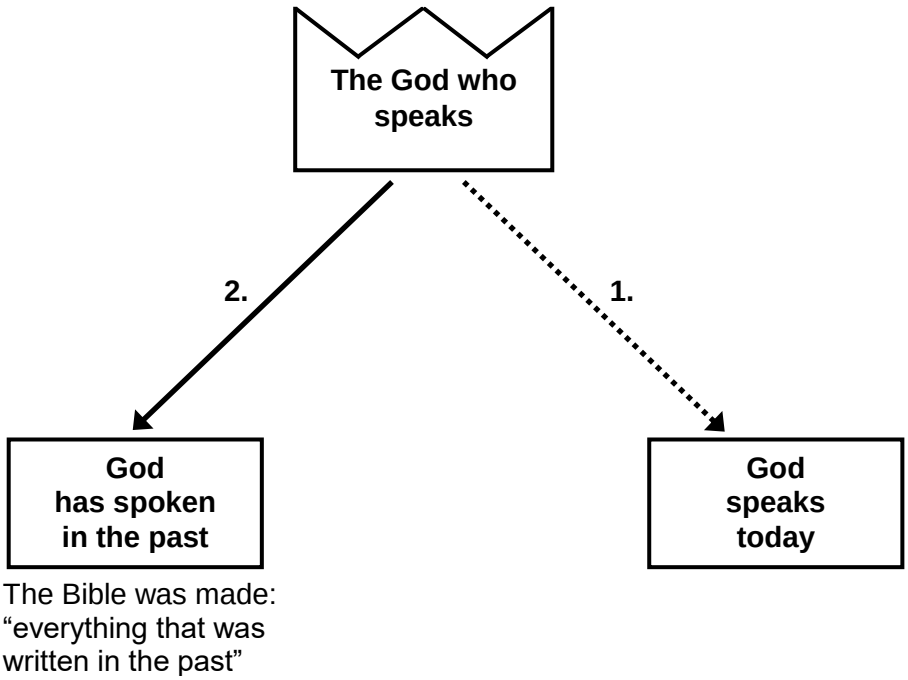
God is a speaking God (Genesis 1:3) and we have begun to discuss the claims that he continues to speak in a range of different ways today. This is indicated by the broken line (1.) in the diagram below.



But how can we recognise God's voice? How can we be confident that we have heard his word? How can we discern between the spirits and the Spirit, between the "word of truth" and "godless chatter" (2 Tim 2:15-16)?

2.2.2 God has spoken in the past

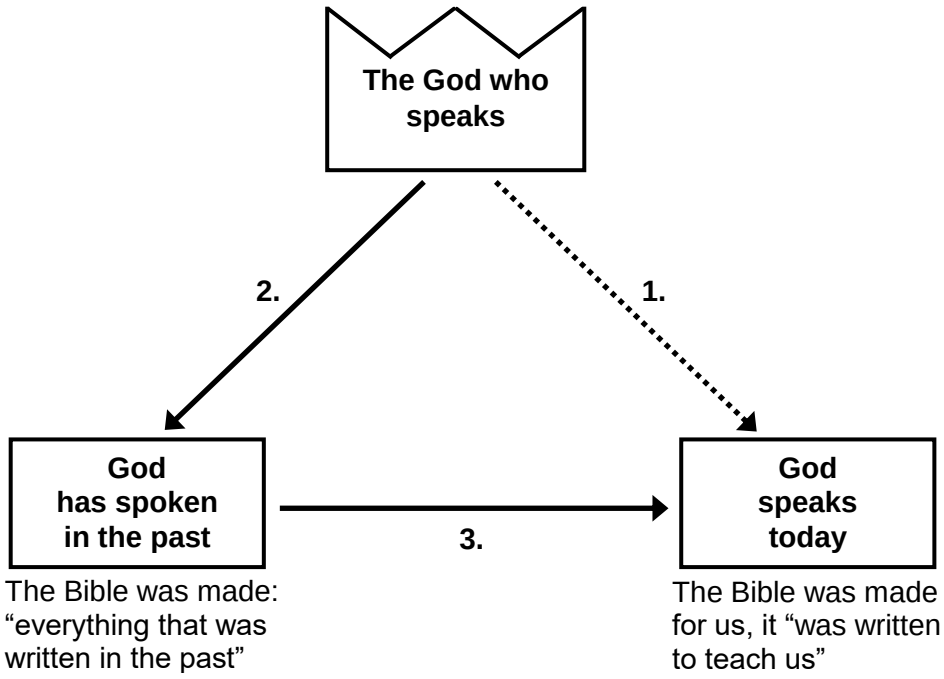
God spoke to his people in the past and those words have been captured in the Bible. When Paul says "everything that was written in the past..." in Rom 15:4 he is thinking of the Old Testament Scriptures because he has just quoted from Psalm 69:9 in verse 3. This solid truth that God has spoken in the past through the Scriptures is indicated by the solid line (2.) in the diagram.



But that leaves a gap between God's words in the past and our lives today. How does God bridge that gap and speak into our lives today?

2.2.3 God speaks today through what he has said in the past

Paul assures us that "everything that was written in the past was written to teach *us*". God speaks to us today through what he has spoken in the past. God teaches us as his written word is taught to us: as it is explained and applied with the help of God's Holy Spirit, as indicated by the solid line (3.) below.



2.2.4 The message of Romans 15:4 in summary

As Paul considers the needs of the church in Rome, he is aware that the members of the church must bear with and encourage one another (Rom 15:1-2). As he teaches them he then turns to the example of Jesus and quotes from the Hebrew Scriptures:

> "For even Christ did not please himself but, as it is written: "The insults of those who insult you have fallen on me."" (Rom 15:3 quoting Ps 69:9).

In the next verse Paul explains an important principle that flows from that: God speaks today through the Scriptures he gave in the past (Rom 15:4).

Church leaders must understand, teach and apply that word today in the light of Jesus and his gospel, in the same way that Paul explained and applied Psalm 69 to the believers in Rome. And we too must exercise endurance as we wrestle with the Scriptures, we need the encouragement they give and the hope that they bring.

When Paul used the phrase "everything that was written in the past" he was talking about the Old Testament Scriptures. The New Testament has been added to those writings to give us the complete Christian Bible. For us today, the whole Bible "was written in the past" and "was written to teach us".

This means that if we are to hear God's voice today, understanding the Bible is essential. The Bible is God's way of communicating with his people today, and it is the way in which all other words and claims are to be weighed and evaluated. The more we hear God's word and absorb it, the more naturally we will recognise God's voice and discern truth from error, just as you recognise a friend's voice on the phone after years of speaking with them face-to-face.

2.3 THE CHALLENGE OF UNDERSTANDING THE BIBLE

We have seen that in order to hear God's voice today we need to establish what he has said in the past. This is the principle of **discovering** what God has said to his people in the past before **declaring** it to his people today.

- Can you think of some of the ways in which this makes the job of understanding the Bible easier?

First, it makes our job easier because we do not have to 'invent' a message. There is no magic involved. Our job is simply to state, explain and apply the point of a text to people today. Whether they are open to hearing God's voice and to responding is another matter. We can pray that they will be, but it is out of our hands.

Second, it makes our job easier because there are similarities or connections between the situation of God's people in the past and our situation today. For example in Romans 15 Paul is encouraging the Christians to accept one another despite differences of opinion on secondary matters. Christians today also need to learn to accept one another despite differences of opinion on secondary matters. Even if in some cases those secondary matters may be a little different today, the principle applies.

- Can you think of some of the ways in which that makes the job of understanding the Bible harder?

The 'distance', the 'gap', between us today and the original hearers in the past makes our job harder – the message was originally written for one context and we need to proclaim it in a new context. We need to work hard and pray hard so that this gap can be bridged.

For example, we can see in Rom 14 that the differences of opinion then were down to differences in practice and culture between Jewish and Gentile Christians. Our differences today may be due to different cultural groups or practices in our churches.

- In what ways is the situation of God's people in the past similar to our situation today?

We too have God's Word and Spirit; we too struggle with sin; the challenges we face may be similar etc

- In what ways is the situation of God's people in the past different to our situation today?

Differences of culture, language, history, place, point in the Bible's story, type of writing.

2.4 THE PROCESS OF UNDERSTANDING THE BIBLE

We can use a step-by-step approach to understand any book of the Bible. Here are four steps to follow that we will then apply to the Pastoral Epistles.

FOUR STEPS FOR UNDERSTANDING A BIBLE BOOK

Step 1: Establish the original CONTEXT of the book

Step 2: Discover the CONTENT of the book

Step 3: Make the CONNECTIONS with our CONTEXT

Step 4: Teach the CONTENT of the book today

2.4.1 Establish the original CONTEXT of the book (Step 1)

In order to understand any spoken or written communication it is important to understand the context or situation in which it was given. What was going on then? The word 'fire' can mean different things in different settings: a source of heat ('a fire'), a command to shoot ('fire!'), or an order to get rid of someone ('fire him').

In the same way, the context is important for understanding a Bible book. We need to begin the process of understanding the Bible by establishing the situation when the Bible book was written, its 'old home'. At the same time we need to keep in mind our own context, the 'new home' in which God's voice will be heard to make the links.

The diagram below illustrates the gap between the situation in the past (on the left) and our situation today (on the right). That gap is created by differences in culture, language, history and geography, and by where the Bible book sits in the story of salvation.

NOTE: The diagram is very simple. But imagine the gap is like a river to cross, with the world of the Bible on one side and today's world on the other side. As church leaders we need to have one foot in the world of the Bible and one foot in the world today. We need to understand both sides of the river and to build a bridge.

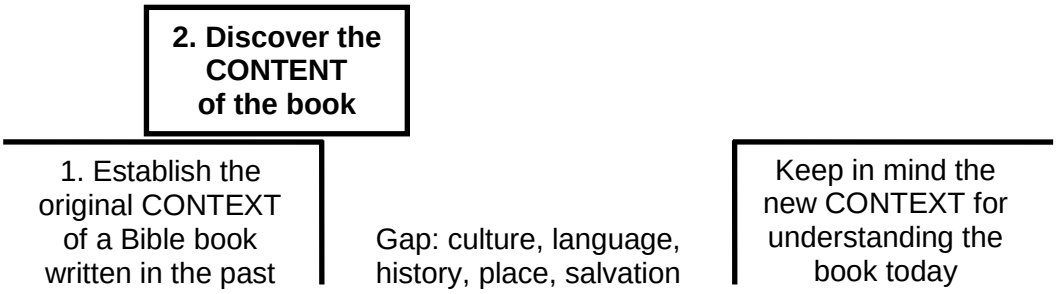
When you look at the diagram below you can imagine the 'content' box in Step 2 as the container of a lorry, with wheels and a driver's cabin on the front of it. Or you can draw those on. If your trainer is drawing this on a blackboard or whiteboard or flipchart they too might picture this as a lorry crossing a bridge over a river.

1. Establish the original CONTEXT of a Bible book written in the past	Gap: culture, language, history, place, salvation	Keep in mind the new CONTEXT for understanding the book today

2.4.2 Discover the CONTENT of the book (Step 2)

In the light of that context it is then important to discover the **CONTENT** of the book. What is the main point that the author is making to his original hearers? What main

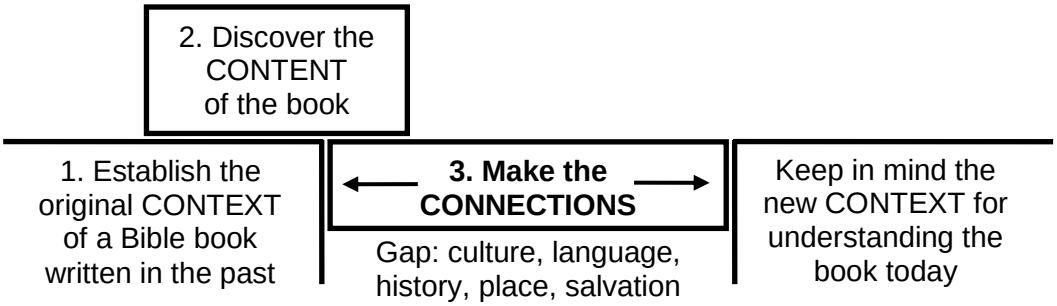
message did the book carry in its original setting, its 'old home'? What important themes did it communicate?



2.4.3 Make the CONNECTIONS with our CONTEXT (Step 3)

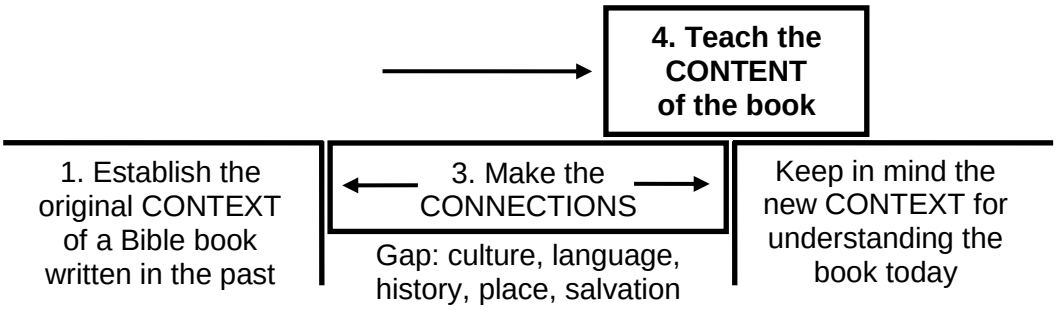
Once we have begun to discover the content of the book we need to **make the CONNECTIONS** with our situation today. This helps to fill the gap and creates a bridge to carry the content of the book over to us today, its 'new home'.

We have focussed on the *difference* between then and now, that create the gap. But we can also think about the ways in which our situation is *similar* to their situation, and how the content we are discovering speaks into our lives. For example, it might be that we are facing similar struggles and sins to our sisters and brothers in the past.



2.4.4 Teach the CONTENT of the book today (Step 4)

Finally we can teach the relevant **CONTENT** of the book today, making the connections between then and now.



2.5 ILLUSTRATING THE FOUR STEPS OF UNDERSTANDING THE BIBLE

We will apply these four steps to a book of the Bible in the next unit, where we will look at 1 Timothy together. (And we will also take a look at 2 Timothy by comparing and contrasting it with 1 Timothy.)

But we can illustrate these steps by using a single phrase in the Bible. In 2 Timothy 4:1 Paul says to Timothy, "I give you this charge".

Step1. Establishing the original CONTEXT

"I give you this charge". Think for a moment. The word 'charge' can mean a number of things, depending on the context or situation in which it is used.

- What do you think Paul meant by that word, 'charge'; which of these is the right answer?

A. An explosive device
B. A bill or invoice to be paid
C. A duty to be carried out

You will almost certainly know that C is the correct answer. Read the words that provide the context for the phrase - "I give you this charge" – which are given below to confirm your answer.

> "In the presence of God and of Christ Jesus, who will judge the living and the dead, and in view of his appearing and his kingdom, I give you this charge: preach the word…" (2 Tim 4:1-2a).

The charge Paul gives Timothy is the duty to proclaim the message of the gospel. The context of the words have helped us to understand the meaning of the words.

Step 2. Discovering the CONTENT

We have already begun to discover the content as we have looked at the context. Timothy has been given a command to obey: it is to proclaim the message of the gospel.

That command is given great weight by the fact that Christ Jesus is present with us now and will judge all people, ourselves included, and will return and establish his unshakeable kingdom in the future.

Step 3: Making the CONNECTIONS

All believers are to continue to witness to Christ Jesus today, to point to him. But those who are called to be leaders in God's church have a special responsibility to proclaim the gospel, a responsibility that continues today. The need continues and so a simple bridge has been built.

Step 4: Teaching the CONTENT

We therefore need to find ways of raising the issue of ongoing witness to Jesus with believers and teaching them about their own responsibility today. Leaders have a particular responsibility in this.

2.6 CONCLUSION

We are following in Timothy's footsteps. He was called to be "a worker who does not need to be ashamed and who correctly handles the word of truth" (2 Tim 2:15).

Correctly handling the message of the gospel means first grasping the importance of understanding the Bible. It is important because God has chosen to speak to his people today through the Scriptures he gave in the past.

Look again at Romans 15:4. Use it to pray together, that we and all God's people might be able to learn and benefit from the endurance and encouragement of the Scriptures, and have gospel hope.

> "For everything that was written in the past was written to teach us, so that through the endurance taught in the Scriptures and the encouragement they provide we might have hope." (Rom 15:4)

We will now apply this learning to 1 and 2 Timothy.

Unit 3. Understanding 1 and 2 Timothy (Tools)

Overview

This unit develops the four steps of understanding the Bible so that they can be applied to any Bible book. The guidelines are developed and explained as they are applied to 1 Timothy. This not only gives us tools for understanding any book of the Bible, it also helps us to understand 1 Timothy. This is foundational for the module's biblical learning. Towards the end of the unit we will look briefly at 2 Timothy by comparing and contrasting it with 1 Timothy.

Outline

- Introduction: Developing the four steps
- Establishing the original CONTEXT of 1 Timothy
- Discovering the CONTENT of 1 Timothy
- Making the CONNECTIONS with our CONTEXT
- Teaching the CONTENT of 1 Timothy today
- Understanding 2 Timothy
- Conclusion

Outcomes

By the end of the unit you will be able to

1. Present the small, practical steps for understanding a book of the Bible
2. Use a set of questions to discover the setting of a Bible book
3. List the main themes of a Bible book
4. Summarise the situation and message of 1 Timothy
5. Compare and contrast 1 and 2 Timothy

This is the last unit of the day. There has been a great deal of new material and the group is new too. Remind the learners that, "The module is like a journey over a hill that is steep and difficult on one side but has a gentle slope on the far side. The first few units are the steep hill. We need to get up that hill, by pushing our bicycles up it, in order to enjoy the gentle ride down the other side through the remainder of the units."

3.1 INTRODUCTION: DEVELOPING THE FOUR STEPS

In Unit 2 we learnt four steps for understanding a Bible book.

FOUR STEPS FOR UNDERSTANDING A BIBLE BOOK

Step 1: Establish the original CONTEXT of the book

Step 2: Discover the CONTENT of the book

Step 3: Make the CONNECTIONS with our CONTEXT

Step 4: Teach the CONTENT of the book today

These four steps can be unpacked and then used to help us understand any Bible book in detail. This will give us a tool that we will use throughout the curriculum.

FOUR STEPS FOR UNDERSTANDING A BIBLE BOOK
Broken down into smaller steps

Step 1: Establish the original CONTEXT of the book
- Where does the book fit in the Bible's **story**?
- What **situation** was the book was written for?
- What **style** of writing was it written in?

Step 2: Discover the CONTENT of the book
- What is the **structure** of the book?
- What are the main **themes** of the book?
- What is the **message** of the book?
- What is the **purpose** of the book?

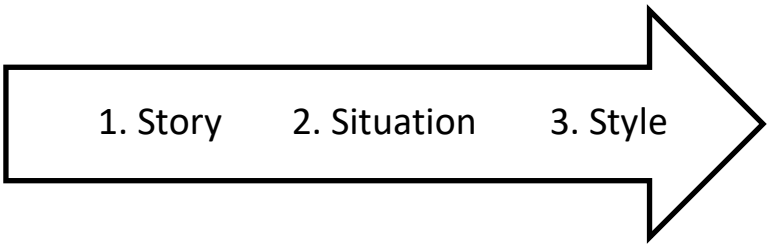
Step 3: Make the CONNECTIONS with our CONTEXT
- What **connections** are there with our situation today?

Step 4: Teach the CONTENT of the book today
- What **main points** would you make?
- How would you **raise these issues** with your listeners?

We will now learn about those detailed steps as we apply them to the book of 1 Timothy.

3.2 ESTABLISHING THE ORIGINAL CONTEXT OF 1 TIMOTHY

We will do that in three ways by looking at three different aspects of a book's context. You need to learn and remember these three words: **story**, **situation** and **style**.



3.2.1 Story

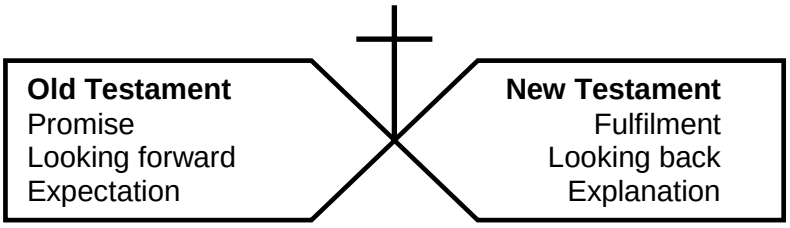
The word '**story**' here is shorthand for 'the story of the Bible'. It is very important to ask this question: Where does 1 Timothy fit into the story of the Bible as a whole? In other words, how does it fit in the development of the Bible's plot?

We will build our knowledge of the Bible's story in Module Two. Here we will introduce one simple idea: it is important to note whether the Bible passage was written before or after Jesus Christ came into the world.

In order to establish that, and what it means for understanding the passage, consider these questions:

- Is the passage in the Old Testament or New Testament?
- Is it about God's promises or the fulfilment of those promises?
- Is it looking forward to the work of Christ or looking back to what he has done.
- Is it expecting the cross and resurrection or explaining it?

This is illustrated below.



1 Timothy was written after Christ's coming. It was written in a time of fulfilment and looks back to the completed work of Christ. It is explaining the gospel and its implications for the churches. It interprets and handles the OT promises in the light of Christ.

This helps us to understand the context and the content. But it also helps us to make connections with today (see below). There may be differences between the situation of those early believers and our situation today (for example, they were still waiting for the NT to be completed whereas we have that treasure). But we have much in common. We too are in the last days, the end times after Christ's first coming and are waiting for his return. We share the same Spirit and have the same gospel. All this makes it far easier to apply the message of these letters today.

3.2.2 Situation

It is very important to discover the situation that the book was written for – its historical setting. Understanding this will bring the words and phrases to life.

Where can we find information on the setting of a letter?
Commentaries on a Bible book can be a great help, but the Bible can be adequately understood without commentaries. The most important book for understanding the Bible is the Bible. That might be a relief to you.

The fact that the Bible is able to interpret itself is based on a truth called the 'sufficiency of Scripture', which we will learn more about in Units 9 and 10. In 2 Timothy 3:15 Paul describes the Scriptures as being able "to make you wise for salvation through faith in Christ Jesus". The Scriptures, with Christ at the centre and a response of trust in him, are all we need for salvation: nothing more, nothing less.

One of the many wonderful things this means is that even though Paul's letters "contain some things that are hard to understand" (2 Peter 3:16) the Bible itself sheds light on them, particularly on the central and vital truths of our redemption. In other words:

The Bible itself provides all the information we need
to help us to understand what the Bible says about our salvation

That includes enough information on the setting of each passage of Scripture. **But how do we go about finding that information?**

Three places to find information on the Bible in the Bible

1. Other parts of the Bible shed light on the setting of a book.
The New Testament repeatedly refers to the Old Testament (for example 1 Timothy 5:18 quotes Deuteronomy 25:4). And the letters often also refer to the Gospels (for example 1 Timothy 5:18 also quotes directly from Luke 10:7). Acts often contains important background information for understanding New Testament Epistles, and that is certainly the case with the Pastoral Epistles, as we will see below.

2. Related Bible books provide useful information too.
Read the other Pastoral Epistles – 2 Timothy and Titus – for insights into the situation in 1 Timothy.

3. The Bible book itself provides the information we need.
We will look at 1 Timothy and discover the situation it was written in and for using some questions that are introduced below.

- Which parts of the Book of Acts might shed light on 1 Timothy and why? List chapters and verses. (HINT: look at 1 Tim 1:3 before turning to Acts: what place is mentioned there that also features in Acts?)

  In Acts 16 we meet Timothy. More on that in Module Five. And Acts 19:8-41 has background on Ephesus, which helps us to understand the worldview and there

will be more on that in Module Seven. But Acts 20:13-38 (particularly verses 25-31) is of more immediate relevance, particularly with the prediction of false teachers emerging from within the church.

How can we use this information to establish the setting of a letter?
You need to imagine you are putting on a detective's hat, imagine that you are a policeman wanting evidence of what has been going on at the scene of 'the crime'. And you need to ask questions in order to discover the information you need. Five questions are given below:

Who? Where? What? Why? When?

- **Who** is addressing whom (which people are involved)?
- **Where** is it being written to and from (what places are involved)?
- **What** is being said (what is the main message of the book)?
- **Why** is this being said (what is the purpose of this piece of writing)?
- **When** was it written (what are the times that are involved)?

Applying these questions to 1 Timothy in order to discover the setting
Please read 1 Timothy at some point and familiarise yourself with the whole book. But as you may be learning a new skill we will focus on the beginning of the letter.

Who? Where? What? Why? When?

- **Who** is addressing whom: which **people** are involved?
  Focus on 1 Tim 1:1-7 and 1:18-20. Look, too, at 1 Tim 4:6, what does that add? Which different groups of people in the church are mentioned?
  Paul to Timothy, but also to 'the brothers' (1 Tim 4:6) the church in Ephesus is clearly meant to hear this. False teachers are mentioned, and particularly Hymenaeus and Alexander, who have 'shipwrecked' their faith.

- **Where** is it being written to and from: what **places** are involved?
  Look again at 1 Tim 1:3 for where it is being written to. Are there any indications of where Paul might be?
  Timothy is to remain in Ephesus. It is not clear exactly where Paul is at this point. Probably somewhere in the area that is Macedonia (1 Tim 1:3). He is not in prison and hopes to join Timothy soon. (Titus 3:12 mentions a place in Macedonia called Nicopolis on the west coast where he hopes to spend the winter.

- **What** is being said: what is the main **message**?
  Look at 1 Tim 1:3-20 and see what themes emerge. And then turn to 1 Tim 3:1-16.
  False teachers are emerging from within the church, as Paul predicted in Acts 20. They are destroying lives, the church and the gospel; they must be stopped. Their message seems to be adding to the gospel by giving people extra things to

do, to believe and to experience (e.g. 1 Tim 1:4 and 1 Tim 4:3). Timothy is to be a true teacher of the gospel and to guard it (1 Tim 6:20) and to ensure sound oversight of the churches (1 Tim 3:14-15).

The channel for false teaching within the churches is 'gendered' – the deceitful leaders are using women who are at home. This is explicit in 2 Timothy 3:6: those who spread a false gospel "are the kind who worm their way into homes and gain control over gullible women". It is implicit in 1 Timothy 2 and may be key to understanding the difficult text, "I do not permit a woman to teach or to assume authority over a man; she must be quiet." (1 Tim 2:12). More on this in later modules.

- **Why** is this being said: what is the purpose of this piece of writing?
  1 Tim 1:3 and 1 Tim 3:14-15 are particularly strong on the purpose of the letter.
  Everything Paul says is designed to encourage Timothy to guard the "glorious gospel" and the character and mission of the church.

- **When** was it written: what are the **times** and events that are involved?
  (HINT: The important thing is to see where the book fits in the story of the New Testament and in relation to the other Pastoral Epistles. Knowing the exact date is less important, although commentaries can help with that.)
  After Paul's release from his imprisonment of Acts 28:30, which gives a limited, two-year period for that imprisonment. Before Titus and 2 Timothy.

3.2.3 Style

When you read a letter from a friend, you do so in a very different way to when you read a newspaper article, or a story, or a poem.

Different Bible books – and often different parts of those Bible books – are written in different styles or genres (a technical word that means 'types of writing').

For example a letter follows a different set of rules to a poem. A story follows a different set of rules to a proverb. The style needs to be identified and kept in mind.

The Pastoral Epistles are a type of letter. There will be more on this type of writing in Unit 4 and also in Module Seven. But it is important to note that a letter is always written:

- From someone
- To someone
- With a message (or messages)
- For a purpose (or for several purposes)

Letters are **occasional**: that is they are written on a particular occasion for a particular reason. That is why it is important to discover the **situation** the letter was written for. In a letter there is an **argument** to follow: an explanation and application of Christian truth.

NOTE: In addition to the 'Who, Where, What, Why, When' questions, it is also worth asking how was it written, in other words what is the tone or feel of the writing? In other

words what feelings are involved? For example, is Paul concerned or angry or encouraged? How urgent and important is the letter?

3.3 DISCOVERING THE CONTENT OF 1 TIMOTHY

We have naturally begun to discover the **content** as we have looked at the **context** above. In looking at the setting we began to see what Paul is saying to Timothy and the church in Ephesus.

Discovering the general content of a book is important before encountering particular texts. In other words, if you were preaching through a book this is a job that yields fruit for a whole series of talks.

One way to approach this is to go through the book and list the content as it comes up. Or you can note the main themes and prioritise them.

- Returning to 1 Timothy and to what we have seen so far, what is the book all about? What are the main things Paul is saying to Timothy?
  Paul's message to Timothy is that...
- *There are false teachers emerging from within the church.*
- *They must be stopped.*
- *Their teaching is adding to the gospel by giving people extra things to do and believe – adding to the gospel destroys the gospel.*
- *The church must be well led by true teachers of the gospel.*
- *That is the way the glorious gospel and the glory of God will be guarded.*
- *Timothy must model that leadership.*

3.4 MAKING THE CONNECTIONS WITH OUR CONTEXT

We have already begun to make some connections through seeing where 1 Timothy comes in the story of the Bible. We can make connections between their situation and ours. While there are differences there are similarities that we need to note.

- What are the similarities and connections between 1 Timothy and your situation and congregation, and with the world you live and work in?

- *The false and misleading teachers within the churches today, driven by selfishness and greed.*
- *The false and misleading teaching itself today – the issues will be different to that of Paul's time, but they are still adding to the gospel and ruining it.*
- *The need for true and godly teachers of the Scriptures and their gospel remains.*
- *The need for well led churches remain, and we need to keep watch over ourselves and one another to make sure that we are not becoming misleading teachers with wrong motives.*

3.5 TEACHING THE CONTENT OF 1 TIMOTHY TODAY

There will be more on this later in the module (Unit 13). But begin to think about how you would teach some of the content of 1 Timothy into your situation, church and churches.

- What **main points** might you make?

- How might you **raise these issues** with your listeners?

3.6 UNDERSTANDING 2 TIMOTHY

Our understanding of 1 Timothy will help us to understand 2 Timothy. We can compare and contrast the two books. They have a close relationship like two brothers.

We will do this by applying the first two steps of understanding a Bible book to 2 Timothy:

Step 1: Establish the original **context** of the book

Step 2: Discover the **content** of the book

If you have enough time together there is no better way to get to know 2 Timothy than by reading it through as a whole.

If you have limited time just look at the verses that are mentioned below, and read through the whole book later.

Guide the participants through this exercise and keep things moving. Their understanding of 2 Timothy will grow as you go through the module.

3.6.1 Establish the context of 2 Timothy

As you look through the book, note specific verses where you see either a similarity to 1 Timothy (something that is nearly the same), or a difference. Describe the similarity or difference by looking at the two books and moving between them. Use the space below to put down your observations. Some verses to look at have been given to help.

- What **similarities** does 2 Timothy have to 1 Timothy in terms of the context?

2 Tim 1:1-2
Paul to Timothy and a very similar greeting. Compare this with 1 Tim 1:1-2.

2 Tim 1:18
There are mentions of Ephesus (also in 4:12) – compare with 1 Tim 1:3.

2 Tim 2:17-18
False teachers are still hard at work. Hymenaeus is mentioned (see 1 Tim 1:20), which means that some of the same group is still operating.

2 Tim 3:1-5
The same testing times are described, including that they are the 'last days' (2 Tim 3:1) or 'later times' (1 Tim 4:1) – meaning that the period we are in, between the comings of Christ, are a period in which sin and Satan continue to exercise their power and influence. See 1 Tim 4:1-2.

Other verses…

- What **differences** does 2 Timothy have to 1 Timothy in terms of the context?

2 Tim 1:2-5

2 Timothy seems even more personal than 1 Timothy. Even 2 Tim 1:2 is slightly different with 'dear son' rather than 'true son in the faith' (1 Tim 1:2). Paul opens his heart to Timothy throughout the letter.

2 Tim 1:16-17; 2:9
In 2 Timothy Paul is now in prison or under house-arrest and is no longer free to travel.

2 Timothy 1:15; 2:17-18
In 2 Timothy the situation described in 1 Timothy has worsened. And Paul is now calling Timothy to join him (4:9) and so Timothy needs to entrust gospel ministry in Ephesus to others as a matter of urgency (2:2).

2 Tim 4:6-8; 16-18
On that note 2 Timothy is more urgent and final than 1 Timothy.

Other verses…

3.6.2 Discover the content of 2 Timothy

As we have looked at the **context** of 2 Timothy we have begun to note the **content**. Build on that now by looking more closely at the content, the themes of the book.

- What **similarities** does 2 Timothy have to 1 Timothy in terms of the content?

2 Tim 1:6
Paul recalls the time when Timothy's gifts were recognised and strengthened – see 1 Tim 4:14.

2 Tim 1:8
There is a clear and similar emphasis on preaching and teaching about Jesus and the gospel. Compare with 1 Tim 1:18.

2 Tim 2:22-23
There is the same call to godly conduct in response to quarrelsome people (see 1 Tim 6:3-6).

2 Tim 2:1-2; 4:1-2
There is the same theme of teaching the true gospel in the face of false teaching throughout.

Other verses…

- What **differences** does 2 Timothy have to 1 Timothy in terms of the content?

2 Tim 1:13-14
Timothy is told to "guard the good deposit" – a more urgent focus on guarding the gospel.

2 Tim 1:8, 16; 2:3; 3:12; 4:5
In 1:8 unashamed loyalty to Paul and the gospel is made clear. There is far more of an emphasis on suffering and enduring. The word 'endure' occurs four times in 2 Tim but not at all in 1 Tim and the exact same thing is true of the word 'suffering'. The only

mention of those who have 'suffered' in 1 Tim is that the false teachers have 'suffered shipwreck with regard to the faith' (1 Tim 1:19).

2 Tim 2:9
The situation has deteriorated so much that Paul has to completely entrust everything into God's hands, which means he clearly expresses his confidence in God's sovereign grace.

Other verses…

3.7 CONCLUSION

We have applied the four steps of understanding the Bible that we discovered in Unit 2 to 1 and 2 Timothy. We have discovered that in a situation where false teachers are damaging the church, the letters focus on the importance of protecting God's people and the need for true teachers of God's message, the gospel. This message becomes more urgent and important in 2 Timothy due to the worsening situation and with Paul facing the end of his life and ministry.

Traditionally 1 Timothy, 2 Timothy and Titus have together been known as 'The Pastoral Epistles'. But that title has led to the understanding that they are letters to church leaders about the organisation and structure of their churches.

- How has this unit of teaching challenged that traditional understanding?

  A close look at 1 and 2 Timothy, beginning with the purpose of 1 Timothy 1:3, to silence the false teachers, demonstrates that Timothy's main job as an itinerant church leader is to oppose these teachers and to equip true teachers of the gospel. He is to model such a life and ministry. Everything else serves this end.

- What alternative title to 'The Pastoral Epistles' might best describe their purpose?

  Interact to end. Possibly, 'The Protection Epistles' or the 'Proclamation Epistles' or similar.

Unit 4. How to encounter a Bible passage (Tools)

Overview

This unit builds on Unit 3 and helps you learn how to discover the original message of a passage of Scripture for yourself. Later in the module we will learn how to preach or teach that message today.

'Scripture sculpture' is one name for the whole process and you will learn the meaning of that term. The first steps, taught in this unit, help you to understand a passage of the Bible. The last steps, taught in Unit 13, help you to teach it.

The first four steps are applied to 2 Tim 1:6-7 so that you can see how they work in practice. Those steps are essential to the BUILD curriculum and will be used throughout as we constantly move from understanding texts to teaching those texts.

Outline

- Introducing 'Scripture sculpture'
- Four steps for encountering a passage of the Bible
- The four steps applied to 2 Tim 1:6-7
- Pulling it all together
- Conclusion: Responding to the message of 2 Timothy 1:6-7

Outcomes

By the end of the unit you will be able to

1. Explain how Unit 3 relates to Unit 4
2. List the first steps of the Scripture Sculpture process
3. Begin to use the four steps for encountering a Bible passage
4. Respond to God's word in 2 Timothy 1:6-7

To help people through the unit, perhaps use the idea of learning to ride a bike – it feels complicated at first but will come naturally in due course. Ask people to share how they learnt to ride a bike. If you are teaching an intensive week, this is the first unit of the second day. Explain that it is the last of the demanding, introductory units. We are at the top of the hill, and this unit will involve group work looking at 1 Timothy itself.

4.1 INTRODUCING 'SCRIPTURE SCULPTURE'

Units 2 and 3 taught some principles for understanding the Bible today and applied them to 1 and 2 Timothy. A main principle is this:

"We must **discover** what God has said in the past before we can **declare** it today."

This unit focuses on discovering what God has said in the past.

In order to discover what God has said in the past we will learn the first steps in a process called 'Scripture Sculpture'. Scripture Sculpture is a process with a series of steps that take us from the Scriptures to a sermon. In other words, from reading a passage to preaching a passage.

This unit teaches the first steps under the title “How to encounter a Bible passage”.

Unit 13 is called “How to preach a Bible passage” and completes the process.

The steps are taken from Ramesh Richard’s ‘Scripture Sculpture’ method and have been adapted with his personal permission. The process is simple, natural and was developed in India.

- What do you understand by the word ‘sculpture’?

If you are unfamiliar with the word, sculpture is an art and a craft. It might mean carving a beautiful object out of wood or making something out of clay.

Ramesh Richard explains why he has called his sermon preparation steps ‘Scripture sculpture’ as follows:

“The Bible is what God has made. Sermons are what we make with what God has made”.

Like creating a sculpture or carving wood, the craft of teaching the Bible means taking what God has given and using it to shape every aspect of our preparation and preaching.

2 Timothy 2:15 says: “Do your best to present yourself to God as one approved, a worker who does not need to be ashamed and who correctly handles the word of truth.”

The word picture Paul uses is one of a workman cutting something straight, or cleanly. We do not know exactly what Paul had in mind, but it might have been a picture of a woodworker, carving and shaping the wood well. What is clear is that we are to be well equipped to understand, explain and apply the Scriptures. A good woodworker knows how best to use the grain or structure of the wood itself to create beautiful carvings. A good Bible-worker uses the shape and structure of the Scriptures to understand, apply and communicate it well.

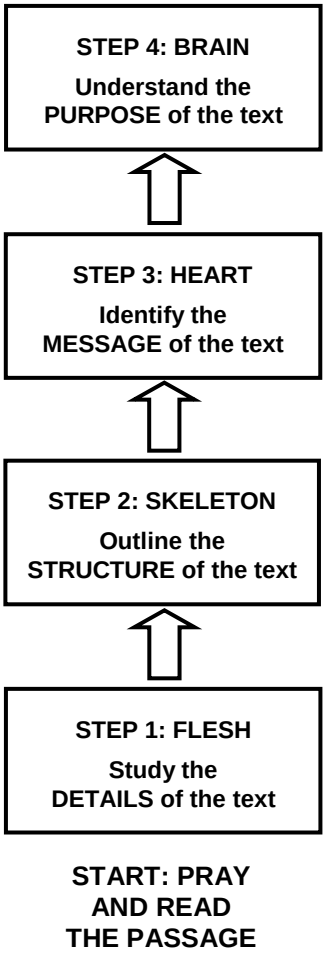
What is also clear is that preaching and praying belong together. In all our preparation we must obey Paul’s command to “pray continually” (1 Thess. 5:17). A background of prayer applies to all the steps, the first four of which are illustrated below.

4.2 FOUR STEPS FOR ENCOUNTERING A PASSAGE OF THE BIBLE

4.2.1 Seeing the four steps in your mind’s eye

The Scripture Sculpture process uses a very powerful image, that of living carving of a person with flesh and bones, a heart and a brain. This is appropriate because God’s word is a living word that comes to us and speaks to us. Start at the bottom of the diagram, which makes it easier to imagine because the brain or mind of the passage is at the top or head.

FOUR STEPS FOR ENCOUNTERING A PASSAGE OF THE BIBLE IN OUTLINE



Imagine these steps as four steps in the creation of a carving that comes to life and walks off the pages of Scripture. These are four steps in our prayerful preparation to preach.

First, the more you study the ‘flesh’ or body of the text on the pages of the Bible, the more familiar the details become and the main findings emerge.

Second, as you continue to spend time in the text its structure appears: the outline or ‘skeleton’ takes shape and becomes clear.

Third, further study leads to you grasping the message or ‘heart’ of the passage, which in turn begins to grip you.

Fourth, and finally, you begin to see the ‘brain’ or the purpose behind the Bible passage.

4.2.2 Four steps for encountering a passage of the Bible explained

The table below gives the outcome of each main step, and also breaks that step down into manageable parts for you.

FOUR STEPS FOR ENCOUNTERING A PASSAGE OF THE BIBLE IN DETAIL

STEP 1: FLESH – Study the DETAILS of the text At the end of this step you will be familiar with the key components of the passage. You need to: a) Set the text in **context** b) See the **details** c) Seek the **meaning** d) Summarise the **findings**
STEP 2: SKELETON – Outline the STRUCTURE of the text At the end of this step you will be able to outline the structure of the passage and see how the author makes his point. You need to: a) Note the various **'bones'** in the passage b) Create an **outline**, having identified the 'big bones'
STEP 3: HEART – Identify the MESSAGE of the text At the end of this step you will be able to write out the author's main point in one or two sentences. You need to: a) State the **theme** of the passage b) Capture the **message** of the passage
STEP 4: BRAIN – Understand the PURPOSE of the text At the end of this step you will be able to explain the purpose of the passage and will begin to make connections for teaching it today. You need to: a) State the **purpose** of the passage b) Make **connections** for teaching it today

4.3 THE FOUR STEPS APPLIED TO 2 TIM 1:6-7

Before you go any further READ THE PASSAGE!

4.3.1 STEP 1: FLESH – study the DETAILS of the text

At the end of this step you will be familiar with the key components of the passage as you **set** the text in context, **see** the details, **seek** the meaning and **summarise** the findings.

a) Set the text in context

Keep the general information about 2 Timothy from Unit 3 in mind as you set 2 Tim 1:6-7 in the context of the book as a whole. In order to do that we can use the same three words that we learnt there: **story**, **situation** and **style**.

Story
When you receive a letter from someone you do not only look at one paragraph: you read the whole letter and come to understand its various parts. A passage can only be properly understood in the context and argument of the book as a whole. Trying to understand a passage of a book without knowing the book itself is like trying to get to know a member of a family without knowing their wider family and where they live.

We have seen where 2 Timothy fits in the story of the Bible as a whole. It is also important to note where a particular passage comes in **the story of the Bible book** it is a part of.

- Where does 2 Tim 1:6-7 come in the argument of the book? How might this help us to understand our verses? Tip: Look at what comes before and after.

  For example: Verses 1 and 2 give the writer's and recipient's names and a fitting greeting. Verses 3-5 then give a prayer and thanksgiving, with an emphasis on the reality of Timothy's Christian faith.

  Verse 6 begins with the words, "For this reason". For what reason? Paul is confident that Timothy's faith is real, so he has a foundation for his appeal for Timothy to "fan into flame the gift of God".

  In vs 8 Paul then tells Timothy, "So do not be ashamed of the testimony about our Lord". This means that verses 6 and 7 must give a reason for Timothy not to be ashamed, a reason for him to be confident in his witness.

Situation

- What do you notice about this passage in relation to what we have already noticed about the book of 2 Timothy – the people, problems and places?

  For example, our passage highlight the close relationship Paul has to Timothy, the tough task Timothy faces, and Paul's urgent call to commitment.

Style

We need to think again about Paul's style of writing. Remember, 2 Timothy is a letter that explains and applies the truth of the gospel in a particular situation.

- What do you notice about 2 Tim 1:6-8 that shows that it is part of a letter?

  2 Tim 1:6-8 presents an argument ("For this reason", for example). It is personal ("I remind you") and it meets the need of the moment: "For the Spirit God gave us does not make us timid, but gives us power, love and self-discipline."

  As participants progress through the module and the book of 2 Timothy and become aware of the situation and the style those elements can be more in the background. Focus on the 'story' element by asking and answering the question, Where does this passage come in the argument of the book? In particular, how does our passage flow from what has gone before and how does it lead into the next section, Where are we in the river of Paul's thought?

b) See the details of the text

We have already begun to notice some of the details; we will now highlight the most important ones. To do this we will **look** for the important details, **mark** them on the passage, and then **list** them.

Look
As you read the passage, look out for the most important details:

1. Repeated and **related** words and phrases

2. Other **important**, **complicated** and **unusual** words and phrases

3. Connections and **links** between the words and phrases

Because "*all* Scripture is God breathed" (2 Tim 3:16), *all* of the details are important. But some stand out and are particularly important.

Because the letter is a form of *teaching* we are looking for the argument and how it is built. So, first, look for words and phrases that indicate the main themes and ideas. And, second, look for words that indicate: the reasoning (for..., therefore..., if...); contrasts (not..., but...); comparisons and illustrations (like...); and connections (and..., this..., which...).

- Have a look at 2 Tim 1:6-7. What important words, phrases and relationships do you see? At this point just look. We will highlight them and list them in a moment.

  Guide the Participants. For example, the phrase "For this reason..." links back to the previous passage.

  The word "remind" is important because it links with "remember", "recalling" and "reminded" in the previous verses. And the phrase "fan into flame" is the main thing Paul calls Timothy to do.

  The "gift of God", "the Spirit God gave" and "but gives" are repeated ideas. And "laying on of my hands" is complex and needs explaining.

"Timid" and "power" are important and contrasting words. And "power, love and self-discipline" is an important phrase.

The words, "For God" link forward. And the words "does not" and "but" make a contrast.

You may see other important words, phrases and arrangements that you can point out. But it is a short passage, do not overcrowd it with markings. An important BUILD saying to use is this: "If you mark everything, you have marked nothing."

Mark
Marking or highlighting a text is a helpful way of visualising things: seeing with your eyes what you hear with your ears. It will improve your powers of observation and help you in your learning and your teaching.

Drawing and highlighting details on the passage is very useful when you "study the flesh of the text" – particularly as you examine it to "see the details". But it will also help you with Step 2 as you "note all the bones in the structure" and as you "outline the skeleton of the text".

This is not only a useful tool to use when you are working on your own, it is also helpful when working in a group, because everyone can see the details and make a contribution. In other words it encourages participation and learning.

The passage we are looking at – 2 Timothy 1:6-7 – is given below. This is how it might appear in a Bible but in a magnified form. Your Trainer will demonstrate how you can write on, underline, divide up the passage and draw on the text to help the important details to stand out. Be imaginative and creative and use different shapes and colours if you can.

If you do have colours to use here is a simple system to follow. Red, green and blue are the most common colours we tend to use. You can think of these in relation to the **green** of the grass, the **red** of the soil and the **blue** of the sky above as a way to remember. Use the colours as follows:

1. For **repeated** or **related** words and phrases use **green**

2. For other **important** or **unusual** words and phrases use **red**

3. For **connections** and **links** between the words and phrases use **blue**

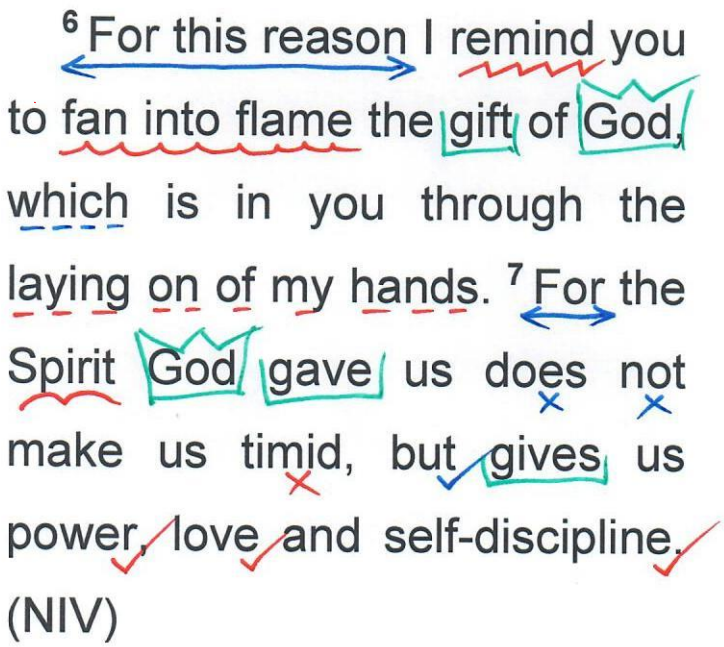
You can then use **black** (or **white** chalk) for more general underlining, notes and structural divisions.

But remember, **be selective**. If you mark everything you have marked nothing!

Depending on the situation, you might like to photocopy the text of the Bible, or simply write out the passage in full on a piece of paper or board.

See the completed, marked up passage below. The version in the Participants' Manual does not have the markings. If you have not gone through the course as a participant and marked up the passages for yourself, please do so in a Participants' Manual.

ENCOUNTERING 2 TIMOTHY 1:6-7 – THE PASSAGE


6 For this reason I remind you
to fan into flame the gift of God,
which is in you through the
laying on of my hands. 7 For the
Spirit God gave us does not
make us timid, but gives us
power, love and self-discipline.
(NIV)

List
Once you have marked the passage, **list** the important words and phrases on one side of a page, as in the column 'see the details' in the table below.

c) Seek the meaning from the details

Ask and answer questions:

- What do these words and phrases mean today in your language?
- What did they mean in the context of the passage when it was written?
- What is their significance in the passage and book?
- Review your answers – are they simple, true and consistent in the context of the book, the group of books and the Bible?

Record your observations in the table below. Your Trainer will guide you.

For example the table below links the details we have already noticed to their meanings. Use this to guide the participants.

See the details of the text	**Seek the meaning from the details**
List words, phrases, and relationships:	Explain words, phrases, and relationships:
"For this reason..."	*Links back – 'based on what I have said…'*
"remind" (links with "remember", "recalling" and "reminded" in the previous verses)	*Paul has been remembering things; Timothy needs to remember something too.*
"fan into flame" (the main thing Paul calls Timothy to do)	*Timothy must renew his passion and reignite and rekindle his God-given gifts.*
"the gift of God", "God gave" and "gives" (repeated ideas)	*Paul encourages Timothy that God has given him all he needs for this ministry.*
"laying on of hands" (complex, needs explaining)	*1 Tim 4:14 ties the gifts to the public recognition of Timothy's ministry*
"For" (introduces an explanation)	*Paul will explain more about this gift*
"Spirit"	*God's Holy Spirit, his empowering presence*
"timid" and "power" (important and contrasting words)	*Personal weakness contrasted with the Spirit's strength*
"does not" and "but" (contrast)	*Underlines the contrast*
"power, love and self-discipline" (important phrase)	*The Spirit is these things and brings these things. They are the perfect blend – each needs the other two.*

d) Summarise your findings

Draw on all the above. What are the main things you have discovered, the most important ideas that you want to carry forward?

Summarise the findings. What are the main ideas that come out of this initial study?

Paul is convinced that Timothy's faith in Christ is genuine.

Because of this confidence Paul reminds Timothy to do something important. Timothy must renew his confidence in God and his gifts.

The greatest gift of all is that of God's Holy Spirit with us. He is powerful, loving and self-disciplined.

4.3.2 STEP 2: SKELETON – outline the STRUCTURE of the text

At the end of this step you will be able to sketch out the structure of the passage and see how Paul makes his point.

a) Note the various 'bones' in the passage

You are aiming to discover how Paul has structured his writing or flow of thought, so that you can understand the message it carries. The clues are in the details and you may have begun to notice the structure. While 2 Timothy 1:6-7 is short and will have a single theme, even a short section of a letter has a structure. That structure may be clearest in the links and logic, or in the arrangement of the themes or ideas.

Links
In Paul's writing the links and the logic are important parts of the structure.

- What important links contribute to the structure?

Verse 6 begins with the words, "For this reason". This forms an introduction. What Paul says in this short passage is based on the content of the previous one: Timothy can be confident in the reality of his own faith.

And in verse 7 the word "for" links verses 6 and 7. Timothy is to obey the command of verse 6 not only because of the confidence he can have in his God given faith, which verse 5 speaks of, but also because of the content of verse 7. Timothy is to stir up and exercise his gifts for ministry because of the nature and character of the greatest gift of all, God's Holy Spirit.

There are also smaller 'bones' that add to the structure. The words "which" and "through" that link the ideas of "the gift of God" and that gift being "in you" and how the gift was given, "through the laying on of my hands." The words "does not" and "but" create a contrast between the attitudes the Holy Spirit does and does not give.

Themes
The way the ideas or themes are arranged also creates structure.

- Look at the main ideas from your study of the flesh of the text. How are they arranged in the passage?

*Verse 6 begins with an **introduction**, which is contained in the words "for this reason". Those words look back to the confidence Paul has in Timothy's "sincere" faith.*

*The verse continues with **a command** for Timothy to obey: "fan into flame the gift of God". He is to renew and exercise his gifts.*

Verse 6 then adds to that by explaining how that gift became a recognised part of Timothy's life and ministry – this also emphasises confidence because it was a public event that had witnesses (1 Tim 4:14).

*Verse 7 then gives **a further reason** for Timothy to use his gifts confidently rather than fearfully: because of the presence and nature of God's Holy Spirit.*

b) Create an outline, having identified the 'big bones'

There are major parts of the structure and minor ones; big bones and small bones. What are the 'big bones' in the passage that give it shape and structure? How would you divide up the passage? Capture this by making a simple summary outline of the passage.

We can divide the passage into three parts using the links and ideas we noticed:

1. The introduction *to confidence in God and his gifts: Timothy can be confident in his faith (v. 6a) because Paul has already assured him it is "sincere" (v. 5).*

2. The command *to renew confidence in God and his gifts: Timothy can be confident that he has the God-given gifts for ministry, therefore he must rekindle them (v. 6b).*

3. The reason *to renew confidence in God and his gifts: God's Spirit is determined, committed and resilient, and we have the presence of this confidence building Spirit in our lives (v. 7).*

4.3.3 STEP 3: HEART – identify the MESSAGE of the text

At the end of this step you will be able to write out Paul's main point in a sentence or two.

Remember, the Bible is 'God preaching' to his people. Therefore a biblical message is more than just information; it tells us something important and practical about that information.

A simple way of identifying the message of a passage is this: note the author's theme <u>and</u> note what he says about that theme.

a) State the theme of the passage

Take time and care to reflect on and pray over your discoveries so far and capture the theme as simply and as clearly as you can by answering the question below.

- What is the main thing Paul is talking about?

  For example: 'The theme of 2 Tim 1:6-7 is, Renewing confidence in God and his gifts for ministry.'

b) Capture the message of the passage

Think about this theme and answer the question, what is the author saying about this theme in this text? Try and do this simply and clearly, without using technical words, and ideally in a way even a child could understand it.

Remember, you are aiming to discover the original meaning of a text. To help with this try completing a sentence that begins with words such as: "Paul tells Timothy that...", or, "What Paul wants Timothy to know is...".

- Complete one of those sentences for our passage:

  "Paul tells Timothy that…

  For example: 'Paul tells Timothy to renew his confidence in God and his gifts for ministry'

4.3.4 STEP 4: BRAIN – understand the PURPOSE of the text...

At the end of this step you will be able to explain the purpose of the passage and will have made some connections so that you can teach it today.

a) State the purpose of the passage

Keeping in mind the context of the passage you need to answer the question: Why is Paul making this point?

- Answer that question for our passage:

  For example: Paul tells Timothy to renew his confidence in God and his gifts because he is facing an urgent and demanding task, one that he cannot overcome with his own abilities and strength.

b) Make connections for teaching today

The aim of the first four steps of Scripture Sculpture is to discover the original meaning of the passage. However, the real aim of encountering a passage of Scripture is to apply it to our lives and ministries and to experience its transforming power. We want to discover the significance of the passage for us today. We must keep in mind not only where the passage belongs in its original context, but also where it belongs in our hearts and lives, in our congregations and communities.

The message statement, **what** is being said, is important as we make connections today. The purpose statement, **why** it is being said is also important.

Think about **what** you and your people need to hear from this Bible passage and **why** they need to hear it.

- Capture that idea in the form of a statement or a question that makes some connections with your situation and your congregation's situation today.

  For example: In the face of all the daily demands and difficulties we face, how can we renew our confidence in God and his gifts for ministry?

4.4 PULLING IT ALL TOGETHER

The two tables below pull together our discoveries in the first four steps of the Scripture Sculpture process. They do this in a format that we will use throughout the BUILD curriculum when encountering a passage of the Bible.

4.4.1 Pulling it all together: Step 1 of the Scripture Sculpture process

STEP 1: FLESH – study the DETAILS of the text

a) Set the passage in context. How does the passage relate to the book as a whole?

Story: Verses 3-5 emphasise the reality of Timothy's faith.

Verse 6 begins with the words, "For this reason..." Paul's confidence in Timothy's faith means he has a basis for his appeal for Timothy to "fan into flame the gift of God..."

Verse 8 then tells Timothy: "So do not be ashamed of the testimony about our Lord..." Verses 6 and 7 must give a reason for Timothy not to be ashamed and to have confidence.

Situation: The passage communicates the close, personal nature of Paul and Timothy's relationship.

Style: A section a letter, which builds a clear argument; it explains and applies the gospel.

b) See the details of the text	**c) Seek the meaning from the details**
List words, phrases, and relationships:	Explain words, phrases, and relationships:
"For this reason..."	Links back – 'based on what I have said…'
"remind" (links with "remember", "recalling" and "reminded" in the previous verses)	Paul has been remembering things; Timothy needs to remember something important too.
"fan into flame" (the main thing Paul calls Timothy to do)	Timothy must renew his passion and reignite and rekindle the gifts that he has
"the gift of God", "God gave" and "gives" (repeated ideas)	Paul encourages Timothy that God has given him all he needs for this ministry
"laying on of hands" (complex, needs explaining)	1 Tim 4:14 ties the gifts to the public recognition of Timothy's ministry
"For" (introduces an explanation)	Paul will explain more about this gift
"Spirit"	God's Holy Spirit, his empowering presence
"timid" and "power" (important and contrasting words)	Personal weakness contrasted with the Spirit's strength
"does not" and "but" (contrast)	Underlines the contrast
"power, love and self-discipline" (important phrase)	The Spirit has these qualities and brings them to Timothy. They are a perfect blend – each quality needs the other two.

d) Summarise the findings. What are the main ideas that come out of this initial study?

Paul is convinced that Timothy's faith in Christ is genuine.

Because of this confidence Paul reminds Timothy to do something important. Timothy must renew his confidence in God and his gifts.

The greatest gift of all is that of God's Holy Spirit with us. He is powerful, loving and self-disciplined.

4.4.2 Pulling it all together: Steps 2 – 4 of the Scripture Sculpture process

STEP 2: SKELETON – outline the STRUCTURE of the text

a) Note all the bones in the structure. What elements highlight the structure?

Links. “For this reason” links the passage to the content of the previous one: the confidence Timothy can have in the reality of his own God-given faith.

And the word “for” (v. 7) links with verses 6 and 7. Timothy is to obey the command of v 6 not only because of the confidence he can have in his own faith (which v. 5 speaks of), but also because of the content of verse 7: Timothy is to stir up and exercise his gifts because of the nature and character of God’s Holy Spirit who has been given to him.

There are also smaller ‘bones’ that add to the structure. The words “which” and “through”, as well as “does not” and “but”, which create a contrast.

Themes. Verse 6 begins with an introduction, which is contained in the words “for this reason”. Those words look back to the confidence Paul has in Timothy’s “sincere” faith.

The verse continues with a command for Timothy to obey: “fan into flame the gift of God”. He is to exercise his gifts for gospel ministry with confidence.

Verse 6 then adds to that by explaining how that gift became a recognised part of Timothy’s life and ministry – this also emphasises confidence because it was a public event that had witnesses (1 Tim 4:14).

Verse 7 gives another reason for Timothy to use his gifts with confidence rather than fear.

b) Decide on the ‘big bones’ and make an outline of the structure. What are the most important parts of the structure? Can you describe the main sections?

1. The introduction to confidence in God and his gifts: Timothy can be confident in his faith (v. 6a) because Paul has already assured him it is “sincere” (v. 5).

2. The command to renew confidence in God and his gifts: Timothy can be confident that he has the God-given gifts for ministry, therefore he must rekindle them (v. 6b).

3. The reason to renew confidence in God and his gifts: God’s Spirit is committed and resilient, and we have the presence of this confidence building Spirit in our lives (v. 7).

STEP 3: HEART – identify the MESSAGE of the text

a) State the theme of the passage. What is the author’s main point?

The theme is, Renewing confidence in God and his gifts for ministry.

b) State the message of the passage. What is the author saying about his theme?

Paul tells Timothy to renew his confidence in God and his gifts for ministry.

STEP 4: BRAIN – first, understand the PURPOSE of the text...

a) State the purpose of the passage. Why is the author making this point?

Paul tells Timothy to renew his confidence in God and his gifts because he is facing an urgent and demanding task, one that he cannot overcome with his own abilities and strength.

b) Make connections for teaching today. What is the relevance of this for us?

In the face of all the daily demands and difficulties we face, how can we renew our confidence in God and his gifts for ministry?

4.5 CONCLUSION: RESPONDING TO THE MESSAGE OF 2 TIMOTHY 1:6-7

We will learn more about how to preach and teach from Bible passages in Unit 13. That unit will use 2 Tim 1:6-7 as an example. But it is important for us to respond to the passages we will encounter before then. Here are three simple exercises to do in response to God's word to us in 2 Tim 1:6-7:

1. Describe how the message you discovered in the passage spoke to you personally: What did you learn or need to be reminded of?

2. Share how the purpose of the passage helped you to apply God's word to your life: What change will this passage make to your thinking and living?

3. State and explain the message you will share with others using your own words: What is the main thing you want people to understand?

ADDITIONAL NOTE: Why select 2 Timothy 1:6-7 as a unit of writing to study?

Over time the participants need to learn how to decide on the limits of a passage. You may decide to introduce this important skill to participants now or later on.

It is always worth thinking about the limits of the passage because a message in the Bible is contained in a unit of writing and that unit can vary in length, as we will discover as we move through the BUILD curriculum. Decisions about the limits of a passage affect the meaning you discover.

Letters convey a main message, but they are divided into paragraphs in which the author makes a single point that contributes to that whole message. Sometimes a single paragraph and a single point is enough to base a study or a sermon on. Or it may be that a few paragraphs with their points combine to make one main point.

We can use 2 Tim 1:6-7 to show how to decide on the limits of a passage. Different versions of the Bible and even different editions of versions break up the early sections of 2 Timothy in different ways; compare them for yourself if you can. Do not assume that the verses and divisions in your version of the Bible are 'correct'.

***Question:** How do we know that 2 Tim 1:6-7 is a unit we can study?*

***Answer:** For two reasons. Firstly, from what we know about the elements of a typical New Testament letter, verses 1 and 2 belong together as do verses 3 and 5. Therefore verse 6 is the beginning of a section. We will consider that in more detail.*

Verses 1 and 2 stand alone as the first 3 elements of a first century letter, which are:
Part 1. The name of the writer (Paul).
Part 2. The name of the recipient (Timothy).
Part 3. The greeting (Grace, mercy and peace...)

Verses 3-5 form the next section:
Part 4 of a standard letter is the prayer wish or thanksgiving (Christianised by Paul and other NT authors).

Verse 6 is the beginning of a new section:
Part 5 of a letter is the main body. And Paul has crafted his thanksgiving and prayer in verses 3-5 to lead into his next point, which begins in verse 6 with the words "For this reason...".

Note: Part 6, the final element of a letter is the final greeting and farewell, 2 Tim 4:19-22 in this case.

The second reason for selecting 2 Tim 1:6-7 as a unit to study is that verses 6-7 form the basis of an appeal to Timothy for his loyalty, a section that runs up to verse 12 and on into verses 13 and 14. Ideally you would take that section as a whole. The main point in his appeal is contained in verse 8: "So do not be ashamed of the testimony about our Lord or of me his prisoner. Rather, join with me in suffering for the gospel, by the power of God."

But because verses 6-7 form the basis for that appeal they can be taken as a small sample unit for us to study.

Unit 5. 2 Timothy 1:8-12 (Encounter)

Overview

Every module has a number of opportunities for you to be coached in your ability to handle the Bible. This unit applies the lessons of Unit 4 to 2 Timothy 1:8-12.

Outline

- Introduction
- Worksheet for Encountering 2 Timothy 1:8-12 – The passage
- Worksheet for Encountering 2 Timothy 1:8-12 – Step 1
- Worksheet for Encountering 2 Timothy 1:8-12 – Steps 2 to 4
- Responding to the message of 2 Timothy 1:8-12

Outcomes

By the end of the unit you will be able to

1. Follow and apply the four steps of Encountering a Bible Passage to a passage from 2 Timothy yourself
2. Share the message of 2 Timothy 1:8-12 with a group of people today

This unit applies the skills that Participants were introduced to in Unit 3. Give the Participants an opportunity to apply the steps themselves, individually or in groups. You might want to take the whole group, interactively, through one or more stages in order to vary the approach.

Or you might vary the group sizes. For example, they could 'see the details' individually, 'seek the meaning' in groups and 'summarise the findings' with your help as the whole group.

Encourage participants to pray together at the end: for grace to continue in gospel ministry.

5.1 INTRODUCTION

In this unit you will apply the lessons of Unit 4 to a passage from 2 Timothy (1:8-12). Keep referring back to the four steps you were introduced to in the last unit. You might want to work on your own, with a friend, or in a small group for this unit.

Spend time reflecting on the text on the next page. If you are working in a group you might want to take it in turns reading it out loud between each step. Listen for and look for different things each time it is read out.

Use a notepad to write the passage out and record observations and work on these before marking the text in this work book, which you will want to keep for reference. You may want to wait until your Trainer marks up a passage before recording it in this book. Use the worksheets on the pages that follow the text in a similar way to before. Your Trainer will help you and guide you through this process.

5.2 WORKSHEET FOR ENCOUNTERING 2 TIMOTHY 1:8-12 – THE PASSAGE

8 So do not be ashamed of the
testimony about our Lord or of me his
prisoner. Rather, join with me in suffering
for the gospel, by the power of God. 9 He
has saved us and called us to a holy life –
not because of anything we have done but
because of his own purpose and grace.
This grace was given us in Christ Jesus
before the beginning of time, 10 but it has
now been revealed through the appearing
of our Saviour, Christ Jesus, who has
destroyed death and has brought life and
immortality to light through the
gospel. 11 And of this gospel I was
appointed a herald and an apostle and a
teacher. 12 That is why I am suffering as I
am. Yet this is no cause for shame,
because I know whom I have believed,
and am convinced that he is able to guard
what I have entrusted to him until that day.
(NIV)

Timothy's call to gospel ministry

The gospel Timothy is called to minister

Paul's example of gospel ministry

5.3 WORKSHEET FOR ENCOUNTERING 2 TIMOTHY 1:8-12 - STEP 1

STEP 1: FLESH – study the DETAILS of the text

a) Set the passage in context. How does the passage relate to the book as a whole?

*Connecting with the **story** of the book the words "So do not be ashamed" (v. 8) links the passage back. Paul is saying "because you can be confident in your gifts and your God" do not be ashamed.*

The clear presentation of the gospel in our passage then leads to a call to "guard the gospel" (vv. 13-14) with God's help and power (which also links to our previous passage).

*Connecting with the **situation** of the book the passage highlights Paul's situation in prison (v. 8) and his encouragement of Timothy to be a true teacher of the gospel in the face of opposition. He tailors his presentation of the gospel (vv. 9-10) to that situation.*

b) See the details of the text.	**c) Seek the meaning from the details**
List important words, phrases, and relationships:	Explain important words, phrases, and relationships:
"So" (v. 8)	*A link back*
"not ashamed", "shame" (v. 8, v. 12)	*A call for unswerving loyalty and boldness*
"Testimony" (explain – similar to "gospel"	*A word of witness about the truth of Jesus*
"Suffering" (x2 v. 8, v. 12)	*A link with Christ's suffering and Paul's*
"gospel" (x3 vv. 8, 10, 11)	*God's good news ("testimony" is similar)*
"saved us and called us"	*God takes the initiative*
"holy life"	*Set apart for God's purposes*
"purpose and grace" "grace" (x2, v. 9)	*Sovereign grace – God is in charge*
"Christ Jesus" (x2)	*Christ is at the centre of God's gospel*
"death and... life"	*Brings resurrection life*
"do not... but" (v. 8)	*A contrast between confidence and cowardice*
"God, who" (v. 8-9)	*Talk of God's power leads to God's gospel*
"not because... but because" (v. 9)	*Rescued by God's work not good works*
"before time... but now" (v. 9-10)	*Planned in the past, revealed in the present*
"life... through the gospel" (v. 10)	*The gospel is a revelation of God's work*
"because" (v. 12)	*The reason for Paul's confidence*
"guard what I have entrusted" (v. 12)	*Paul puts his life and ministry into God's hands*
"that day" (v. 12)	*Jesus' second appearing (v. 10 has his first)*

d) Summarise the findings. What are the main ideas that come out of this initial study?

The theme of unashamed, Spirit empowered gospel ministry continues

It involves a call to commitment: to Christ, to the gospel, and to communicating the gospel

There is a detailed explanation of the gospel, tailored to the situation with God's sovereign grace at the heart of it, in order to encourage Timothy in his task.

There is an unavoidable link between public gospel work and suffering

In Paul's mind Christ is at the heart of all the above and his life is an example of suffering for Christ and the gospel.

5.4 WORKSHEET FOR ENCOUNTERING 2 TIMOTHY 1:8-12 – STEPS 2 TO 4

STEP 2: SKELETON – outline the STRUCTURE of the text

a) Note all the bones in the structure. What elements highlight the structure?

*The **links** are important: "So do not" looks back and leads into v. 8. And there are important turning points: "This grace…" (v. 9); "And of this gospel…" (v. 11). And many little links or bones (e.g. v. 12 "that", "Yet", "because").*

*The **themes** are important too: 1. A all to unashamed gospel ministry (v. 8);*

2. The gospel of God's grace in Christ (vv. 9-10). This is the central idea, with a step by step development of themes such as God's initiative, God's grace, Christ's work;

3. Paul's example of unashamed gospel ministry (vv. 11-12).

b) Decide on the 'big bones' and make an outline of the structure. What are the most important parts of the structure? Can you describe the main sections?

The links and themes suggest three main sections:

1. From "So" to "God" (v. 8) on the call to gospel ministry – linked to the experience and example of Paul;

2. From "He" (v. 9) to "gospel" (v. 10) on the gospel Timothy is called to minister;

3. From "And" (v. 11) to "that day" (v. 12) on Paul's example of gospel ministry.

STEP 3: HEART – identify the MESSAGE of the text

a) State the theme of the passage. What is the author's main point?

(Timothy is called to follow Paul's example of unashamed proclamation and defence of the glorious gospel.)

The theme is: a call to a sacrificial commitment to Christ and the gospel

b) Explain the message of the passage. What is the author saying about his theme?

Paul calls Timothy to be loyal to Christ and the gospel: it will involve sacrifice but it is worth it because of the importance of the gospel

STEP 4: BRAIN – first, understand the PURPOSE of the text...

a) State the purpose of the passage. Why is the author making his point?

He makes this point in order to encourage Timothy and prepare him for the realities and loneliness of gospel centred ministry (together with the sense of God's present power and future vindication)

b) Make connections for teaching today. What is the relevance of this for us?

Paul's call to gospel ministry and experience of gospel ministry is very different to our approach today. We need a renewed sense of the seriousness, significance and sacrifice of Gospel ministry in the face of all the challenges we face.

5.5 RESPONDING TO THE MESSAGE OF 2 TIMOTHY 1:8-12

Here are three simple exercises to do in response to God's word to us in the passage we have just encountered:

1. Describe how the message you discovered in the passage spoke to you personally: What did you learn or need to be reminded of?

2. Share how the purpose of the passage helped you to apply God's word to your life: What change will this passage make to your thinking and living?

3. State and explain the message you will share with others using your own words: What is the main thing you want people to understand?

Unit 6. What is the gospel? (Reflection)

Overview

God's gospel is the central theme of 2 Timothy 1:8-12, which we encountered. This explores the important question of the nature of that gospel. It does so through three steps: encounter, reflection and action. These steps examine our own understandings, revisit 2 Timothy 1:8-12, reflect more widely on the gospel in the Pastoral Epistles, and begin to consider what this means in practice.

Outline

- Introduction
- Encounter your own understanding of the gospel
- Reflect on the meaning of the gospel in the Pastoral Epistles
- Action to take from a true understanding of the gospel

Outcomes

By the end of the unit you will be able to

1. Reflect independently on issues you meet in the Pastoral Epistles
2. Evaluate your own understanding of the gospel
3. Explain what the gospel is to other church leaders

Unit 1 had the category 'reflection' after the title 'Introducing BUILD'. It engaged with a topic but nothing was said about the discipline of Christian reflection.

This unit is the first to deliberately reflect on an issue. It follows three steps of encounter, reflection and action. Do not explain the process, simply follow the steps. Unit 9 will explain the process in detail.

6.1 INTRODUCTION

We have met the word 'gospel' a number of times in the preceding units and have seen its central importance in the Pastoral Epistles. These letters are all about "the importance of being a true teacher of God's message, the gospel, and the need to establish other true teachers of the faith."

We have just encountered 2 Timothy 1:8-12 and its emphasis on the gospel. This unit builds on that with some guided reflection. It does this through questions and discussion. The questions are given below and your Trainer will guide you through the process in three steps of encounter, reflection and action.

6.2 ENCOUNTER YOUR OWN UNDERSTANDING OF THE GOSPEL

We have just encountered 2 Timothy 1:8-12 and the gospel it contains. Some people assume that they are Christians but they have not understood the gospel and it has no impact on their lives. And genuine believers have different understandings of the gospel.

Before we look again at what the Pastoral Epistles say about the gospel, we need to be honest about our own understanding or lack of understanding of the gospel. Use the

questions and guidelines below on your own, with another person or in a group reveal your thinking.

If you do this exercise in a pair, work through the questions one at a time allowing time for feedback. You can check whether you have understood your companion correctly by reflecting back their answer to them: “So you are saying that...?” This approach will make their answers clearer and improve your listening skills.

1. What do you think the word ‘gospel’ means?

2. Give a short summary and explanation of the gospel as you understand it.

3. Comment on the importance of the gospel to you. What difference has the good news made in your own life?

4. Comment on what the gospel seems to mean to other church leaders. Why do you think there are these different understandings?

6.3 REFLECT ON THE MEANING OF THE GOSPEL IN THE PASTORAL EPISTLES

We have thought about our understanding of the gospel. But what does Paul think?

6.3.1 Explore Paul’s understanding of the gospel in the Pastoral Epistles

Use the questions and guidelines below, beginning each time with 2 Timothy 1:8-14, before broadening out your investigation.

1. What words and phrases does Paul use for the gospel?
Discuss the words and phrases Paul uses in place of or to mean the same thing as "the gospel."

- Begin with 2 Timothy 1:8-14. What words or phrases does Paul use to refer to the gospel?

For example, 2 Tim 1:8: "So do not be ashamed of the testimony about our Lord or of me his prisoner. Rather, join with me in suffering for the gospel, by the power of God". The phrase "the testimony about our Lord" is a way of talking about the gospel.

2 Tim 1:13-14 speak of: "what you heard from me" (Paul's message); "the pattern of sound teaching" (a consistent framework and content of truth); and "the good deposit" (something that has been laid down, once for all). These phrases tell us that the gospel is a message to be shared and passed on that has clear content to it.

Extra: 1 and 2 Timothy and Titus are rich in words and phrases that describe the gospel. If you have time skim through the books and look for such words with your trainer's help.

If you do this, draw attention to some of these phrases: "a trustworthy saying that deserves full acceptance" (1 Tim 1:15); "the testimony given in its proper time" (1 Tim 2:6); "the true faith" (1 Tim 2:7); "the truth" (1 Tim 3:15); "the faith" (1 Tim 4:1); "the good teaching" (1 Tim 4:6); "God's word" (2 Tim 2:9); "the word of truth" (2 Tim 2:16); "the trustworthy message" (Titus 1:9); "the teaching about God our Saviour" (Titus 2:10).

2. What is the focus of the gospel?

- Discuss what 2 Timothy 1:8-14 tell us about what lies at the heart of the gospel.

2 Tim 1:8-14 makes it clear that Christ Jesus as our Lord is right at the centre of it. Its focus on Christ focuses further still on his destruction of death and his gift of life (v. 10). And the phrase "the testimony about our Lord" is then spoken about in relation to "suffering for the gospel". Sharing the gospel is the costly work of sharing the message about Jesus.

Extra: Look at some or all of these texts: 1 Timothy 2:3-7; Titus 2:11-14 and 3:3-8.

1 Tim 2:3-7 also puts Christ at the centre, with him as the "one mediator between God and men". Titus 2:11-14 emphasises Christ's sacrifice. Titus 3:3-8 puts Christ at the centre and also emphasises the work of the Holy Spirit in applying God's rescue plan to the lives of individuals and the church. But even the Holy Spirit's work and power is released "through Jesus Christ our Saviour".

3. What is the foundation of the gospel?

- Discuss what 2 Timothy 1:8-14 tell us about who or what lies behind the gospel.

The gospel is about God saving us and calling us to a new life (v. 9) he is the one who is behind it all. The gospel is about something God has done at his initiative, not something we have done, it is "because of his own purpose and grace" (v. 9).

4. What is the fruit of the gospel?

- Discuss what 2 Timothy 1:8-14 tell us about what the gospel produces.

The aim of the gospel is to produce "a holy life" (v. 9). And it leads to "life and immortality" (v. 10). The gospel is a message that must be proclaimed, taken into the world and taught (v. 12 – "herald... apostle... teacher").

5. How does the gospel relate to time: the past, present and future?
Finally, look at Titus 2:11-14 and Titus 3:3-8 and discuss how we are to think about the past, present and future in the light of the gospel.

Titus 2:11-14 emphasises "grace" and its impact on transforming people's lives in the present, but with a fresh emphasis on the future coming of Christ. Titus 3:3-8 gives more background on what the Cretan Christians have been saved from (v. 3), saved by (v. 5), saved through (v. 5), and saved for (v. 7-8). It touches the past, present and the future.

6.3.2 Pulling our findings together

Use the questions below to summarise your discoveries.

<u>What</u> is the gospel?

The gospel is God's good news of salvation from sin and evil through King Jesus, a declaration of what God has done. The message transforms those who have truly heard and understood it.

Gordon Fee, in his commentary on the Pastoral Epistles, says that the gospel is at "the heart of everything" for Paul. He describes it as: "The good news of God's gracious acceptance and forgiveness of sinners, to which the proper response is faith (trusting God that he really does accept sinners) and love toward others".

<u>Who</u> is involved in the gospel?

The gospel is God's message about an initiative that is his from start to finish. It is about God's plans and purposes achieved in Christ and through the Holy Spirit. It is for all people.

<u>Why</u> is there a gospel at all?
The gospel message only exists because of what God has done in love and mercy and grace for us and for his world. It is nothing to do with what we have done. It is entirely undeserved.

<u>How</u> has the gospel been implemented, in history and in our lives?

The gospel is about Christ putting God's plans into action through his life, death and resurrection. His death destroys death and brings life. He acts as a mediator between God and people. And it is about the Holy Spirit enabling faith, bringing new life and empowering God's people to live lives that make the gospel attractive to others.

How do we benefit from this good news? We turn from our disobedience to God and trust that the gospel is true – that God can be taken at his word and will accept us, forgive us and transform us.

<u>When</u> does the gospel have an impact?

*The gospel is about the past, the present and the future. The Holy Spirit gives us **faith** to trust in what God has done in the past; he gives us **love** for God and others in the present; and he brings us **hope** for the future return of Christ and his coming Kingdom.*

*Or put another way: Those who trust in the message of the gospel **have been** saved from the penalty of sin; are now **being saved** from the power of sin; will one day **be saved** from the presence of sin.*

Where did the gospel come from and what places will it reach?

The gospel began at a particular place and finds its ultimate focus in an announcement and proclamation of God's forgiveness from the cross. But there is a ripple effect from there as it is good news for all people everywhere.

As a Trainer you may find that people begin to ask about the relationship between the way Jesus announced the good news and the way Paul did. In Module Three we will look more at the terms Jesus uses, such as the Kingdom of God, a term that is also present in Paul's writing. Explain that there is only one gospel which is presented in different ways in different settings by Jesus and Paul.

6.4 ACTION TO TAKE FROM A TRUE UNDERSTANDING OF THE GOSPEL

The gospel is God's good news of salvation from sin and evil through King Jesus, a declaration of what God has done. The message transforms those who have truly heard and understood it.

Gordon Fee, in his commentary on the Pastoral Epistles, says that the gospel is at "the heart of everything" for Paul. He describes it as:

"The good news of God's gracious acceptance and forgiveness of sinners, to which the proper response is faith (trusting God that he really does accept sinners) and love toward others".

The next unit puts this reflection into action through training us to share the gospel. But begin to think through what action you need to take:

- It might be through identifying a change that is needed in your **attitudes**. How does the gospel transform your view of yourself or of other people?

- It might be through identifying some **skills** you need to develop to explain these things to others. Are there gaps in your abilities that you need to work on?

- It might be through identifying some gaps in your **knowledge** that you need to fill. Do you have questions about the gospel that you need to have answered?

End this session by in prayer: asking God to act. Use your new understanding of the gospel in prayer for yourself, for your church and for the community you are a part of.

Unit 7. Sharing the gospel (Action)

Overview

This unit builds on the previous one. It helps you to put that reflection on the nature of the gospel into practice through teaching motives and methods for sharing the gospel.

Outline

- Introduction
- Why should we share the gospel?
  - The rule of God
  - The love of God
  - The justice of God
- How can we share the gospel?
  - A testimony to share
  - A message to communicate
  - A change to demonstrate
- Conclusion

Outcomes

By the end of the unit you will be able to

1. Name and then internalise clear motives for sharing the gospel
2. Share the story of what God has done in your life in a way that communicates the heart of the gospel
3. Use a simple framework to explain the gospel to others

This unit contains a great deal of information that can be used for reference and Participants will need to return to it repeatedly as they learn how to use it. Focus the training on the practical skills of explaining the gospel.

7.1 INTRODUCTION

Begin by discussing these questions:

- What motivates you to share the good news of Jesus with other people?

- What hinders us in our desire and ability to share the gospel with others?

Write the questions up on a board or speak them out and encourage the participants to discuss them. Follow up the questions and discussions by helping people to see that there are obstacles to evangelism, but they are obstacles we can overcome, not least as the motivation for sharing the gospel is so strong.

7.2 WHY SHOULD WE SHARE THE GOSPEL?

7.2.1 The rule of God

We have already learnt that the gospel is based on the fact that God is in charge of the world – he is the one who has purposes, makes plans and is able to follow through on them. Paul uses the phrase "our Lord" (2 Tim 1:8) when talking about Jesus; Jesus rules God's world and has the right to rule our lives. Paul commands Timothy to preach the word "in view of his appearing and his kingdom" (2 Tim 4:1).

We also learnt that the gospel is for everyone. God's rule means it is for everyone. It is a public message and God's church is designed to be a public address system – God's way of letting the whole world know the message and implications of the gospel. In other words the rule of God means that the gospel is relevant and important for everyone – we have to share it and share it well. There are far too many faulty public address systems. We need to make sure that our church is faultless in proclaiming the gospel clearly.

7.2.2 The love of God

- Think of some good news you have received. What did you do once you had received it?

We have all received good news – perhaps the birth of a child or even their graduation. Energise the Participants by getting them to share; perhaps have a competition to share the best bit of news and get them to evaluate the contributions.

The Pastoral Epistles connect God's gospel with God's love. For example Paul talks of when the "kindness and love of God our saviour appeared" (Titus 3:4). The gospel is the good news of God's love; that good news is for sharing. It is as simple as that. The gospel speaks of God's love for us and transforms us to love others. The most loving thing we can do is to share the gospel of God's love with them.

7.2.3 The justice of God

The gospel is a message of both God's love *and* God's justice – 2 Tim 4:1 talks of "Christ Jesus, who will judge the living and the dead". It is a reminder that our wrongdoing deserves punishment, but that in love Christ bears that shame and punishment himself. But if people do not trust Christ to do that for them, they will have to face the consequences one day, not least because of the rule of God.

This is good news, because God will not allow sin, including injustice, to go unpunished. But it is bad news in that it is a solemn warning for all people everywhere.

7.3 HOW CAN WE SHARE THE GOSPEL?

7.3.1 A testimony to share

We have discussed the different words we use for the activity of sharing the gospel with others. The idea of 'testimony' may have come up. A testimony is the presentation of evidence by a witness. When you are giving a testimony you are telling your story of what Christ has done in your life – it is a testimony about Christ. 1 Timothy 1:12-17 is a fine example of this, read that passage before you go any further.

Prepare well
You will find it much easier to relax and be yourself if you are well prepared. Give time to preparing your story and make sure the length serves the listener.

Use a structure
It is easiest to follow this simple structure:

1. Before – explain what life was like before you met Christ. You may have been brought up in a Christian home and Jesus has always been a friend of the family. Do not invent a troubled past if you do not have one, but make it clear that you had to come to a point where you made a decision yourself about Christ.

2. During – how did you come to meet Christ and make that decision? What were the circumstances and who was influential. What got you thinking and what did it involve? All our stories are different, but make it clear that God calls us to turn away from our wrong doing and self-centredness and to turn to him as our only hope.

3. After – what difference has it made? Be realistic about the ups and downs of the Christian life, but use examples of how Christ's love and God's promises have made a difference to you and those around you.

Avoid 'jargon'
Technical, theological or complicated words not only put people off the gospel but fail to communicate it. For example talk about rebellion and disobedience rather than 'sin'. Explain that we need to turn away from self and to God rather than 'repent'. Say that we need to rely on what God has done in Christ, rather than our own efforts rather than 'faith'.

Practice on a Christian friend
It will help you and encourage your Christian friend if you can practice your testimony. You might want to do that now in pairs:

> **Step 1.** Person A: spend 5 minutes sharing your testimony with Person B
>
> **Step 2.** Person B: comment on the testimony that you have just heard. For example, what was clear about it and what was not?
>
> **Step 3.** Reverse the process. Person B: spend 5 minutes sharing your testimony with Person A.
>
> **Step 4.** Person A: comment on the testimony that you have just heard. For example, what was clear about it and what was not?

Pray
Evangelism, sharing the gospel, is what we do. Changing lives is what God does. We must pray that he will help us and will speak to our friends and contacts.

7.3.2 A message to communicate

Paul tells us that the gospel is “the power of God for the salvation of everyone who believes” (Romans 1:16). God’s good news is a life changing message. We need to be able to communicate it simply and explain it deeply. That depth will develop as we go through the BUILD modules.

Communicating the good news to others
We will begin by assessing the way in which we are already communicating the gospel to other people. We will follow a similar process to the one we used to help us share our testimonies with the aim of evaluating the message we are sharing and the way in which we are explaining it. Follow the four steps below:

> **Step 1.** Person A: Spend 5 minutes explaining the gospel, as you understand it, to Person B.
>
> **Step 2.** Person B: Comment on the explanation of the gospel that you have just heard from Person A. For example, what was clear about it and what was not?
>
> **Step 3.** *Now reverse the process.* Person B: Spend 5 minutes explaining the gospel, as you understand it, to Person A.
>
> **Step 4.** Person A: Comment on the explanation of the gospel that you have just heard from Person B. For example, what was clear about it and what was not?

You might want to comment on your explanations in the light of the passages about the gospel that we have already looked at in the Pastoral Epistles.

Communicating the gospel using BUILD’s 3-2-1 method
There are many different ways of explaining the good news. BUILD’s 3-2-1 outline has been designed for BUILD learners. It is built on and will build on your learning. It is based on 1 Timothy 1:15-17. Take time to learn this short passage by heart if you have not done so already. It is presented below in a way that will help you to memorise it:

15 Here is a trustworthy saying that deserves full acceptance:
Christ Jesus came into the world to save sinners – of whom I am the worst.

16 But for that very reason I was shown mercy so that in me, the worst of sinners,
Christ Jesus might display his immense patience as an example
for those who would believe in him and receive eternal life.

17 Now to the King eternal, immortal, invisible, the only God,
be honour and glory for ever and ever. Amen.

We are calling this method 3-2-1 so that we know what we are referring to and to make this presentation of the gospel easy to remember. It is called 3-2-1 because in 1 Timothy 1:15-17 there are:

> **3** things to understand, **2** things to do and **1** way to live

3 things to understand:

1. God is King

God is “the King eternal, immortal, invisible, the only God” (verse 17). God is King and is in charge of everything and everyone. He always has been and always will be because he alone is “eternal.” God is not like us. He is “immortal” and “invisible.” He is unique, “the only God.” We have been created to give him “honour and glory.” That means recognising who he is and living to please him.

- Do you understand that God is King and that you should obey him?

2. We are sinners

God made us to love and obey him, but we live for our own honour and glory. That is why Paul calls people “sinners” and feels he is the “worst of sinners” (verses 15 and 16). No one likes to be called a sinner, but Paul has just told us that God loves us very much (verse 14). However, despite and because of his great love for us, God cannot stand our sin and we cannot approach him. This leads to death, a problem that only God can solve.

- Do you understand that you are a sinner and are cut off from God?

3. Jesus came to save us

This good news is at the heart of the “trustworthy saying”: “Christ Jesus came into the world to save sinners” (verse 15). If we understand our guilt, shame and powerlessness we know we need a saviour. The title “Christ Jesus” means ‘God’s chosen rescuer.’ God the King came in the person of his Son, and his death and resurrection completed his mission. At the cross Jesus dealt with sin and evil once and for all. He is the saviour that we need and that God sends.

- Do you understand that Christ Jesus is the only one who can rescue you?

2 things to do:

1. Believe in Jesus

Verse 16 reminds us that God has done all the work but that we need to respond: we must “believe in him.” That is Paul’s way of telling us to trust what God has already done for us through Jesus Christ. The gospel is “a trustworthy saying that deserves full acceptance” and we must put our hope fully in Jesus, the only one who can rescue us.

- Will you put your trust fully in Jesus to save you?

2. Receive new life

Verse 16 goes on to tell us that as we trust in God we “receive eternal life.” The King removes our sin and shame and welcomes us into his kingdom, a place with no evil and no end. That life begins now through the gift of God’s Holy Spirit but it continues beyond the grave and into the future, when God’s new heavens and new earth will be established forever. We must open our hearts to receive God’s great gift.

- Will you open your heart to receive God’s gift of new life?

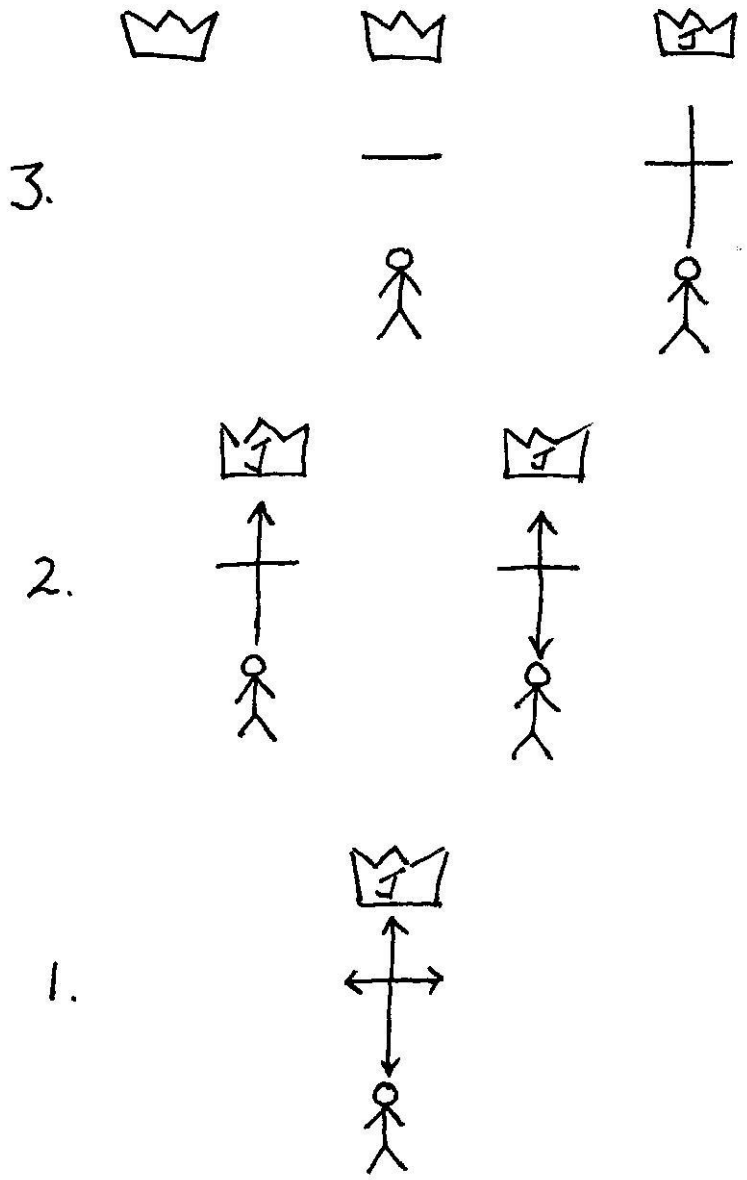
1 way to live:

Live God’s way

Believing in Jesus and receiving God’s Holy Spirit is just the start. We must live God’s way from now on. The passage ends, “Now to the King eternal, immortal, invisible, the only God, be honour and glory for ever and ever. Amen.” Paul learnt to love, honour and obey God, and we must do the same. That means loving others and living for God.

- Will you turn from sin and evil and live God’s way from now on?

Picturing the gospel using the 3-2-1 method
You can use some very simple pictures to illustrate and explain the 3-2-1 outline. You can either draw these as six separate pictures or build up one picture as you go along:



<u>3 things to understand</u> - in the first row of pictures:
- The first picture is a crown, to show that God is King.
- The second shows us under God's rule, but as sinners, separate from him.
- The third points out that Jesus is our saviour: he died for the sins of the world.

<u>2 things to do</u> - in the second row:
- In the first picture the arrow points up: we must believe in Jesus.
- In the second the arrow also points down: we receive life through the Holy Spirit.

<u>1 way to live</u> - in the third row:
- All the arrows in the picture point outwards: we must live our lives God's way.

Other ideas for using the 3-2-1 method to explain the good news:

1. Ask the person you are with for permission to share a brief explanation of the good news from the Bible for you to discuss together. Many people have rejected a false presentation of the gospel and have never considered a true one.

2. Read out the passage at the beginning and keep referring to it. That will help people to see that you are not inventing a message and that your authority comes from the Bible.

3. Go through the presentation by making the statements, providing the explanations and asking the questions. Build out the statements with further explanation. You do not have to follow the exact text of the 3-2-1 method given above. Adapt it for your setting using your own language. Use what you learnt in Unit 6 to help you.

4. Repeat the presentation with the pictures if it is easy and natural to do so. You do not have to introduce the pictures of your presentation at the beginning or to use them at all. But they can provide a way of reinforcing the message if you want to use them.

5. Use other parts of 1 Timothy to shed more light on the message, again, if it is easy and natural to do so. For example:

> 1 Timothy 6:15-16 reinforces and develops the main idea of 1:17: God is King. It uses a number of phrases to do so. For example, “King of kings and Lord of lords,” is based on Old Testament texts that emphasise God’s sovereignty (Ezekiel 26:7 and Daniel 2:37) and his power over all other ‘gods’ (Deuteronomy 10:17 and Psalm 136:2-3). The fact that he dwells in “unapproachable light” (Psalm 104:2) reminds us of his purity.
>
> 1 Timothy 3:16 explains more about Jesus’ saving mission: his becoming flesh, his global recognition and his glorious ascension.
>
> 1 Timothy 2:5-6 tells us more about Jesus’ role as our mediator and ransom through his death.
>
> 1 Timothy 6:14 explains that Jesus will appear again: no one will escape his claim on their lives.
>
> 1 Timothy 4:10 uses the idea of putting “our hope in the living God” as another way of describing belief. It tells us that we do that by placing our trust in him through Jesus, “the Saviour of all people”. It also helps us to understand that while God can save everyone and anyone, he only saves “those who believe”.

Using 3-2-1 to not only explain the gospel but to lead someone to Christ:

People need to not only understand the gospel but also to respond to it. Repentance and faith is the response God requires: people must turn away from sin and evil and turn to Christ. That change is demonstrated in lives lived God’s way. The explanation of ‘two things to do’ and ‘one way to live’ underlines the importance of that.

3-2-1 not only explains the content of gospel, it gives a natural opportunity to challenge people to follow Jesus themselves. You can help someone to begin to follow Jesus by turning the content of 3-2-1 into a prayer like this one:

> Heavenly Father, I recognise that you are King. I have been living in your world but I have not been living in your way. Thank you for sending Jesus to be my saviour. I trust in him alone for my salvation and receive the gift of life that your Holy Spirit brings. From now on I want to live for Jesus until I meet him face to face in his new world. Thank you for the gift of your Holy Spirit, who will strengthen me to live life your way from now on. In Jesus' name I pray. Amen.

You can adjust the content of the prayer for the situation of the listener or group.

The strengths and weaknesses of different ways of sharing the gospel
Any short explanation of the gospel will have its strengths and weaknesses. You can make up for any shortcomings that you think this presentation has. Remember that even Jesus and Paul explained the same gospel in different ways in different places. You need to tailor your explanation to your setting. For example, you can explain that the single figure of the individual can also represent mankind as a whole: we were made for relationship with one another. And while each of us, alone, must make a decision, the good news has an impact on all our relationships and leads to a new community, the local church.

7.3.3 A change to demonstrate

The Pastoral Epistles make it clear that the message of the gospel is also to be communicated through our lives, which demonstrate the change that Christ brings. In other words there is also to be non-verbal communication.

- Titus 2:1-10 draws attention to this aspect of evangelism. Look through that passage and discuss the link between the message of the gospel and lives that reinforce the message.

All the behaviour that Paul encourages in the lives of Christians is there to "make the teaching about God our Saviour attractive" (Titus 2:10). Paul's concern here is first that the true gospel will be protected and strengthened by the lives of believers. (NOTE: That statement is made with regard to first-century slaves. 1 Tim 1:10 talks of the sinfulness of slavery, however, the abolition of slavery as an outworking of the gospel came much later. Perhaps it might not have come at all if these early slaves had not demonstrated and passed on the true gospel.)

- Do our lives demonstrate the impact of the gospel in a similar way? In what ways does this challenge you, individually, and your church or churches?

7.4 CONCLUSION

Review the motivations for sharing the gospel: the rule, love and justice of God. Review the methods for sharing the gospel: sharing our testimony, explaining the message, demonstrating the change the gospel brings.

End the session in prayer, asking for God to open the eyes of our hearts to see and understand his kingdom of love and justice and to help us to share his good news, not least as we "make the teaching about God our Saviour attractive" (Titus 2:10).

7.5 EXTRA: THE DIFFERENT WORDS FOR SHARING THE GOSPEL

- What words or expressions do you use for the activity of sharing the gospel? What words do others use? What do they mean?

We have been talking about the activity of sharing the gospel. Paul himself uses different words and phrases for this. Your trainer will guide your responses to the question above to help you in your learning.

Some guidance on this: The Greek word for gospel is 'euangelion' and the word 'evangel', another word for 'gospel' comes from that. The activity of sharing the gospel is 'evangelism'.

Evangelism is a better word for this activity than the word 'crusade' which can bring with it a sense of forcing people to become Christians and which has a shameful history attached to it, particularly for Muslims.

Others might mention 'witness', which is helpful. We are called to be witnesses of what God has done in Christ – both in history and in our own lives.

'Testimony' may come up. Those who are witnesses can testify. A testimony needs to be something that points to what God has done in Christ, even when we are explaining what he has done in our lives.

Witness and testimony put Jesus Christ at the centre. You might like to make the point that just as good news is for sharing, great friends are for introducing to others. If we have met the living Lord Jesus we will want others to meet him. Sharing the gospel is about introducing Jesus to others.

It is worth making the link between the gospel and 'evangelism' because many people will have heard of that word. But once you have made that point you might like to ask if anyone has heard of the word 'evangelical' (they may well not have done, but may be evangelical none the less)! If anyone has heard of that word explain that 'evangelism' (an activity) must not be confused with the word 'evangelical' (a theology that puts the gospel first).

An 'evangelical' can then describe a person who aims to put the gospel, the 'evangel' at the heart of their theology and ministry. Paul was an evangelical in that sense and the Pastoral Epistles are 'evangelical' because they are all about the centrality of the gospel.

How do the two words 'evangelism' and 'evangelical' relate? 'Evangelicals' put the gospel at the centre of their theology and ministry, and 'evangelism' will be one of their top priorities.

Unit 8. 2 Timothy 2:1-7 (Encounter)

Overview

Every module has a number of opportunities for you to be coached in your ability to handle the Bible. This unit applies the lessons of Unit 4 to 2 Timothy 2:1-7.

Outline

- Introduction
- Worksheet for the passage
- Worksheet for Step 1
- Worksheet for Steps 2 to 4
- Responding to the message of 2 Timothy 2:1-7

Outcomes

By the end of the unit you will be able to

1. Follow and apply the four steps of Encountering a Bible Passage to a passage from 2 Timothy yourself
2. Share the message of 2 Timothy 2:1-7 with a group of people today

This unit applies the skills that Participants were introduced to in Unit 3.

Once again give the Participants an opportunity to apply the steps themselves, individually or in groups.

You might want to ask which of the steps people are struggling with and focus on that particular one.

8.1 INTRODUCTION

In this unit you will apply the lessons of Unit 4 to another passage from 2 Timothy (2:1-7). Keep referring back to the four steps in that unit. You might like to think back to your earlier experience of this process and something you found particularly hard to achieve and ask your Trainer for help with that.

Spend time reflecting on the text on the next page. It ends on the theme of reflection – “reflect on what I am saying” – so you might want to give particular time to considering the images Paul uses and pray for insight.

Use a notepad to write the passage out and record observations and work on these before marking the text in this work book, which you will want to keep for reference. You may want to wait until your Trainer marks up a passage before recording it in this book. Use the worksheets on the pages that follow the text in a similar way to before.

Your Trainer will help you and guide you through this process.

8.2 WORKSHEET FOR ENCOUNTERING 2 TIMOTHY 2:1-7 – THE PASSAGE

2 You then, my son, be strong in the grace that is in Christ Jesus. [2] And the things you have heard me say in the presence of many witnesses entrust to reliable people who will also be qualified to teach others. [3] Join with me in suffering, like a good soldier of Christ Jesus. [4] No one serving as a soldier gets entangled in civilian affairs, but rather tries to please his commanding officer. [5] Similarly, anyone who competes as an athlete does not receive the victor's crown except by competing according to the rules. [6] The hardworking farmer should be the first to receive a share of the crops. [7] Reflect on what I am saying, for the Lord will give you insight into all this. (NIV)

Empowered

Entrust

Endure

Envisioned

8.3 WORKSHEET FOR ENCOUNTERING 2 TIMOTHY 2:1-7 - STEP 1

STEP 1: FLESH – study the DETAILS of the text

a) Set the passage in context. How does the passage relate to the book as a whole?

Story: *In the book's* ***argument*** *the words "you then" (v. 1) links the passage back to the previous section where Paul tells Timothy to guard the gospel (1:14) remain loyal and committed – unlike those in 1:15 and like Onesiphorus in 1:16.*

The call to "reflect on" what Paul continues to say about loyalty to the gospel (v. 7) leads on to a reminder that it is Jesus' gospel and that Timothy is accountable to him (v. 8-13).

The passage continues with the ***theme*** *of suffering for the gospel (v. 3) and the need to draw on God's strength and wisdom (v. 1, 7).*

b) See the details of the text	**c) Seek the meaning from the details**
"my son" (v. 1)	*Paul continues on a personal note*
"be strong in the grace" (v. 1)	*Action. Renews the theme of empowerment*
"Christ Jesus", "Lord" (vv. 1, 3, 7)	*Christ at the centre*
"things you have heard me say" (v. 2)	*The gospel in the form of Paul's teaching*
"presence of many witnesses" (v. 2)	*The public nature of that teaching*
"entrust" (v. 2)	*Action. Deposit the deposit with others*
"reliable people" (v. 2)	*Others who are prepared to stand firm*
"join with me" (v. 3)	*Action. Suffering hardship for the gospel*
"soldier, athlete, farmer" (vv. 4, 5, 6)	*Three pictures of rewarding hard work*
"civilian affairs" (v. 4)	*The focus is on putting the gospel first*
"according to the rules" (v. 5)	*There are no short cuts in athletics*
"receive" (vv. 5, 6)	*Emphasis on reward (similarly "please")*
"reflect" (v. 7)	*Action. Consider carefully, understand*
"you then" (v. 1)	*A link back*
"in, in" (v. 1)	*His strength in God's grace in Christ*
"heard, entrust, teach" (v. 2)	*Heard – past; entrust – present; teach – future*
"me, you, people, others" (v. 2)	*Four generations or groups in the chain*
"like", "similarly" (vv. 3, 5)	*Word pictures and comparisons*
"for" (v. 7)	*The reason to reflect*

d) Summarise the findings. What are the main points that come out of this initial study?

Paul's passionate concern for the gospel and continued gospel ministry continues; set against a background of those who have failed him and one who has not.

Paul calls Timothy once again to rely on God's power, to stand firm in the struggle, to pass on the gospel to others who will also engage in the struggle.

He reinforces this call to endurance with three word pictures which shed light in different ways on the same theme of dedicated but rewarding work.

Paul tells Timothy to reflect deeply and to receive empowering insight. In the verses that will follow he goes on to look at the example of Christ the promise of his presence and reward.

8.4 WORKSHEET FOR ENCOUNTERING 2 TIMOTHY 2:1-7 – STEPS 2 TO 4

STEP 2: SKELETON – outline the STRUCTURE of the text

a) Note all the bones in the structure. What elements highlight the structure?

The links: *"You then" introduces Paul's first command (v. 1). "And" introduces a main theme (v. 2). The word "like" (v.3) introduces the first of three word pictures, the word "similarly" also draws attention to an illustration.*

The themes: *Four actions are important:*

(1) "Be strong" (v. 1) – a call to stand firm in Christ Jesus.

(2) "Entrust" (v. 2) – a call to pass on the gospel.

(3) "Join with me in suffering" (vv. 3-6) – a call to loyalty to the gospel through three pictures of hard work and dedication with the promise of reward.

(4) "Reflect" (v. 7) – a call to be strengthened through reflection.

b) Decide on the 'big bones' and make a summary outline of the structure.

Those four things Timothy must do suggests four parts to the passage:

(1) Strengthen your commitment to the gospel (v. 1)

(2) Pass on your commitment to the gospel (v. 2)

(3) Live out your commitment to the gospel (vv. 3-6)

(4) Understand your commitment to the gospel (v. 7)

STEP 3: HEART – identify the MESSAGE of the text

a) State the theme of the passage. What is the author's main point?

The theme is: Putting the gospel first or loyalty and commitment to the gospel.

b) Explain the message of the passage. What is the author saying about his theme?

Paul again tells Timothy to put the gospel first by relying on God's grace and wisdom, through the costly training of others, and through the dedicated but rewarding service of Christ and his cause: "Pass on the gospel in the strength and service of Christ Jesus."

STEP 4: BRAIN – first, understand the PURPOSE of the text...

a) State the purpose of the passage. Why is the author making his point?

Paul makes this point because the future of the gospel and gospel ministry is so important. Protecting and preserving the gospel is a struggle but God gives strength for the task.

b) Make connections for teaching today. What is the relevance of this for us?

We need to carefully assess our commitments and priorities and ask whether we are prepared to put the gospel and its future first, whatever the cost.

8.5 RESPONDING TO THE MESSAGE OF 2 TIMOTHY 2:1-7

Here are three simple exercises to do in response to God's word to us in the passage we have just encountered:

1. Describe how the message you discovered in the passage spoke to you personally: What did you learn or need to be reminded of?

2. Share how the purpose of the passage helped you to apply God's word to your life: What change will this passage make to your thinking and living?

3. State and explain the message you will share with others using your own words: What is the main thing you want people to understand?

Unit 9. Keeping the gospel central (Reflection)

Overview

This unit flows out of the study of 2 Timothy 2:1-7 and explores ways in which commitment to the gospel shapes the ministry of local church leaders. In doing so it teaches us how to "reflect" on the Scriptures and the situations we face and develops the BUILD 'ERA' model of theological reflection that is used throughout the BUILD curriculum.

Outline

- Introducing theological reflection
- The three steps of theological reflection
- Principles for gospel centred ministry
- 'ERA': A further look at the steps of theological reflection
- The BUILD logic of gospel ministry

Outcomes

By the end of the unit you will be able to

1. Recall and arrange the steps of theological reflection
2. Apply the steps of theological reflection to issues you encounter
3. Plan steps to make the gospel more central to your ministry
4. Use the acronym 'BUILD' to present the logic of gospel ministry

Begin with the simple exercise in 9.1.1. This unit teaches steps of reflection that will be used and developed throughout the curriculum.

This is not the first time we have come across the idea of theological reflection. Unit 1 explained that the BUILD curriculum has four types of learning unit: (1) Tools for encountering God's word; (2) Encounters with God's word; (3) Reflection for wisdom; (4) Action as leaders in mission.

Those types of units are based on an idea that we will return to again and again: Training for ministry is an essential part of ministry rather than something separate from it. The letter 'I' in the word 'BUILD' is a picture of this: learning must be done in the context of mission and ministry, it is to be in-service training.

9.1 INTRODUCING THEOLOGICAL REFLECTION

9.1.1 What challenges are you facing?

We have seen that Timothy faced some very real challenges. Some individuals were distorting the gospel and destroying the church. We too face many struggles and difficulties in our own ministries.

- Individually or in a group: Identify a challenge or problem you are facing. If you are in a group write these down and then underline one or two that will benefit from further discussion later on in the unit. (NOTE: It might be a situation in your life or the life of your church that is puzzling. Or it might be a Scripture that is challenging.)

9.1.2 Going further and deeper

All too often our responses to the different experiences we face and the studies in the Bible we do are quickly forgotten and rarely lead to real change. Why is this the case and how can we go further and deeper? Discuss this together.

- Why do you think that so much teaching and learning fails to bring about any real change in people's lives? Where do you think the problem lies?

- How can we make sure that our encounters with the situations we face and the Scriptures God has given us lead to real learning and action?

  In order to truly learn, change and do ministry effectively we need to learn what it means to reflect on the Scriptures and the situations we face.

9.1.3 "Reflect"

In the passage we have just encountered (2 Tim 2:1-7), Paul tells Timothy to pass on the gospel as a servant of Christ in the strength of Christ. Paul uses three pictures to illustrate what that means in practice and makes it clear to Timothy that he must do more than just read his words.

Paul knew that **reflection** was essential for real learning to take place and for action to happen. And so he ends that passage with a command that comes with a wonderful promise (2 Tim 2:7): "Reflect on what I am saying, for the Lord will give you insight into all this."

- Memorise that verse now and consider the importance of careful reflection and the Lord's kindness in opening the eyes of our hearts to his truths.

9.2 THE THREE STEPS OF THEOLOGICAL REFLECTION

How can we reflect more deeply and effectively on God's word and God's world? We will explore that question by looking more closely at Paul's words in 2 Tim 2:7 and by exploring one of the issues that you identified at the beginning of the unit.

As we do so we will discover that theological reflection is a three step process that encourages learning and action:

1. It begins when we **encounter** something in God's world and/or God's word with a desire for wisdom.

2. It continues with **reflection** on those situations and Scriptures in order to gain wisdom.

3. It leads to **action** in God's world with the wisdom that comes from God's word.

9.2.1 Encounter

The first step is:

To encounter something in God's world and God's word with a desire for wisdom.

Paul tells Timothy to reflect "on" something. Theological reflection is an encounter with Scripture or experience. Scripture takes priority when it comes to shaping belief and behaviour, but we always encounter God's word in the context of the world around us.

Timothy is called to reflect on God's word in the midst of the situation he was facing. We too are to reflect on God's word in the context of all that is going on in our lives and churches and communities. Sometimes the issue or challenge is something we meet in the midst of our ministry. Sometimes it is something we meet in the Bible.

In the discipline of encounter you first **describe** things and you then **discover** things. That work of description and discovery involves asking and answering questions:

1. How did events unfold? Tell the story of what you experienced.
2. Who was involved in the experience? Describe the people.
3. What were the various people doing and saying? Record what happened.
4. Where and when did the events take place? Describe the situation.
5. What key things have you discovered that will need further reflection? List the different issues that have come to your attention.

- Apply the questions above to one of the challenges or issues you noted as a group at the beginning.

Summary points for the <u>encounter</u> step of theological reflection:

- To <u>encounter</u> something is to meet something new, surprising and unsettling.
- You need to <u>describe</u> the things you encounter and your reactions.
- You must list the <u>discoveries</u> you have made.

Your initial description and the discoveries you make will only be shallow. They will not explain the fuller meaning and significance of the encounter or experience. You must resist jumping to conclusions. Rather than taking action immediately you need to pause and go deeper by taking the next step.

9.2.2 Reflection

The second step is:

Reflection on those situations and the Scriptures in order to gain wisdom.

In 2 Timothy 2:7 Paul commands Timothy to "reflect" on what he has said about gospel ministry. Remember that any "insight" is a gift from "the Lord". Reflection is an opportunity for God to break into our lives, which means we need to make space for God's grace through prayer in the process. Do not rely on your own understanding.

In his reflection Timothy must consider three word pictures Paul has used: the images of soldier, athlete and farmer. It often helps if there is a *visual* aspect to our reflection, which helps us to think in fresh ways. (Diagrams, drawings and maps can help the process.)

But the most important thing is to *keep the gospel at the centre of your theological reflection*, to consider the situation in the light of God's good news. In verse 7 Timothy is called to "reflect" on God's word through Paul and in verse 8 to "remember" Jesus Christ, the heart of Paul's "gospel".

In the discipline of reflection you **consider** your discoveries and develop **principles**. Considering and developing principles means asking and answering questions:

1. Why might these things be happening? Note the reasons that might lie behind the description and discoveries. Give explanations.
2. What light does the gospel, the good news of God's grace, shed on all this? Keep the gospel at the heart of your reflection.
3. What Bible passages and themes are particularly relevant to the problem? List a few Scriptures that you think are important.
4. What pictures come to mind that help you to understand God's perspective on it? Explain any illustrations or draw any diagrams that help you to understand what is going on.
5. What principles seem to come from this process? List these lessons.

- Apply these questions to the discoveries you have made about the challenge or issue you noted as a group.

Summary points for the <u>reflection</u> step of theological reflection:

- To <u>reflect</u> is to pause for thought rather than to react. It is to question, to think and go deeper, to chew things over.
- You need to <u>consider</u> the discoveries you have made in the light of the God's word and in his presence.
- You must list the <u>principles</u>, the new perspectives or ways of looking at life and ministry that come from this.

It is tempting to leave these principles as interesting topics for discussion, as many academics do. But rather than leaving them as theories on a page, you need to put what you have learnt into practice and take the final step and prepare to take action.

9.2.3 Action

The final step is:

Action in God's world with the wisdom that comes from God's word.

Paul calls Timothy to reflect on his words, which are God's words, for a purpose: so that he can be strengthened for a demanding ministry. Action is therefore not just about *what* you do but is also about *why* you do it, it is to be guided by the gospel.

Action means **planning** new approaches to ministry, testing things out and developing new **practice**.

We need to test our reflection by making a plan and taking action. We need to ask and answer questions such as:

1. How might all this change my attitudes?
2. What action can I take that will put these principles into practice?
3. What plans can I make in order to achieve this? (Make plans, whether formally or informally.)

- Apply these questions to the principles you have drawn out of your reflection on the challenge or issue you noted as a group. Note some of your plans below.

Summary points for the action step of theological reflection:

- To take action is to do something new or in a new way.
- You need to plan to put the principles into practice.
- The outcome will be new practice: ministry and mission that is more faithful to the gospel.

9.2.4 Summary table for the three steps of theological reflection

Step and description	Definition	Activity	Outcome
Encounter something in God's world and God's word with a desire for wisdom.	To meet something new and surprising	Describe	Discoveries
Reflection on those situations and the Scriptures in order to gain wisdom.	Pause for thought and go deeper	Consider	Principles
Action in God's world with the wisdom that comes from God's word.	Do something new or different	Plan	Practice

- Make sure you have understood the summary table ask and clarify any questions here.

9.3 PRINCIPLES FOR KEEPING THE GOSPEL CENTRAL

We have looked at some issues we are facing today in the light of the gospel, and we have been challenged to keep the gospel central in our life and ministry.

One way of listing, considering and remembering some of the principles we have noted is to use the letters that make up the word gospel – G O S P E L.

See if you can think of words that fit with the principles you have discovered and the plans you have made which begin with the letters G and O and S and P and E and L.

For example, the letter G might stand for 'God', because keeping the gospel central means honouring him. His will and his ways matter more than anything else.

You might think of more than one word for each letter. Pick the best two and use them in the table below. Your Trainer can help you with this.

Principles for keeping the gospel central to our life and ministry:

God – keeping the gospel central means honouring God. His will and his ways matter more than anything else.	**G***race – we do not try and keep the gospel central in order to gain his favour but because of his favour.*
O*wnership – the gospel has been entrusted to us. We need to know it and its benefits first hand, in our hearts not just our heads.*	**O***rganisation – we must plan our ministry around the gospel. That will not happen by chance.*
S*acrifice – Paul makes it clear that keeping the gospel central in life and ministry is costly.*	**S***pirit – we can only keep the gospel central and guard it with the help of the Holy Spirit who lives in us (2 Tim 1:14).*
P*riorities – if the gospel is to be central, other things will need to be put to one side.*	**P***eople – 2 Tim 2:2 makes it clear that people are essential to the work of passing on the gospel and loyalty to that message.*
E*vangelism – We preserve and prioritise the gospel by spreading the gospel, by doing "the work of an evangelist".*	**E***xposition – letting the Bible speak for itself by explaining and applying the Scriptures will keep the gospel central (because the gospel is central the Bible).*
L*earning – Paul expects Timothy to continue to learn and grow as he keeps the gospel central to his life and ministry.*	**L***eaders – training up leaders, those who are FAST (faithful, available, sacrificial and teachable) will keep the gospel central (2 Tim 2:2)*

9.4 'ERA': A FURTHER LOOK AT THE STEPS OF THEOLOGICAL REFLECTION

9.4.1 The word 'ERA' is a simple way to remember the steps

In English the word **'ERA'** is a simple and helpful way of remembering these three steps:

> **E** is for **Encounter**, **R** is for **Reflection**, **A** is for **Action**.

And this way of remembering the steps has real meaning. The word 'era' means a significant period of history. For example, the reign of a king is known as the era of that ruler.

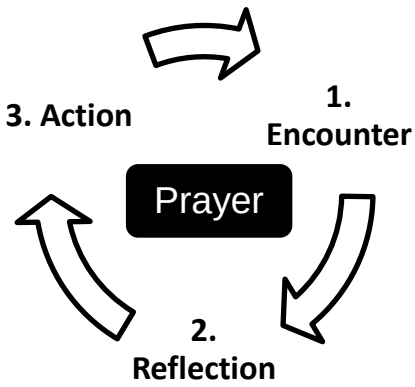
That is why ERA is a helpful way of remembering this cycle: the reason we wrestle with the situations we face in the light of the gospel, and the reason we then return to the often difficult context of God's world in order to take action in a renewed way is to bring about change and transformation.

The change we are seeking is that God's "will be done, on earth as it is in heaven" (Matt 6:10). In other words, the aim of our reflection is to point to God's Kingdom, the new era God is bringing in and through his king Jesus.

9.4.2 The steps of theological reflection as a cycle

Having encountered God's world and God's word we reflect and then act. But as we take action in God's world with the wisdom of God's word we will make fresh discoveries and have new experiences. Those new encounters will deepen our reflection and refine our action.

This means that the three steps of encounter, reflection and action can be understood as steps in a cycle. That cycle is illustrated below.



Prayer lies at the heart of the process because that desire for wisdom must be continuous throughout:

> "If any of you lacks wisdom, you should ask God, who gives generously to all without finding fault, and it will be given to you." (James 1:5)

9.5 EXTRA: THE BUILD LOGIC OF GOSPEL MINISTRY

To close this unit we will link this learning to the word 'BUILD'. In Unit 1 we learnt the meaning of the acronym 'BUILD':

B	is for	**Biblical** …	2 Tim 3:16-17
U	is for	**Understanding** …	2 Tim 2:15
I	is for	**In-service** …	2 Tim 1:8
L	is for	**Leadership** …	2 Tim 2:2
D	is for	**Development** …	2 Tim 3:14

Here we will build on this by seeing that the order in which the letters B – U – I – L – D come can be used to teach an important logic to gospel ministry, a pattern that we have been discovering in this unit.

9.5.1 The order of the letters B – U – I – L – D and the words they represent

First, the order of the letters BUILD and the words they stand for is important. Consider the order they are in below:

1. Biblical
The Bible and its gospel are of immense value
"Scripture..." (2 Tim 3:16-17)

🡻

2. Understanding
We must use it all with great care
"Handles..." (2 Tim 2:15)

🡻

3. In-service
That includes using it in practice in mission
"Reflect..." (2 Tim 2:7)

🡻

4. Leadership
And in passing on true gospel ministry to others
"Entrust..." (2 Tim 2:2)

🡻

5. Development
This is an ongoing commitment
"Continue..." (2 Tim 3:14)

Think about the importance of that order and progression:

> First, the Bible is a great treasure that bears God's authority.
>
> So, second, we must handle it and the glorious gospel it contains, the word of truth, with great care.
>
> Third, following on from that, careful use of Scripture and truth is not simply about preserving the gospel, it is about sharing it and being strengthened by it. The Bible and the word of life it contains are God's gift for a church on a mission.
>
> And, fourth, part of that mission is to pass it on to others: to train trustworthy and true ministers of the gospel.
>
> Fifth and finally, all this is an ongoing process that involves every dimension of our lives: all true teachers of the gospel must continue in what they have learnt and have become convinced of, watching both life and doctrine.

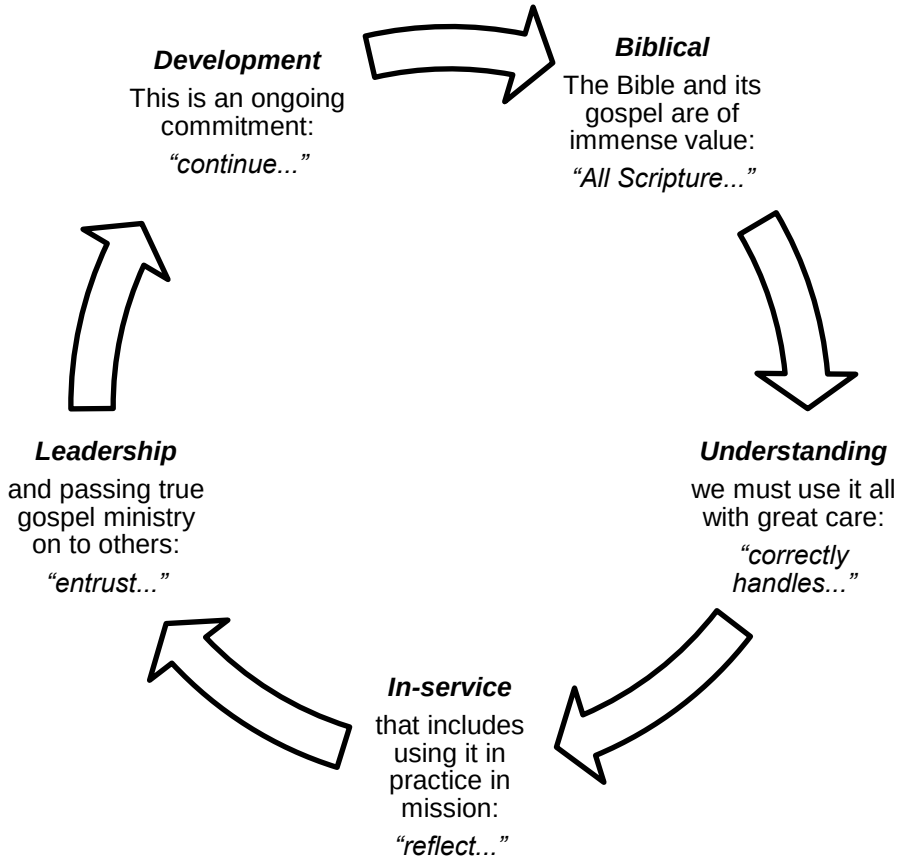
You can emphasise the importance of these elements and this sequence by asking what would be lacking if one or more elements are removed. For example, what happens to church leadership development if we remove the Biblical basis of it? Or try putting them in a different order. For example, what is the impact of putting 'service' before 'understanding'?

9.5.2 The BUILD learning cycle

This order can also be understood as a cycle. If you are going to grow as a leader you must "continue in what you have learnt" (2 Tim 3:14). Therefore it is important to see that the letters 'BUILD' form a cycle of growth and learning. Persevering in the ongoing process of true gospel ministry means the following. We must:

1. Constantly return to Scripture (Biblical)
2. Renew our grasp of the gospel (Understanding)
3. Use the gospel more and more in practice (In-service)
4. Develop ourselves as leaders as we develop others (Leadership)
5. Continue with this, encouraged by the joys and despite the disappointments (Development)

This is illustrated below:



- Read through the cycle and make sure you understand the logic of the steps. Try and explain them to another participant in order to test out and improve your understanding.

- End by explaining to the others in your group which step you find the most challenging, and pray about some of the issues that raises.

Unit 10. 2 Timothy 3:14-17 (Encounter)

This unit applies the lessons of Unit 4 to 2 Timothy 3:14-17. Refer back to previous 'Encountering the Bible' units for learning outline and outcomes.

As with previous units that encounter Bible passages, give the participants an opportunity to apply the steps for themselves and help them with the process.

NOTE: Verses 10-13 provide important background to the passage and the contrast that is made there ("But as for you…"). Do not forget to look at those verses when you 'Set the passage in context'.

10.1 WORKSHEET FOR ENCOUNTERING 2 TIMOTHY 3:14-17 – THE PASSAGE

14 But as for you, continue in what you
have learned and have become
convinced of, because you know those
from whom you learned it, 15 and how
from infancy you have known the Holy
Scriptures, which are able to make you
wise for salvation through faith in Christ
Jesus. 16 All Scripture is God-breathed
and is useful for teaching, rebuking,
correcting and training in
righteousness, 17 so that the servant of
God may be thoroughly equipped for
every good work. (NIV)

Keep trusting the gospel

Keep using the Bible

10.2 WORKSHEET FOR ENCOUNTERING 2 TIMOTHY 3:14-17 – STEP 1

STEP 1: FLESH – study the DETAILS of the text

a) Set the passage in context. How does the passage relate to the book as a whole?

Story: *Connecting with the* ***argument*** *of the book the words "But as for you" (v. 14) links the passage back, again making a contrast with the false teachers (v. 13).*

The passage prepares the way for the charge in 4:1.

Connecting with the ***themes*** *of the book the passage continues with an unusual number of previous themes: e.g. keeping going with true gospel ministry despite the pressures; the genuine nature of Timothy's heritage of faith and relationship to Paul; salvation; teaching etc.*

b) See the details of the text	**c) Seek the meaning from the details**
"continue" (v. 14)	*Keep going despite the difficult times*
"what you have learned" (v. 14)	*The apostolic message, the true gospel*
"and become convinced of" (v. 14)	*Reinforcing the above*
"those from whom" (v. 14)	*Timothy's heritage of faith*
"learned", "learned" (v. 14)	*Repetition – important idea*
"infancy" (v. 15)	*Linking back to his faithful family*
"the holy Scriptures" (v. 15)	*Old Testament (and Jesus' sayings?)*
"wise for salvation" (v. 15)	*Preparation for receiving Christ's rescue*
"through faith in Christ Jesus" (v. 15)	*Received through trusting in Christ*
"able", "useful", "equipped" (vv. 15-17)	*Practical nature of Scripture*
"God breathed" (v. 16)	*From God (and a link to the Spirit's role)*
"teaching, rebuking" (v. 16)	*The first pair focus on teaching truth*
"correcting and training in righteousness"	*The second on godly living*
"All", "thoroughly", "every" (vv. 16-17)	*Completeness of what Scripture brings*
"But as for you" (v. 14)	*Links back and makes a comparison*
"because" (v. 14)	*The reason for sticking with the gospel*
"which" (v. 15)	*Paul will tell Timothy about the Scriptures*
"so that" (v. 17)	*Outcome of using the Scriptures*

d) Summarise the findings. What are the main points that come out of this initial study?

Paul's concern for the gospel and continued gospel ministry continues. This time he again gives reasons for Timothy to be confident. The first is a reminder of what he has said already – his sound heritage of faith, including Paul himself.

The second is an explicit mention of what has been in the background: the reliability of the Scriptures. Paul has and will talk about the Word of God, the gospel. Here he talks about the words of God written, the Scriptures that contain the gospel.

His initial mention of the Scriptures teaches about the relationship between Scripture, salvation and the saviour. It leads to a marvellous discussion of the nature, purpose and impact of Scripture, with an emphasis on its complete sufficiency.

10.3 WORKSHEET FOR ENCOUNTERING 2 TIMOTHY 3:14-17 – STEPS 2 TO 4

STEP 2: SKELETON – outline the STRUCTURE of the text

a) Note all the bones in the structure. What elements highlight the structure?

*The **links** are important too: "But as for you" introduces the section (v. 14). The word "because" (v.14) leads to two reasons for confidence in the gospel. The word "which" leads to an introduction to the Scriptures. "All Scripture" is a link in that the repetition introduces a further reflection on Scripture.*

*The **themes** are important: 1. Continuing in gospel ministry (v. 14); 2. The Character of those who passed the gospel to Timothy (v. 14); 3. Timothy's knowledge of the Scriptures (v. 15); 4. The purpose of Scripture in relation to the gospel (salvation) (v. 15); 5. The nature, purpose and impact of the Scriptures in ministry (vv. 16-17).*

b) Decide on the 'big bones' and make an outline of the structure. What are the most important parts of the structure? Can you describe the main sections?

The themes and the flags suggest three main sections:

1. Verse 14a a further call to remain true to the gospel (Timothy must continue with the apostolic gospel)

2. Verses 14b-15 reasons for Timothy to be steadfast and confident in the gospel (those who taught him and the Scriptures that teach it)

3. Verses 16-17 reasons to be confident in the Scriptures that contain the gospel (their nature, their purpose, and their impact)

STEP 3: HEART – identify the MESSAGE of the text

a) State the theme of the passage. What is the author's main point?

The theme is: steadfast confidence in the gospel

b) Explain the message of the passage. What is the author saying about his theme?

Paul again tells Timothy to continue with the gospel; confident in those who taught him the message of salvation, and confident in the Scriptures that teach the message of salvation.

STEP 4: BRAIN – first, understand the PURPOSE of the text...

a) State the purpose of the passage. Why is the author making his point?

He makes this point to further build up Timothy's understanding and strength for a vital but difficult task in difficult times.

b) Make connections for teaching today. What is the relevance of this for us?

We too are in the 'last days' and must stand firm in the gospel. We are not to be surprised by the pressures around us (which tend to be old pressures in new clothing). We are not to underestimate the power and relevance of the Scriptures.

10.4 RESPONDING TO THE MESSAGE OF 2 TIMOTHY 3:14-17

Here are three simple exercises to do in response to God's word to us in the passage we have just encountered:

1. Describe how the message you discovered in the passage spoke to you personally: What did you learn or need to be reminded of?

2. Share how the purpose of the passage helped you to apply God's word to your life: What change will this passage make to your thinking and living?

3. State and explain the message you will share with others using your own words: What is the main thing you want people to understand?

Unit 11. The Bible and biblical ministry (Reflection)

Overview

This unit flows out of the study of 2 Timothy 3:14-17. It explores the nature and the purpose of the Bible and what that means for ministry in practice. It follows the BUILD ERA model of reflection; the 'Action' component focuses on personal Bible study and prayer.

Outline

- Introduction to the Bible and biblical ministry
- Encountering different views of the Bible
- Reflection to gain wisdom about God's word
- Action flowing from the nature and purpose of Scripture
- Conclusion
- EXTRA: The BUILD modules and the flow of the Bible

Outcomes

By the end of the unit you will be able to

1. Repeat the process of theological reflection learnt in Unit 9
2. Show what 2 Timothy says about the nature and purpose of the Bible
3. Explain how the nature of the Bible relates to its purpose
4. Evaluate the relationship between private and public Bible study and prayer
5. Apply the lessons of Unit 10 to personal Bible study
6. Present a simple pattern of Bible study to others

11.1 INTRODUCTION TO THE BIBLE AND BIBLICAL MINISTRY

The passage we have just encountered contains an important statement about the nature and the purpose of Scripture:

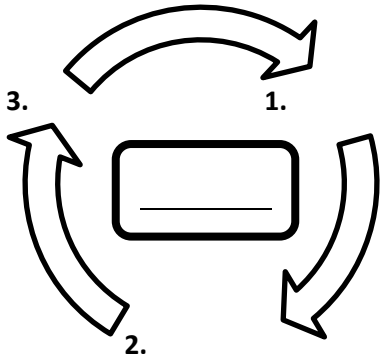
> "All Scripture is God-breathed and is useful for teaching, rebuking, correcting and training in righteousness, so that the servant of God may be thoroughly equipped for every good work." (2 Tim 3:16-17)

The letter 'B' in the word 'BUILD' stands for 'Biblical' and we have already learnt a number of things about the Bible. For example in Unit 2 we learnt that the Bible, God's written word, is the principal and controlling way in which we hear God's voice today. This unit takes this further by looking in more depth at the nature and purpose of the Bible.

Unit 9 introduced some steps of theological reflection:

- What were the three steps and what word helps us to remember them?

- The steps can also be understood as a cycle. Can you fill in the blanks in the diagram below?



The summary table for the three steps of theological reflection is given again below:

Step and description	Definition	Activity	Outcome
Encounter something in God's world and God's word with a desire for wisdom.	To meet something new and surprising	Describe	Discoveries
Reflection on those situations and the Scriptures in order to gain wisdom.	Pause for thought and go deeper	Consider	Principles
Action in God's world with the wisdom that comes from God's word.	Do something new or different	Plan	Practice

Keep returning to this table as you go through the unit.

11.2 ENCOUNTERING DIFFERENT VIEWS OF THE BIBLE

Remember, the first step is to **encounter** something in God's world and/or God's word with a desire for wisdom. In this case it is the issue of the Bible and biblical ministry.

On this occasion we will first encounter our own ideas and those of others around us before encountering God's word on the matter. There are reasons for this. Firstly, it is often easier to describe our own experiences and the experiences of others before looking at the Bible. Secondly, that then naturally prepares us to see what the Bible says by way of connection or contrast.

11.2.1 Encountering different views of the Bible in the world around us

Think first about yourself and the world around you. Put a mirror up to your own life and ministry as well as considering what others are saying and doing and describe your attitudes to the Bible and your understanding of it. These questions will help you:

- Describe some of the things that you hear people saying about the Bible in churches or elsewhere in society.

- What other sources of wisdom and insight do people turn to for direction or help in their lives and ministries?
- What do people mean when they claim that their ministry is 'biblical'?
- How would you describe the place the Bible has in your ministry and the ministry of those around you?

Allow the participants to share directly about the place of the Bible in their own lives and the lives of others. Draw them out on what others are saying, perhaps with the question: "If you went around asking people in your community what they thought about the Bible, how would they answer?" or "What are people saying positively as well as negatively?"

List these positives and negatives. The negatives are particularly important as this unit will address them. Participants might report that people say that the Bible is untrue, unclear, unreliable, irrelevant or that it does not all fit together as a whole, or that they like the New Testament but not the Old Testament.

11.2.2 Encountering what God's word says about the Bible

Now begin to describe what you have been learning in the Pastoral Epistles and the discoveries you have been making, particularly in 2 Timothy. Focus on 2 Timothy 3:14-17 before discussing any other passages that you have noticed on this theme.

- What do you think the Christians in Ephesus were saying about the Scriptures? Defend your answer with evidence from specific chapters and verses.

- What is striking about what 2 Timothy 3:14-17 and other parts of the Pastoral Epistles have to say about the Bible?

- What have you encountered in our studies so far? Begin to describe what the epistles seem to be saying about the Bible.

Guide the participants using some of the questions above. They might take you to other passages such as back to 2 Tim 2:7 and Paul's words there, or to 1 Tim 4:13. Or the Participants might take you to passages that mention 'the word of God', such as 2 Tim 2:9. But try and keep within the Pastoral Epistles for the time being.

11.3 REFLECTION TO GAIN WISDOM ABOUT GOD'S WORD

11.3.1 Considering the issue and developing principles

Remember, the second step is to **reflect** on those situations and the Scriptures in order to gain wisdom. In the discipline of reflection you **consider** your discoveries and develop **principles**, in this case about the Bible and biblical ministry.

Take a step back and **consider** carefully what we have encountered in God's world and God's word. Remember that diagrams, drawings and even maps of a local community can help this process of reflection. You could picture the place of Scripture in the place

and find ways of drawing that. Or you might want to return to the BUILD emblem or logo in Unit 1, section 1. Begin to capture some **principles** that you are learning.

Ask and answer questions such as:

- Why might people have these attitudes and understandings? Note the reasons behind the description and discoveries. Give explanations.
- What light does the gospel, the good news of God's grace, shed on our understanding of the Bible, what it is and what it does? Keep the gospel at the heart of your reflection.
- What Bible passages and themes are particularly relevant as you form principles about the Bible and its place in ministry? List a few Scriptures that are important.
- What pictures come to mind that help you to understand God's perspective on the Bible and its place in ministry? Draw any diagrams or maps that help you to understand what is going on.
- What principles seem to come from this process? List these lessons you are learning.

*Give the participants time to work on this together in groups. Explain that it builds on the last step and is an opportunity to sharpen the issues and allow themes to emerge through some careful observation. Allow them to then share their observations before developing any principles with them. After they have shared, explain that 2 Timothy 3:14-17 tells us about both the **nature** of Scripture and the **purpose** of Scripture. Begin to list the issues people are highlighting, for example:*

- *The inspiration of Scripture*
- *The authority of Scripture*
- *The sufficiency of Scripture*
- *Christ and the Bible*
- *The Bible and Christian ministry*

You might even be able to draw out the fact that there are a number of important relationships that we need to understand. For example:

- *The relationship between God's words and people's words*
- *The relationship between Christ and the Bible*
- *The relationship between the Old Testament and the New Testament*
- *The relationship between Scripture and the Gospel (God's words and God's Word)*

11.3.2 Drawing together some principles about the Bible

Your Trainer will help you to draw some of these ideas together under two headings:

1. The nature of the Bible – "All Scripture is …" (2 Tim 3:16)

2. The purpose of the Bible – "… and is useful for …" (2 Tim 3:16)

Your Trainer will be able to help and guide you in this under those headings.

1. The nature of the Bible

a) Our Bible is God's words through people's words

"All Scripture is God-breathed..." Some translations say "inspired" by God. This does not mean the Bible is an inspiring or exciting story. It is inspirational and exciting but it is so much more than that. "Inspired" means that it is breathed out by God the Holy Spirit. The words we read are God's words. But they are also human words, one and at the same time. Paul commands Timothy to "reflect on what I am saying, for the Lord will give you insight into all this". As we read Paul's writing we become aware that he had a sense that he was speaking God's words. 2 Peter clearly makes that claim when he says this:

> "Bear in mind that our Lord's patience means salvation, **just as our dear brother Paul also wrote you with the wisdom that God gave him**. He writes the same way in all his letters, speaking in them of these matters. His letters contain some things that are hard to understand, which ignorant and unstable people distort, **as they do the other Scriptures**, to their own destruction" (2 Peter 3:15-16).

Paul's words and the words of the other apostles were considered to be God's words. The Bible is God's word through human words. God is the Bible's primary author, but he communicates through human authors. So what?

The Bible is people's words…	**The Bible is God's words…**
Each book of the Bible has a particular historical setting and audience in mind.	The Bible is relevant for all people in all places at all times.
We need to take the context into account and aim to discover the original meaning of any passage for its audience.	We need to handle it carefully, submit to its message and discover the relevance of any passage for us today.
The question of what it **meant** originally is vital.	The question of what it **means** today is equally important.
Explanation is important.	**Application** is important.

b) Our Bible has been formed around Christ the Messiah

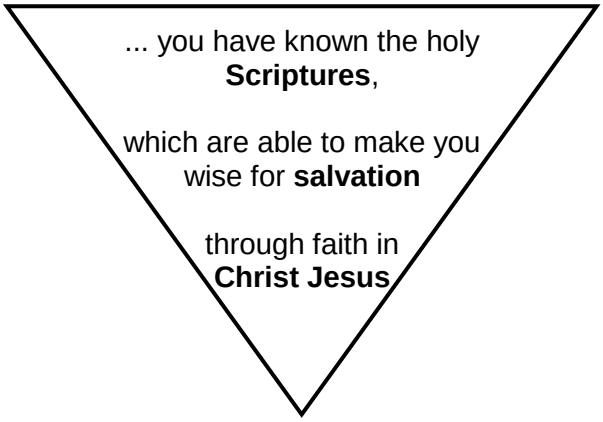
Remember that Paul would not have had the Bible we have today; he was writing parts of the Bible. So how did the Bible come into being? Paul would have had access to the Old Testament Scriptures and some of the early writings about Christ and possibly some letters. Paul asked Timothy to "bring... my scrolls, especially the parchments" in 2 Timothy 4:13.

Because of the nature of the Bible – with Christ and Salvation at the centre – the Bible forms itself around those, as though Christ and the gospel were a magnet.

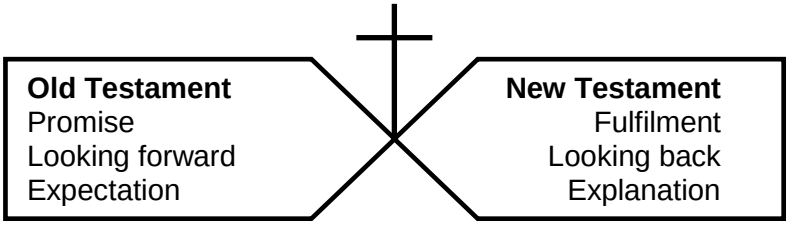
We trust the Bible because we trust Christ himself. He is our starting point and Christ himself trusted the Old Testament Scriptures and referred to them repeatedly (excluding the Apocrypha, which has value but is not Scripture). Jesus then predicted the formation of the New Testament, through the writings of the Apostles, helped by the Holy Spirit. Jesus explains this in John 16:12-15. The church then closed the Bible once all the writings that were clearly Apostolic and that pointed to Christ and the gospel were gathered together.

c) Our Bible links the Scriptures with Salvation and the Saviour
The Bible is the words of God (Scriptures) about the word of God (the gospel) which is all about the Word of God (Christ, the saviour).

2 Timothy 3:15



d) Our Bible links the Old Testament and the New Testament
Building on this, because of the relationship between Scripture and salvation and the Saviour there is a unity to the Bible – both Old Testament and New Testament belong together and are a single story on the single theme of salvation with the one hero, God in Christ. We saw this in Unit 3, point the Participants back to that unit and this simple illustration:



The Old Testament is like a light shining ahead to Christ and the New Testament – Christ and the New Testament only makes sense in the light of the Old Testament.

The New Testament is like a light shining back on Christ and the Old Testament – Christ and the Old Testament only makes sense in the light of the New Testament.

e) Our Bible is sufficient and complete
The outcome of this unity of the Bible, which forms around Christ and the gospel, is that it is complete and sufficient. In the last unit we could not help noticing the words in 2 Tim 3:16 that spoke of the completeness of the Bible:

> "All Scripture is God-breathed and is useful for teaching, rebuking, correcting and training in righteousness, [17]so that the servant of God may be thoroughly equipped for every good work."

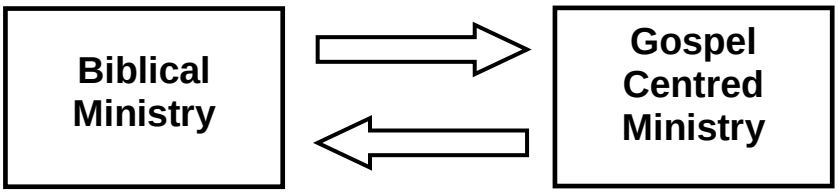
There is no hint that anything else is needed. This is encouraging. Scripture is enough for salvation and for knowing the saviour. Yes, other books are useful, but they are not essential, as we have already noted.

2. The purpose of the Bible

The nature of Scripture leads to its purpose. Just as there are five points we have made about the nature of Scripture (like five fingers on one hand) we can make five points about the purpose of Scripture (like five fingers on another hand). All of these link together.

The nature of Scripture	**The purpose of Scripture**
a) It is God's words through people's words	It directs our preaching and teaching
b) It has Christ at the centre	It points people to Christ
c) It is about salvation and leads to the Saviour	It leads people to be saved through Christ
d) It is formed around Christ and his gospel and teaches that gospel	It preserves the gospel and makes it central
e) It is sufficient in every way	It equips leaders

We have talked about 'Gospel centred ministry' – Biblical ministry is inseparable from Gospel centred ministry. Gospel centred ministry means that we will want to keep rediscovering and rejoicing in the Gospel that the Bible teaches. And the more we look at the Bible the more we will be excited by and driven by the true gospel in presents.



11.4 ACTION FLOWING FROM THE NATURE AND PURPOSE OF SCRIPTURE

Paul tells Timothy that Scripture is *useful*, it is a practical book. But we need to use it according to its nature and purpose, which we have learnt about. We have noted five areas in which it is useful:

a) For preaching and teaching

b) For pointing people to Christ

c) For leading people to salvation

d) For keeping the gospel central

e) For equipping leaders

All five are connected together in different ways. One way is that the first four feed into the last, “so that the servant of God may be thoroughly equipped for every good work” (2 Tim 3:17).

And that includes taking the nature and purpose of Scripture very seriously in our own lives. We must be equipped by the word if we are to equip others from the word; we need to watch our own “life and doctrine closely” (1 Tim 4:16).

The rest of this unit will focus on our own, personal, study of Scripture and the prayer that belongs with it.

11.4.1 Personal Bible study and prayer

Discuss these questions:

- Is Christian ministry a profession or a vocation? In other words, to what extent is our ministry a position we hold in the church and how much is it about God’s calling on our lives? At what points do you feel a sense of conflict between your position as a church leader and your personal call to serve God?

- It is all too easy for church leaders to be so busy feeding others from God’s word that they starve themselves. Have you ever felt like that? How did it come to that point and how have you been able to change the situation?

The life-giving message is not simply something to be passed on and taught. Timothy must live by the Bible and benefit from its gospel and teaching. For example, he also says, “You then, my son, be strong in the grace that is in Christ Jesus” (2 Tim 2:1).

The Pastoral Epistles have a great deal to say about the disciplines of Bible study and prayer, both public and private, and Paul links those disciplines to Timothy’s own spiritual health as well as to the health of the local church.

- In groups ‘skim read’ 1 Timothy and 2 Timothy and note where Paul talks directly or indirectly about Bible study and prayer, both in public and in private.
  (To ‘skim read’ means to cast your eye quickly down the text in order to spot these ideas.)
  Begin with 1 Timothy and focus on 1 Tim 2:1-8; 1 Tim 3:1-10; 1 Tim 4:6-16.
  If you have time go back to 2 Timothy and look at 2 Tim 1:13-14; 2 Tim 2:1-7, 14-15, 22-26; 2 Tim 3:14-17; and 2 Tim 4:1-5.

- As you do this, fill in the table below using those discoveries, noting down some verses and the ideas they contain.

1. Public use of the Bible	**2. Public Prayer**
1 Tim 4:13 *2 Timothy 4:1-5*	*1 Tim 2:1-2, 8*
3. Private use of the Bible	**4. Private Prayer**
1 Tim 3:9 *1 Tim 4:5* *1 Tim 4:6* *1 Tim 4:16* *2 Tim 2:7* *2 Tim 3:15-17*	*1 Tim 4:5* *2 Tim 1:14*

Both Bible study and prayer are essential for our spiritual health. But what we do publicly should be an expression of what we do privately, on our own before God. Read 1 Tim 4:6 again, which makes the link between our private faith and our public ministry. Our public prayer and study must flow from a genuine personal experience. Jesus tells us not to be hypocrites (Matt 6:5-15).

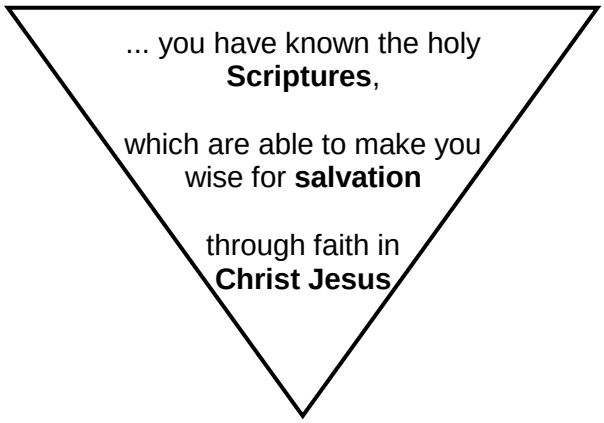
- To what extent is that true of your life and the life of others in your group? Be honest with one another and before God and end any discussion in prayer.

11.4.2 Studying the Bible according to the nature of the Bible

What we learnt in the last unit about the Bible and biblical ministry will help us to study the Bible in private as well as in public.

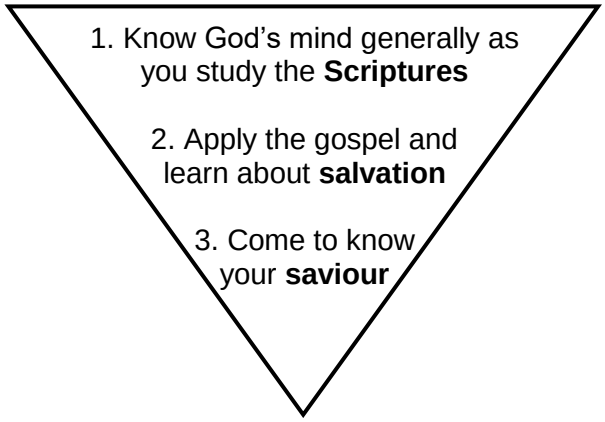
For example, we noticed the relationship between Scripture, Salvation and the Saviour.

2 Timothy 3:15



That means that we need to study the Bible with those three elements in mind. We need to ‘go with the grain’ and study Scripture in the way that God has designed it to be studied (just as we saw that a sculptor uses the grain within the wood he is working on). As you read the Bible for yourself and for your own encouragement bear in mind these three things:

2 Timothy 3:15



In John's gospel Jesus commands us to take all three steps through this warning to the religious leaders of his day:

> "You study the Scriptures diligently because you think that in them you have eternal life. These are the very Scriptures that testify about me, yet you refuse to come to me to have life" (John 5:39-40).

- How can we make sure that our own study of the Scriptures lead to salvation in and through Jesus?

- Look back at the last unit and note how other aspects of the nature and purpose of the Bible can help you to study it and receive God's grace through it.

11.4.3 A pattern for personal Bible study

The principles we have been learning for encountering the Bible apply to personal Bible study and prayer too. But it is helpful to have a simple way of approaching the Bible on a daily basis to hear from God. The more we study the Bible in depth for public ministry the more it will help us to hear God's word in private; and the more we hear God's voice in private, the more it will empower our public preaching.

Here is one simple pattern to follow, which can apply to any passage of Scripture. Again it uses the word 'GOSPEL' to help us to remember it, and as such it is a way of preaching the gospel to ourselves day by day:

G is for **God**
As you meditate on a Bible passage look first for what it teaches about **God**. Focus particularly on God's character, beginning with his might and majesty.

O is for **Ourselves**
The Bible also tells us the truth about **ourselves**. It is a mirror in which we see our own brokenness. Look for ways in which the passage shows up your sinfulness, as well as any signs of God's love for you.

S is for **Salvation**
Turn to note anything that points us to our **salvation** in Christ Jesus. These might be truths that lead you to Christ's saving work on the cross.

P is for **Promise**
There may be indicators of the **promise** of the God's Holy Spirit and his grace and gifts for us today. Truths about the work of the promised Holy Spirit can bring us assurance of all that God has done for us.

E is for **Eternity**
The passage may point you to **eternity**, to the life of the world to come, or to Christ's return and his future judgement. If it does, it is important to take that perspective into your day.

L is for **Life**
Finally apply all this to your **life** today. Look for commands to obey, examples to follow, warnings to heed, or promises you can hold on to. Apply the message to your hopes and fears for the day.

- Practise this approach now as a group on a passage from the Pastoral Epistles. Take Titus 3:3-8 for example.

Here are some other practical suggestions:

1. Use lectionary readings for this discipline, and select a short passage to reflect on. This provides a balanced diet.

2. Use a notebook and pen so that you can concentrate and develop ideas.

3. Write down and memorise a key verse in the text to take into the day.

4. Imagine someone asking you what God has said to you from his word today. How would you answer them?

- Share other ideas in your group to help one another to feed from the Scriptures.

11.4.4 Praying from the word

There is no better moment to pray than as you study the Bible or straight after you have finished. As God speaks to you, respond in prayer. Many people find the acronym 'ACTS' a helpful one to use.

A is for **Adoration**. Turn what you have learnt about the Lord into praise.

C is for **Confession**. That will automatically lead to the confession of sin.

T is for **Thanksgiving**. First for your salvation, as you continue to preach the gospel to yourself, and then for the many other blessings God has given you.

S is for **Supplication**. 'Supplication' means to ask for something, we can end by laying our requests before God.

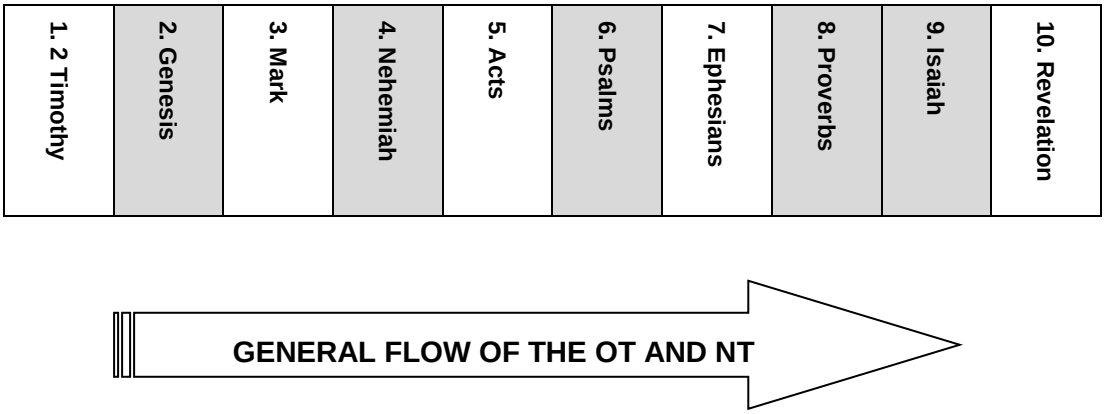
11.5 CONCLUSION

There is an extra section below that not only reinforces what we have been learning, but also explains the flow of the modules in the BUILD curriculum. You might like to cover that now, or return to it later.

Whatever you decide to do, pause and close your main time together by turning some of the key things you have learnt into prayer, using the 'ACTS' pattern above. For example, you might have new things to adore God for, now you have understood the wonder of his word. Give time to prayer.

11.6 EXTRA: THE BUILD MODULES AND THE FLOW OF THE BIBLE

As an extra for personal or group study: one practical way in which the shape of the Bible is used in BUILD is in shaping its curriculum. The way the modules have been arranged is designed to teach some of the principles taught above. The modules follow the flow of the Bible and this is illustrated using the key books the modules are based around:



- What else do you notice about the arrangement of the books? What might this achieve?

In relation to the structure of the Bible, the modules move forward through the Bible but also alternate between modules that focus on the NT and those that focus on the OT. This is in order to help us to develop an understanding of the important relationship between the New Testament and the Old Testament.

- Are there any exceptions to this? Your Trainer will help to point these out and explain them.

The exception to that rule are the last two modules, which reverse that order: Module 9 looks at Isaiah and the Prophets and provides a foundation for Module 10 – Revelation and Apocalyptic which completes the curriculum.

The modules tend to work through the OT and the NT sequentially. The movement through the OT is from Genesis and the historical books, through Psalms and Wisdom and on to the Prophets. Similarly the NT begins with the gospels, Acts, Epistles and ends in Revelation. The exception is Module One, which takes 2 Timothy and the Pastoral Epistles: they make for a sound introduction to all the modules.

Unit 12. 2 Timothy 4:1-5 (Encounter)

This unit applies the lessons of Unit 4 to 2 Timothy 4:1-5. Refer back to previous 'Encountering the Bible' units for the learning outline and outcomes.

This unit again applies the skills that Participants were introduced to in Unit 3. Give the Participants an opportunity to apply the steps themselves, individually or in groups.

By now the Participants should be able to work more independently as individuals or as small groups. You may want them to give time to the whole process and then give time for different groups or individuals to present their findings. You might want one group to present the 'flesh', one group the 'skeleton' etc.

12.1 INTRODUCTION

In this unit you will again apply the lessons of Unit 4 to another, slightly longer passage from 2 Timothy (4:1-5). Keep referring back to the four steps in that unit. By now you should be able to work more independently and be able to identify the parts of the process that you need more help with.

Spend time looking at the text on the next page. Do not forget to read it out loud several times so that you get a feel for it. It is a particularly important passage in 2 Timothy; allow God to speak to you through it.

Use a notepad to write the passage out and record observations and work on these before marking the text in this work book, which you will want to keep for reference.

Your Trainer will help you and guide you through this process.

12.2 WORKSHEET FOR ENCOUNTERING 2 TIMOTHY 4:1-5 – THE PASSAGE

4 In the presence of God and of Christ Jesus, who will judge the living and the dead, and in view of his appearing and his kingdom, I give you this charge: **2** preach the word; be prepared in season and out of season; correct, rebuke and encourage – with great patience and careful instruction. **3** For the time will come when people will not put up with sound doctrine. Instead, to suit their own desires, they will gather round them a great number of teachers to say what their itching ears want to hear. **4** They will turn their ears away from the truth and turn aside to myths. **5** But you, keep your head in all situations, endure hardship, do the work of an evangelist, discharge all the duties of your ministry. (NIV)

A solemn Setting

A Serious Charge

A challenging Context

An important responsibility

12.3 WORKSHEET FOR ENCOUNTERING 2 TIMOTHY 4:1-5 – STEP 1

STEP 1: FLESH – study the DETAILS of the text

a) Set the passage in context. How does the passage relate to the book as a whole?

Story: Connections with the **argument** of the book? *The passage builds on everything that has gone before, not least the platform the Scriptures give for gospel ministry. It leads on to the reason for the appeal in v. 6: "For I am..." (Paul is at the end of his ministry and is passing on the baton – it is his final, summary appeal).*

Connections with the **themes** of the book? *The same appeal to teach the true gospel as a true servant of the gospel is brought to a conclusion. This is set against the theme of the false teachers and the testing times Timothy is in.*

b) See the details of the text.	**c) Seek the meaning from the details**
List the important words, phrases, and relationships	Explain the important words, phrases, and relationships
"In the presence of God and of Christ Jesus" (v. 1)	*Awareness of the invisible reality of the living God (note how Christ and God are viewed)*
"judge the living and the dead" (v. 1)	*Accountability emphasised*
"his appearing and his kingdom" (v. 1)	*Certainty of Christ's return and reign*
"charge" (v. 1)	*Commission, task, responsibility*
"Preach the Word" (v. 2)	*Proclaim the gospel message*
"in season and out of season" (v. 2)	*Whether convenient or not*
"correct, rebuke and encourage—with great patience..." (v. 2)	*Links back with 3:16 (using the reliable word of God)*
"the time will come" (v. 3)	*Emphasis again on "the last days" (3:1)*
"teachers" (v. 3)	*The false teachers*
"sound doctrine", "the truth" (vv. 3-4)	*Links with what Timothy has "learned" (3:14)*
"own desires", "itching ears", "their ears" (vv. 3-4)	*People will prefer their own message rather than God's message and messenger*
"keep your head", "endure hardship" (v. 5)	*Remain true despite the pressures*
"the work of an evangelist" (v. 5)	*Another way to say "Preach the Word"*
"discharge all the duties" (v. 5)	*Call to disciplined hard work*
"this charge... Preach" (vv.1-2)	*Relates the setting to the charge*
"For" (v. 3)	*Gives a reason for such a stand*
"But you" (v. 5)	*A strong comparison is made*

d) Summarise the findings. What are the main points that come out of this initial study?

Paul's constant theme of true gospel ministry underlies his charge.

Building on what has been said about the confidence Timothy can have in the Scriptures, Paul re-commissions him as a servant of the gospel.

The holy presence of God the king provides the setting for the command to announce and proclaim the message of God. Opposition to that gospel provides the setting for his ministry and the call to persevere in it.

12.4 WORKSHEET FOR ENCOUNTERING 2 TIMOTHY 4:1-5 – STEPS 2 TO 4

STEP 2: SKELETON – outline the STRUCTURE of the text

a) Note all the bones in the structure. What elements highlight the structure?

Links

"In the presence" flags up the introduction (v. 1). The end of v. 1 and the beginning of v. 2 marks a change. The word "For" introduces an important section (v. 3). "Instead" (v. 3) indicates an explanation. "But you" (v. 5) begins the conclusion.

Themes

1. The reminder of the presence and majesty of God (v. 1); 2. The fact that Paul is summarising his call to Timothy (v. 1); 3. The charge itself and how it is to be carried out (v. 2); 4. The context Timothy is to work in (v. 3-4); 5. The contrasting work of the false teachers (v. 3-4); 6. Set against that the determined ministry Timothy must exercise (v. 3-4).

b) Decide on the 'big bones' and make an outline of the structure. What are the most important parts of the structure? Can you describe the main sections?

The ideas and flags suggest four main sections:

1. Verse 1 – an introduction: a solemn setting for Paul's charge to Timothy

2. Verses 2 – the focal point: the serious charge itself, to proclaim the message of the gospel

3. Verses 3-4 – a longer explanation of the situation: the challenging context of people who prefer false teaching

4. Verse 5 – a concluding section: underlining the responsibility Timothy has been given

STEP 3: HEART – identify the MESSAGE of the text

a) State the theme of the passage. What is the author's main point?

The theme is Paul's command to proclaim and to teach the true gospel

b) Explain the message of the passage. What is the author saying about his theme?

Paul reminds Timothy of the importance of proclaiming and teaching the true gospel in the light of God's coming judgment and the challenging context he faces

STEP 4: BRAIN – first, understand the PURPOSE of the text...

a) State the purpose of the passage. Why is the author making his point?

The clue to the purpose is in v. 6 "For I am...". Paul is passing on the baton of gospel ministry, which is of utmost importance

b) Make connections for teaching today. What is the relevance of this for us?

We too have a clear work to do and we need to think through how to carry out the proclamation of the gospel in the situation we are in. We too face discouragement from the lack of visible, tangible results. The invisible presence of God and the importance of the work must lead us to translate all this into relevant patterns of single-mindedness and persistence.

12.5 RESPONDING TO THE MESSAGE OF 2 TIMOTHY 4:1-5

Here are three simple exercises to do in response to God's word to us in the passage we have just encountered:

1. Describe how the message you discovered in the passage spoke to you personally: What did you learn or need to be reminded of?

2. Share how the purpose of the passage helped you to apply God's word to your life: What change will this passage make to your thinking and living?

3. State and explain the message you will share with others using your own words: What is the main thing you want people to understand?

Unit 13. How to preach a Bible passage (Action)

Overview

We have seen throughout that 2 Timothy emphasises the central place of the Bible (the words of God) and its gospel (the Word of God). It is essential that anyone who leads, teaches and cares for a congregation is able to "preach the Word" (2 Tim 4:2), as we have just seen in Unit 12.

This unit builds on that unit, but also on Unit 3, where you learnt how to discover the original message of a passage of Scripture, and is designed to provide steps to help you to preach or teach that message today.

These steps are essential to the BUILD curriculum and will be used throughout as we constantly move from texts to teaching those texts.

Outline

- Introducing expository preaching
- Completing the 'Scripture Sculpture' process
- The steps of preaching a passage applied to 2 Tim 1:6-7
  STEP 4: BRAIN – state the PURPOSE of the sermon
  STEP 5: HEART – form the MESSAGE of the sermon
  STEP 6: SKELETON – create the STRUCTURE of the sermon
  STEP 7: FLESH – develop the DETAILS of the sermon
- Conclusion: Pulling it all together

Outcomes

By the end of the unit you will be able to

1. Explain how Unit 13 relates to Unit 3
2. Outline the steps of preaching a passage of Scripture
3. Demonstrate how to follow the steps of preaching
4. Evaluate sermons using some simple steps

13.1 INTRODUCING EXPOSITORY PREACHING

13.1.1 Your own experience of preaching

- What are the components of a strong and effective sermon? Think back to some of the best preaching you have heard.

- What makes for a weak and poor sermon? Think back to some of the worst preaching you have heard.

13.1.2 What is expository preaching and why is it important?

- Discuss this question together. There are different kinds or types of sermon, can you think of any different sorts of sermon? What are the strengths and weaknesses of each?

Guide the participants as they think about the different types of sermons preachers preach. Some are topical and explore a particular theme or issue. Some are evangelistic: they explain the good news and call people to repentance and faith. Some are biographical: they look at the life of an individual in the Bible. Still others doctrinal: they take a particular truth and see what the Bible has to say about it.

Different types of preaching can have a place in the life of the church. But we have seen from the Pastoral Epistles that all preaching must be the explanation and application of Scripture, the Gospel, and Jesus Christ at the centre. This means that there is a foundational or fundamental type of preaching, which is often called **expository preaching**.

Some people think expository preaching is a style of preaching, one in which the preacher works through the verses in a passage systematically. Expository preaching might or might not involve that method, because expository preaching is not a style of preaching but is an approach to preaching. The word ‘expository’ describes the foundation, basis or underlying theory of preaching.

- How many sermons have you heard in which the preacher takes a verse of Scripture and then uses it as an opportunity to say whatever he wants to say?

The aim of expository preaching is to **expose** the message of a passage. It is based on a belief that the Bible is God’s word and that God speaks through it. We need to simply allow the Bible to speak freely on its own terms, rather than to **impose** our own message on the passage and then on our people. The job of the preacher is simply to let the Bible to do the talking, and to trust that God will speak as he reveals and applies the message of the Bible to our lives today, by his Holy Spirit.

We must not impose our understanding on the Bible, but expository preaching does take the nature and purpose of the Bible into account. In units 9, 10 and 11 we saw the link between **Scripture**, **Salvation**, and the **Saviour**. Scripture has Salvation as its subject and the Saviour as its focus. Expository preaching follows this pattern: we must preach the Bible in the way the Bible is designed to be preached. That makes it a far more exciting and rewarding way to preach. It is like crafting a sculpture out of wood, and going with the grain of the wood rather than going against it, which is messy and hard work. And just as the master craftsman sees a design within the wood, we see God’s design in the passage.

Another way of thinking about this is the link between 2 Timothy Chapter 3 and 2 Timothy Chapter 4. Chapter three ends with the Scriptures as the foundation for gospel ministry; Chapter four begins with the charge to preach the gospel. Paul assumes a link between the two – the gospel is preached and Christ is honoured as the Bible is taught.

This also means that expository preaching can evangelise those who are not Christians and encourage those who are – because it constantly teaches the gospel that saves us and which also builds us up. In other words evangelistic preaching is not simply one type

of preaching for those who do not yet believe, and expository preaching is another sort for Christians. Expository preaching can be evangelistic, or encouraging, or both.

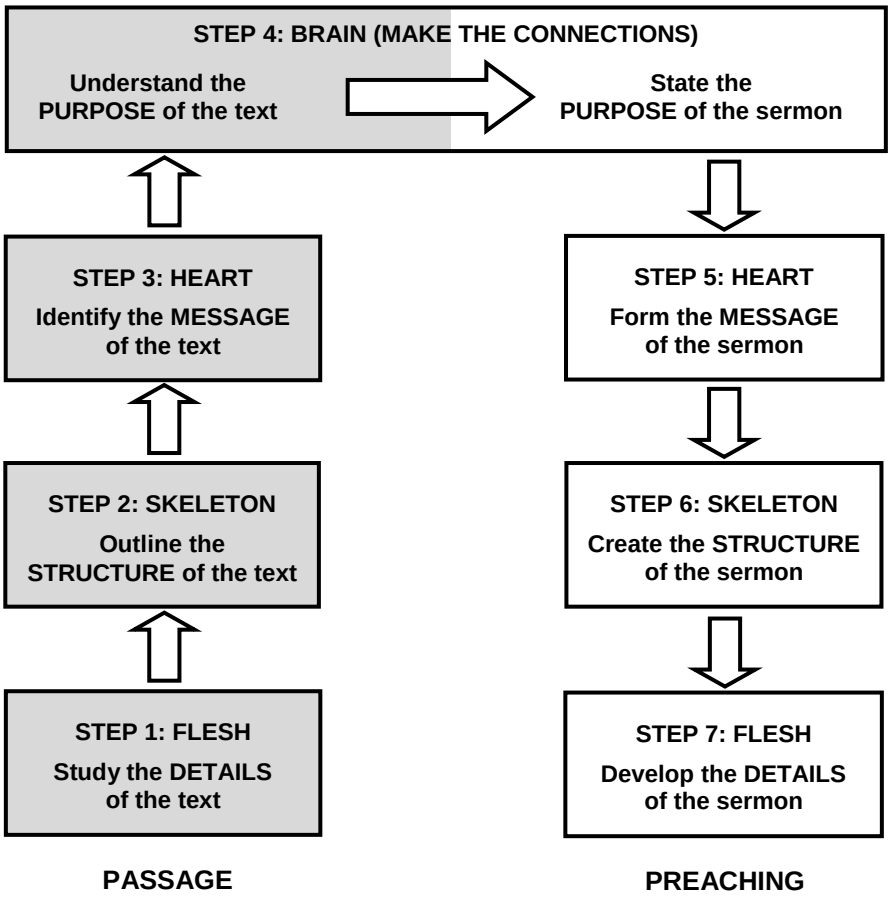
13.2 COMPLETING THE 'SCRIPTURE SCULPTURE' PROCESS

The 'Scripture Sculpture process', which we began to look at in Unit 4, helps us to prepare expository sermons. The process is called 'Scripture Sculpture' because understanding and preaching the Bible is an art: it is the process of taking what God has given us and using that to shape and influence every aspect of a sermon.

In Unit 4 we looked at the first steps of this process: how to **discover** what God has said to his people, a process which we called 'How to encounter a passage of the Bible'. In this unit we will complete the steps by looking at 'How to preach a passage of the Bible', and be able to **declare** what God is saying to his people today.

13.2.1 The seven steps of the Scripture Sculpture process

The whole Scripture Sculpture process is illustrated below, with the steps we have already used to encounter passages of the Pastoral Epistles shaded in grey:



This unit begins at the top of the diagram by extending Step 4 to form a bridge to connect with today's world. It then continues down the right hand side: from the BRAIN of the

sermon to the HEART of the sermon to the SKELETON of the sermon to the FLESH of the sermon.

- Learn, memorise and explain the logic to someone else using these key words:

PASSAGE
flesh → skeleton → heart → brain → heart → skeleton → flesh
SERMON

13.2.2 A review of our encounter with 2 Tim 1:6-7

When we come to look at the four steps of preaching a passage of the Bible in detail we will use the same text we studied in Unit 4, which is 2 Tim 1:6-7. We need to review what we have learnt so far in Unit 4 when we encountered that text. This is what we discovered:

STEP 1: FLESH – Study the DETAILS of the text

In 2 Tim 1:6-7 we saw that:

- Paul is convinced that Timothy's faith in Christ is genuine.
- Because of this confidence Paul reminds Timothy to do something important. Timothy must renew his confidence in God and his gifts.
- The greatest gift of all is that of God's Holy Spirit with us. He is powerful, loving and self-disciplined.

STEP 2: SKELETON – Outline the STRUCTURE of the text

In 2 Tim 1:6-7 we noted:

1. The **introduction** to confidence in God and his gifts: Timothy can be confident in his faith (v. 6a) because Paul has already assured him it is "sincere" (v. 5).
2. The **command** to renew confidence in God and his gifts: Timothy can be confident that he has the God-given gifts for ministry, therefore he must rekindle them (v. 6b).
3. The **reason** to renew confidence in God and his gifts: God's Spirit is committed and resilient, and we have the presence of this confidence building Spirit in our lives (v. 7).

STEP 3: HEART – Identify the MESSAGE of the text

In 2 Tim 1:6-7 we discovered that:

- The theme is, Renewing confidence in God and his gifts for ministry.
- The message from Paul to Timothy is to renew his confidence in God and his gifts for ministry.

STEP 4: BRAIN – Understand the PURPOSE of the text

In 2 Tim 1:6-7 we realised that:

- Paul tells Timothy to renew his confidence in God and his gifts because he is facing an urgent and demanding task, one that he cannot overcome with his own abilities and strength.

We began to make connections and asked this question:

- In the face of all the daily demands and difficulties we face, how can we renew our confidence in God and his gifts for ministry?

13.2.3 The steps of preaching a Bible passage in outline

The table below gives the outcome of each main step, and also breaks that step down into manageable parts for you.

STEP 4: BRAIN – B) State the PURPOSE of the sermon At the end of this step you will be able to state and explain the purpose of the sermon. You need to: a) Keep your **listeners** in mind b) Decide what God wants your people to **understand and obey** c) State the **purpose** of the sermon
STEP 5: HEART – form the MESSAGE of the sermon At the end of this step you will be able to state and explain the message of the sermon in one or two sentences. You need to: a) State the **theme** of your sermon b) Build on that and state the **message** of your sermon c) **Check** that the message 'works' for your people today
STEP 6: SKELETON – create the STRUCTURE of the sermon At the end of this step you will have a clear outline for the sermon. You need to: a) Clarify the **main points** or structure of the sermon b) Create an **introduction** c) Develop the **body** d) Have an idea for the **conclusion**
STEP 7: FLESH – develop the DETAILS of the sermon At the end of this step you can preach the sermon to your people. You need to: a) Remember the importance of **words** b) Create **notes** that will help you to preach c) Use your **voice** to communicate d) Take care with **presentation** e) Remember the importance of **evaluation**

13.3 THE STEPS OF PREACHING A PASSAGE APPLIED TO 2 TIM 1:6-7

13.3.1 STEP 4: BRAIN – state the PURPOSE of the sermon

At the end of this step you will be able to explain the purpose of your sermon to someone.

> **Remember:** The purpose statement acts as a bridge in the process of teaching the passage today. Once you know why the text is in the Bible – what it is there to achieve – you can develop a purpose for your sermon or teaching.

It is important to have a clear purpose for the sermon for a number of reasons. Adapting and building on Ramesh Richard:

- **The purpose** can help you to establish and form the sermon's heart.
- **The purpose** can help with the sermon's introduction.
- **The purpose** helps you decide what to include and what to leave out.
- **The purpose** guides the application and conclusion of the sermon.
- **The purpose** helps you to evaluate the sermon.
- **The purpose** gives you a sense of purpose as you preach the sermon.

We have already begun on this step because we have come to **understand the PURPOSE of the text**. In Unit 4 we discovered this purpose for 2 Tim 1:6-7:

- Paul tells Timothy to renew his confidence in God and his gifts because he is facing an urgent and demanding task, one that he cannot overcome with his own abilities and strength.

We took that a step further and began to **translate it into the PURPOSE of the sermon**. In Unit 4 we began to build a bridge and to make some connections with our own context today. That led to the purpose expressed as a question:

- In the face of all the daily demands and difficulties we face, how can we renew our confidence in God and his gifts for ministry?

That is a good general statement of purpose for a sermon based on 2 Tim 1:6-7. Because of the nature of 2 Timothy. But it will need to be tailored for most situations and congregations. You need to learn **how to create a purpose statement for your listeners**.

a) Keep your listeners in mind

We must keep our listeners in mind. Pray for your listeners in the light of the passage. We need to consider their needs and situations. Real sermons are not abstract lectures. As you learn to preach in the BUILD group that must also be the case. Think about a sermon you will preach on Sunday to your congregation. Or think about what you would say if you were to speak to your BUILD group: imagine that your fellow BUILD participants are your congregation.

b) Consider what God wants your listeners to know and obey

Ask and answer this question, in the light of the Bible passage: What does God want my listeners to know and obey?

As you do so, continue to reflect on the heart of the text, its theme and message. That theme was confidence for ministry. And the message to Timothy was that he can be confident that he has everything he needs for his ministry: the gifts of the Spirit and the gift of the Spirit. And it is vital to be guided by the brain of the text, its purpose, which is to renew confidence in God and his gifts for ministry.

It may help to complete these two statements:

> God wants my listeners to know this truth:…
>
> And, God wants my listeners to obey that truth in these ways:…

You can then combine those statements.

- Work together now on answering the question, What does God want my listeners to know and to obey?

The answer to that question for a 'congregation' of BUILD Participants could be this: God wants my listeners to know that they can continue gospel ministry with confidence, knowing that God's Spirit will help and equip them. And God wants them to obey that truth by relying on him in prayer and by refusing to shrink back from their responsibility to proclaim the gospel.

c) State the purpose of the sermon

That statement comes from turning your answers above into a single statement, beginning with these words: "The purpose of my sermon is..."

- Turn your thinking into a single statement of your sermon's purpose. Begin that statement with these words: "The purpose of my sermon is..."

For example: The purpose of the sermon is to encourage BUILD Participants to keep going with gospel ministry confident in the presence of God's Spirit and his gifts, and to translate that into action.

CHURCH HEALTH WARNING: If you do not know what your sermon's purpose is, DO NOT PREACH IT! In other words do not preach unless you know why you are preaching!

13.3.2 STEP 5: HEART – form the MESSAGE of the sermon

At the end of this step you will be able to state and explain the theme and message of the sermon in one or two sentences.

> **Remember:** You can use the heart of the passage, together with the brain and connections you have begun to make, to form the heart of your sermon – the message or main point you will communicate.

a) State the theme of your sermon

This may well flow from the brain of the sermon. The theme of the sermon is simply your main point, the main thing you are talking about, your subject.

- Building on your purpose statement, what will you be talking about?

The theme can be given as a simple statement: 'How to keep going with gospel ministry.' Or it can be explored in the form of a question: 'How can we keep going with gospel ministry?'

b) Build on that and state the message of your sermon

The message of your sermon is what you will be saying about that theme. In other words, what will you be saying about what you are talking about?

- Can you develop a message from that theme, which is faithful to 2 Tim 1:6-7?

For example the message could be: 'We can keep going with gospel ministry because God has given us the gift and gifts of the Spirit.'

c) Check that the message 'works' for your people today

This means thinking a bit more about your audience and their situation. Think about the words: are they simple, clear and alive? Will the heart of my sermon get to the heart of this group of people? Is the message memorable?

- Rework and restate the message of the sermon if necessary.

Discuss this and see if you can improve on the message for your context. For example, it might mean reworking it a little: Encouraged to keep going. Empowered by the Spirit. Empowered for gospel work.

13.3.3 STEP 6: SKELETON – create the STRUCTURE of the sermon

At the end of this step you will have a clear outline for the sermon.

> **Remember:** The purpose and message of your sermon will help you to create the structure of the sermon.
>
> This form may be different to the structure of the passage, but it will always draw on it and be guided by it.

a) Clarify the main points or structure of the sermon

The structure must serve the purpose, the message, the explanation of the passage and the audience. It can be informed by the passage, but remember that the structure of the passage was designed to communicate the message to the original audience and it may or may not be the best form for your people today.

The skeleton of the passage may provide a general guide. For example, when teaching proverbs, it might be appropriate to make some short memorable statements that work as proverbs for today. Or if you are looking at a biblical story, it might be appropriate to simply use the story, or a similar story, as a framework.

It might be that in the passage:

- There are 3 ideas you can use as a structure
- There are 2 questions it asks
- There are 4 steps it encourages people to take
- There is a contrast it makes that can shape your sermon
- There are 4 emotions it communicates
- There are 3 ways it makes the same point
- There is a puzzle to be solved – you can (1) state the puzzle, (2) solve the puzzle, (3) apply the puzzle and solution to our lives

- Can you list other possibilities?

- How would you structure a sermon on 2 Timothy 1:6-7? Give an outline below:

The body of our sermon on 2 Timothy 1:6-7 could be shaped around the two areas:
1) Confidence in the Spirit's gifts
2) Confidence in the Spirit's presence

b) Develop the body

Developing the body of the talk often means thinking through how those points will be made. This usually means the following:

- Stating a point clearly
- Explaining a point simply
- Illustrating a point to shed light on it
- Applying a point to the lives of the listeners
- Linking that point on to the next one or into the conclusion

Good application is important, and will be guided by the message and purpose you have given the sermon. Preachers tend to give too little thought and time to this area. Prayer is important throughout sermon preparation, but it is particularly important when it comes to application. We will build on these areas throughout the curriculum but we must:

1) Encourage <u>repentance and faith</u>
The biblical pattern for transformation is through **repentance** and **faith**. That means turning away from sinful thoughts, words, deeds and habits, and turning to Christ and walking in his way. Both must be held together. Repentance without faith is moralistic. Faith without repentance is hollow.

We need to encourage people to turn away from wrong thinking and wrong living, and to embrace Christ's way. Encouraging them to embrace Christ's way must point them to the liberating message of the cross, and the encouraging presence and power of the Spirit.

2. Engage <u>mind, heart and will</u>
Applications can include challenges that change people's thinking. But they must also include ways of changing people's character and behaviour.

c) Create an introduction

An introduction grabs and holds the listeners attention, taking them from their world of distractions and concerns, and into the world of the Bible and the sermon. Therefore it should relate to both those worlds: the world of the listener and the world of the Bible.

- It might be a story that leads into the purpose of the sermon and the passage of the bible.

- It could be a question that is relevant to the listener and which the passage answers.

The BRAIN of the sermon will be particularly helpful here.

- What introduction might work for our sermon on 2 Tim 1:6-7?

It could simply be these introductory questions which are raised by the BRAIN of the sermon: Given all the pressures on us in gospel ministry, why should we have any confidence as pastors and how can we have any confidence? Our passage is designed to answer just that question.

d) Have an idea for the conclusion

A good conclusion is also important, and tends to be neglected. The conclusion takes the listener back into their world, and, when part of corporate worship, into the rest of the service.

- It might be a summary of the sermon, but it should not simply be that
- It might be a fresh twist that reinforces the point
- It might lead back to the introduction and build on that
- It might be a set of applications that lead to specific prayer or prayer ministry

- How would you conclude our sermon on 2 Tim 1:6-7?

One helpful conclusion could simply to be to remind pastors that if they have turned from their sins and embraced Christ, then the Spirit of Christ is surely with them and will not leave them – they can rely on his strength and gifts for ministry (which is his ministry after all). But it is also an opportunity to challenge those who may never have truly turned to Christ or those whose love for Christ has cooled, with a call to repent and turn to Christ and to be renewed in faith and begin afresh in confidence.

13.3.4 STEP 7: FLESH – develop the DETAILS of the sermon

At the end of this step you can preach the sermon to your people.

> **Remember:** You can finally put some flesh and skin on the bones and create the sermon. Ask God to breathe his Spirit into the message and you, his messenger.

a) Remember the importance of words

Preaching is more than words (what other aspects of communication are there?).

But preaching is never less than words, and the choice of words is important.

Think carefully about how you will put things as you flesh out the skeleton.

b) Create notes that will help you to preach

What sort of notes should you create to help you to deliver your sermon? People have different answers to this question.

No notes? ⟷ A full manuscript?

Some people say that you do not need any notes at all. People say that notes inhibit you. Others say that you should have a full manuscript.

The answer probably lies somewhere in between and you need to learn what works best for you. In practice the more work you put into this the *less* you will be inhibited.

NOTE: People also think that it is easy to give a short talk. But the shorter the talk is the more time you will need to give to preparing notes for every minute that you speak.

c) Use your voice to communicate

Good use of your voice is not about *volume* but *variety*. Remember to vary and use these four words:

- Pitch (vary the tone of your voice)
- Pace (vary the speed of your delivery)
- Pause (stop speaking for a moment or two to give space for thought)
- Power (vary the intensity and volume)

Trainers need to explain and demonstrate this. Explain that a culture of shouting can hinder real communication and learning.

d) Take care with presentation

Be yourself but think how you will best serve the listeners.

Practice your preaching. Some people think that this is 'unspiritual'. But time given to going over your message and praying over your message will give you more confidence and freedom. Become familiar with your sermon and remember to preach it to yourself first.

e) Do not forget the importance of evaluation

A simple form of evaluation is to use the questions:

Was the sermon TRUE?	Did the **message** come from the Bible? Was it true to the text and to the gospel? Was it God's word?
Was the sermon RELEVANT?	Was there a **purpose**, and were there specific applications for the listeners?
Was the sermon CLEAR?	Was there good explanation and a clear **structure** that was easy to follow? Was the communication good?

Evaluate yourself: Do this first, as you prepare and practice. Are you clear on what you are preaching, why you are preaching it and how you are delivering it? If not, there is a problem.

Get others to evaluate you: Allow others to give constructive criticism at the appropriate moment after the sermon using the questions above. You might want to ask someone in advance to do this. When you are evaluating people always begin with some genuine encouragement. It may be best to only give encouragement straight afterwards and to then offer further constructive criticism later on.

*Use that simple form of evaluation with the participants. It can be very effective to build in evaluation to the devotion time in workshops and meetings. Encourage participants to criticise any daily talks constructively by discussing and feeding back on those three questions above: was the sermon **true**, was it **relevant**, and was it **clear**?*

*And use the 'pointing hand' explanation: a thumb pointing up indicating communication from God through his word, which we need to be **true** to; a finger pointing forward to ask whether it was **relevant** to the listeners; and three fingers pointing back at the speaker himself to raise the issue of whether the communication was **clear**. Remember that in many cultures pointing can be rude, so make a joke of this.*

13.4 CONCLUSION: PULLING IT ALL TOGETHER

13.4.1 Ezekiel 37:1-14 and the breath of God

On the next page there is a table that will help you pull together the findings for 2 Tim 1:6-7 from the work we have done. We will use a similar table throughout the rest of the curriculum.

But to conclude this unit we will look at Ezekiel 37:1-14 and the powerful picture it contains.

- Before you read it together as a group read the following notes:

  Ezekiel is a prophet and is called to preach to Israel. However, the message of Ezekiel 37 is not mainly about the work of a preacher. Ezekiel 37 is a vision of Israel being resurrected and restored by God after the punishment of the Exile.

  But Ezekiel is commanded to preach or prophesy to the bones in this vision, and, in the context of Scripture Sculpture, it is a powerful picture of flesh and skeleton, heart and brain, skin and bones coming together.

  Without the breath of God, the Spirit of God, the bones will remain bones. We need to pray throughout the process of preparing to preach and ask God the Holy Spirit, who inspired the Scriptures, to breathe his new life into our preaching and through it, into the lives of our listeners.

- Now read Ezekiel 37:1-14 with this background in mind.

In the context of the Pastoral Epistles, Paul tells Timothy to guard the gospel "with the help of the Holy Spirit who lives in us" (2 Tim 1:14). God longs to use us to guard the

gospel, not least as we preach and teach, and he gives us the strength of his Holy Spirit to empower us for that task.

- End this unit with prayer for one another in this important area.

13.4.2 Preaching the message of 2 Tim 1:6-7

Use the table below to record the key ideas we have discussed for a sermon or talk:

STEP 4: BRAIN – state the PURPOSE of the sermon My sermon's purpose statement:
STEP 5: HEART – form the MESSAGE of the sermon My sermon's theme and its message statement:
STEP 6: SKELETON – create the STRUCTURE of the sermon My sermon's outline (with the main points, introduction and conclusion):
STEP 7: FLESH – develop the DETAILS of the sermon My sermon's details (note here key words, explanations, illustrations and applications that will help you write notes or a full sermon):

Unit 14. Titus 1:5-9 (Encounter)

Overview

This unit applies the lessons of Unit 4 to Titus 1:5-9. In doing so it provides the learners with the opportunity to look at a passage from elsewhere in the pastorals, both as an appetiser and as an important passage in itself that leads into the final unit of the module.

Outline

- Introduction: Understanding Titus
- Understanding the Pastoral Epistles
- Worksheet for the passage
- Worksheet for Step 1
- Worksheet for Steps 2 to 4
- Preaching Titus 1:5-9

Outcomes

By the end of the unit you will be able to

1. Recall and apply the four steps of Encountering a Bible Passage to a passage from Titus
2. Explain the message of Titus 1:5-9 to a group of pastors today
3. Apply Titus 1:5-9 and evaluate your own life and ministry

It is often important to ask the Participants which of the steps they are struggling with and to focus on those at this point. All the previous passages have been taken from 2 Timothy. This passage is from Titus and means that you need to help the Participants to understand that book so that they can set the passage in context properly.

14.1 INTRODUCTION: UNDERSTANDING TITUS

Titus is the final letter of the Pastoral Epistles. We have dipped into it already, particularly when looking at the gospel and how to share it in Units 6 and 7.

You will remember from Units 2 and 3 that in order to understand a Bible passage we must ‘Keep in mind the original CONTEXT of the Bible book’.

We noted that, ‘Trying to understand a passage of a book without knowing the book itself is like trying to get to know a member of a family without knowing their wider family and where they live.’

Before we look at Titus 1:5-9 we will do an introductory study of it, guided by Unit 3. We have already completed that exercise for 1 and 2 Timothy. We will build on that by thinking through some of the similarities and differences between Titus and 1 Timothy, the book that was written before Titus.

If you have enough time together read Titus through as a whole, it is shorter than the other letters. If you have limited time just look at the verses that are mentioned below, and read through Titus later.

14.1.1 Establish the context of Titus

Read through the book and look for indicators of the context. (Who is addressing whom? Who else is involved? Where is it being written to and from? Why has it been written?)

Note specific verses where you see either a **similarity** to 1 Timothy (things that are nearly the same), or a **difference** to it. Describe those similarities and differences by looking at the two books and moving between them.

- What **similarities** does Titus have to 1 Timothy in terms of the context?

Titus 1:4
It is Paul to Titus with a very similar greeting to 1 Tim 1:1-2. It seems it grew out of 1 Tim as it is different to 2 Tim 1:2 "To Timothy, my dear son". (Compare Titus 1:4, "To Titus, my true son in our common faith" with 1 Tim 1:2, "To Timothy my true son in the faith"). Titus has a similar relationship to Paul and, similarly, is not from Crete. We learn about him in 2 Corinthians and he is mentioned in Galatians 2:1 – he is possibly from Antioch, and an itinerant worker not a local pastor.

Titus 1:5-9
There are similar needs and instructions for faithful church leaders – compare with 1 Tim 3.1ff.

Titus 1:10-11
False teachers are present and must be silenced (see 1 Tim 1:3).

Titus 2:1
There is the same concern that Paul's associate, Titus in this case, teaches the truth (see 1 Tim 4:11).

Titus 3:12
Paul will be in Nicopolis, which is in Macedonia – the same region as in 1 Timothy (1:3)

- What **differences** does Titus have to 1 Timothy in terms of the context?

Titus 1:4
It is Paul to Titus not Timothy. That it obvious but important. Different people, with different backgrounds.

Titus 1:5, 12
Titus is on Crete, a Mediterranean island, not in Ephesus, a Greek city. Different contexts and cultures, and churches at different stages. Leaders are to be appointed in Crete rather than rebuked and corrected as in Ephesus. (Timothy was "to reform an established church, Titus had been left behind to set in order what had not yet been accomplished... the appointing of elders", Gordon Fee). Titus' task seems less urgent and demanding. He is called to warn people clearly (3:10) but there is little emphasis on the struggles of 1 Timothy. The focus is more positively on what it means for the church to be an attractive witness to the gospel (2:10b; 3:1-2, 14).

14.1.2 Discover the content of Titus

As we have looked at the **context** of 2 Timothy we have begun to note the **content**. Build on that now by looking more closely at the content, the themes of the book.

- What **similarities** does Titus have to 1 Timothy in terms of the content?

Titus 1:9; 2:15
Similar themes of teaching the true gospel in the face of false teaching.

Titus 1:5-9
The importance of faithfulness in church leaders together with guidelines for them (compare with 1 Tim 3).

Titus 2:10b; 3:1-2, 8, 14
The need for the church to live out the gospel, as noted above, "… so that in every way they will make the teaching about God our Saviour attractive" (Titus 2:10b).

- What **differences** does Titus have to 1 Timothy in terms of the content?

Titus 1:1-3
There is a longer introduction with a presentation of Paul's apostleship.

Titus 2:11-14 and 3:3-7
There are different presentation of the gospel, with an emphasis on the work of the Holy Spirit.

You will grow in your understanding of Titus as you look at the passage that follows and connect it to the rest of the book. We will turn to that passage in a moment and apply the 4 steps of Encountering a Bible Passage to it.

But before we do, and now that we have looked at the background to all three books, we will look briefly at understanding the Pastoral Epistles as a whole.

14.2 UNDERSTANDING THE PASTORAL EPISTLES

14.2.1 The relationship between the individual Pastoral Epistles

We have now looked at the background of all three Pastoral Epistles: 1 Timothy, 2 Timothy and Titus. This is a good moment to use the similarities and differences between the letters to illustrate the relationship between the books. 1 and 2 Timothy have naturally been grouped together in our Bibles, but it seems that they were written in the order below:

1 Timothy

- From Paul who is in Macedonia (1:3) and free to travel, leaving Timothy in Ephesus.
- False teachers have already emerged from within the church leadership, they have established themselves and have begun to destroy the church.
- Being a true teacher of the gospel means stopping the false teachers and appointing other true teachers: this is the essential task.
- This is urgent and important.
- 1 Tim is probably the first of the three letters to be written.

Titus

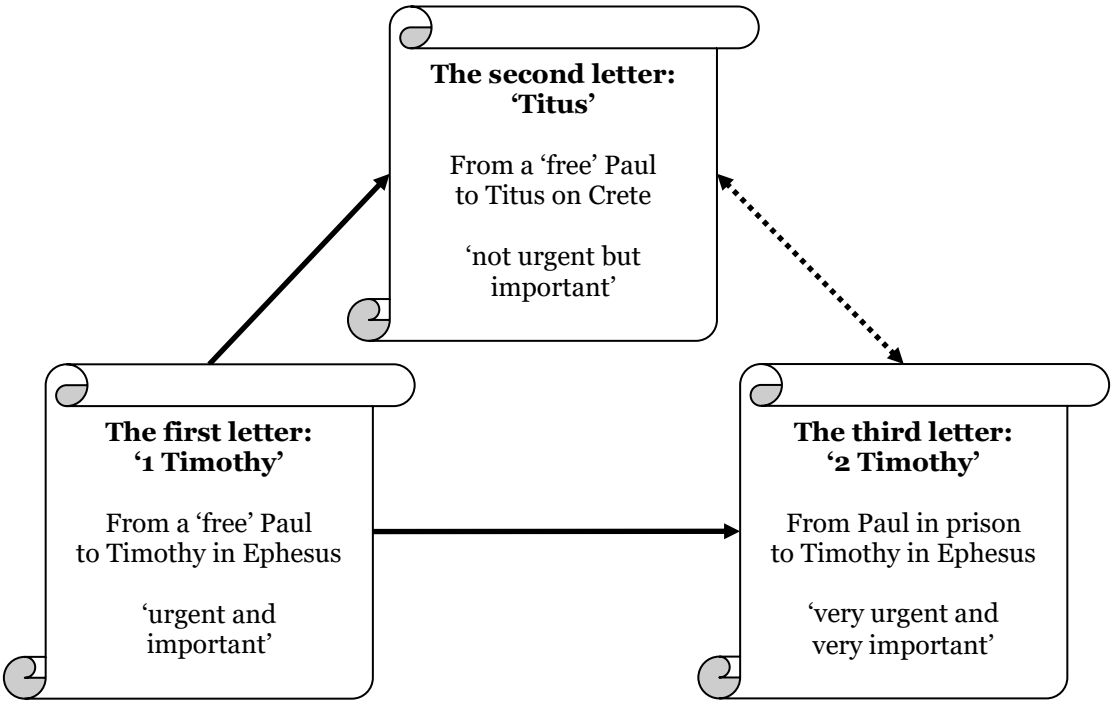
- From Paul who is still in Macedonia ("Nicopolis" on the coast, 3:12) and free to travel, leaving Titus on Crete.
- False teachers are already on the scene but the problems are less severe.
- Being a true teacher of the gospel and appointing other true teachers is still vital in order to protect the churches as they develop.
- This task is important but less urgent.
- Titus is probably the second of the three letters: it seems to be based on 1 Timothy but written for a different setting.

2 Timothy

- From Paul who is imprisoned in Rome and facing death, to Timothy in Ephesus.
- Being a true teacher of the gospel and passing gospel ministry on to other true teachers is now more important than ever. Partly so that Timothy can go to Paul's side, and partly so that true gospel ministry will continue and flourish.
- It is serious, extremely urgent, and highly important.

14.2.2 A way of illustrating the way the relationship between the three letters

The relationship between the three letters can be pictured in the way shown below.



The solid lines show direct connections: There is a direct connection between 1 Timothy and Titus: after writing 1 Timothy Paul may well have turned his attention to the less urgent, but still important, matters on Crete, using some of the same material.

And there is a direct connection between 1 Timothy and 2 Timothy: with Paul's imprisonment and a worsening situation in Ephesus he builds on 1 Timothy in 2 Timothy.

The dashed line shows an indirect link: There is only an indirect connection between 2 Timothy and Titus – they both relate to similar issues, and both arose out of 1 Timothy, but Paul is writing to different people in different places.

14.3 WORKSHEET FOR ENCOUNTERING TITUS 1:5-9 – THE PASSAGE

5 The reason I left you in Crete was that
you might put in order what was left
unfinished and appoint elders in every
town, as I directed you. 6 An elder must be
blameless, faithful to his wife, a man
whose children believe and are not open
to the charge of being wild and
disobedient. 7 Since an overseer manages
God's household, he must be blameless –
not overbearing, not quick-tempered, not
given to drunkenness, not violent, not
pursuing dishonest gain. 8 Rather, he must
be hospitable, one who loves what is good,
who is self-controlled, upright, holy and
disciplined. 9 He must hold firmly to the
trustworthy message as it has been
taught, so that he can encourage others by
sound doctrine and refute those who
oppose it. (NIV)

Choose leaders
– PLURAL

Leaders who are faithful
– PROVEN

Leaders who are not ungodly

Leaders who are godly
– PURE

Leaders who know and tell the gospel
– PROCLAMATION

14.4 WORKSHEET FOR ENCOUNTERING TITUS 1:5-9 – STEP 1

STEP 1: FLESH – study the DETAILS of the text

a) Set the passage in context. How does the passage relate to the book as a whole?

Story: Connections with the **argument** of the book? *Looking back, the 'you' of v. 5 is clearly Titus. The emphasis on the gospel that has been entrusted to Paul continues. It provides the background for the warnings of v. 10 onwards; e.g. "dishonest gain" makes that link.*

Connections with the **themes** of the book? *The passage links with the call for the people of God to live attractive lives for the sake of the gospel (3:14). The leaders are to be exemplary in that regard. And it links with the centrality of the gospel and the need to preserve it against the false teaching that undermines it. More widely it links with 1 Tim 3.*

b) See the details of the text	**c) Seek the meaning from the details**
List important words, phrases and relationships	Explain important words, phrases, and relationships
"Crete"	*A Mediterranean island with its own culture.*
"you might straighten out what was left unfinished" (v. 5)	*Given context of an unfinished task this must be about putting things in place, in order.*
"appoint elders" (v. 5)	*The whole paragraph is about this work*
"elder" (v. 6)	*'presbyteros' – leaders who teach and care*
"blameless" (twice) (vv. 6-7)	*Without fault. Related to holiness and purity*
"husband of but one wife" (v. 6)	*Faithful, true and self-controlled sexually*
"whose children believe" (v. 6)	*Proven in the attractiveness of his faith*
"overseer", "he", "one who" (repeatedly) (vv. 7-9)	*As well as 'elders' he talks of 'overseers' (episkopoi) – a different title for the same job?*
"manages" (v. 7)	*Steward*
"overbearing" (v. 7)	*Begins the list – not stubborn*
"quick-tempered" (v. 7)	*Continues a range of characteristics to avoid*
"hospitable" (v. 8)	*Positively... welcoming, kind, in control*
"hold firmly to the trustworthy message" (v. 9)	*Clear personal grasp and understanding of the message of the gospel*
"those who oppose it" (v. 9)	*Those who teach a false gospel or no gospel*
"The reason I left you" (v. 5)	*Reminder of Titus' task*
"as I directed you" (v. 5)	*Looking back to Paul's directions then*
"not open to the charge" (v. 6)	*Contrast with faithfulness of his children*
"Since" (v. 7)	*Because... a logical link*
"Rather" (v. 8)	*A contrast is being made*
"encourage", "refute" (v. 9)	*Two related sides of the teaching task*

d) Summarise the findings. What are the main points that come out of this initial study?

Paul gave Titus a clear task to do on Crete and has written to remind him of that and help him with it. That important job is to put leadership for the churches in place, which in turn emphasises the importance of sound leadership.

That leadership is to be plural, that is shared. Two different terms seem to be used for the same person, emphasising different roles and responsibilities.

Life and doctrine, character and belief are both important and belong together and Paul gives a clear picture of the character and qualifications of local church leaders.

14.5 WORKSHEET FOR ENCOUNTERING TITUS 1:5-9 – STEPS 2 TO 4

STEP 2: SKELETON – outline the STRUCTURE of the text

a) Note all the bones in the structure. What elements highlight the structure?

The important **links**? *"The reason" flags up an introduction (v. 5). V. 6 then begins the main section. "Since" (v. 7) indicates a development of the verse before. "Rather" begins a positive contrast (v. 8). "He must" begins a concluding section (v. 9), with "so that" as a little bone.*

The important **themes**? *1. The introduction to Titus' task of appointing elders (v. 5); 2. An initial section on the importance of faithfulness in an elder, shown in his relationships; 3. The repetition of "not" (v. 7) indicates a theme of characteristics to avoid; 4. This is then contrasted with characteristics to look for; 5. Finally, a grasp of the gospel and an ability to teach it are emphasised (v. 3-4).*

b) Decide on the 'big bones' and make an outline of the structure. What are the most important parts of the structure? Can you describe the main sections?

The ideas and flags suggest two main sections, the second has four parts:

1. Verse 5 – An introduction to the important task of selecting local church leadership

2. Verses 6-9 – What to keep in mind when selecting local church leadership:

a) The basic importance of faithfulness in relationships (v. 6);

b) There are negative attitudes to watch out for (v. 7);

c) There are important character traits to seek (v. 8);

d) A real understanding and right use of the gospel is essential (v. 9)

STEP 3: HEART – identify the MESSAGE of the text

a) State the theme of the passage. What is the author's main point?

Paul's theme is the important task of selecting sound leaders for local churches

b) Explain the message of the passage. What is the author saying about his theme?

Paul reminds Titus of the important task of selecting sound leaders for the local churches and guides him in it by highlighting the need to look for: faithfulness in relationships; negative attitudes to avoid; certain key character traits; a right understanding and use of the gospel.

STEP 4: BRAIN – first, understand the PURPOSE of the text...

a) State the purpose of the passage. Why is the author making his point?

The clue to the purpose is in v. 10 "For there are...". Churches are being destroyed and sound leadership is the key to saving them, strengthening them and preserving the gospel.

b) Make connections for teaching today. What is the relevance of this for us?

The relevance lies in selecting leadership for churches at a variety of levels; in calling people to accountability; in developing leaders after this pattern; in praying for leaders to grow in godliness. These principles come out: Plurality; Proven; Purity; Proclamation.

14.6 PREACHING TITUS 1:5-9

In order to consider preaching Titus 1:5-9 we will, first, respond to the message at a more personal level, picking up on the discoveries we have already made. We will then use the table on the next page to capture some key ideas for a sermon or talk.

14.6.1 Responding to the message of Titus 1:5-9

Here are three simple exercises to do in response to God's word to us in the passage we have just encountered:

1. Describe how the message you discovered in the passage spoke to you personally: What did you learn or need to be reminded of?

2. Share how the purpose of the passage helped you to apply God's word to your life: What change will this passage make to your thinking and living?

3. State and explain the message you will share with others using your own words: What is the main thing you want people to understand?

14.6.2 Preaching the message of Titus 1:5-9

Use the table below to outline some of the key ideas for a sermon or talk:

STEP 4: BRAIN – State the PURPOSE of the sermon My sermon's purpose statement:
STEP 5: HEART – Form the MESSAGE of the sermon My sermon's theme and its message statement:
STEP 6: SKELETON – Create the STRUCTURE of the sermon My sermon's outline (with the main points, introduction and conclusion):
STEP 7: FLESH – Develop the DETAILS of the sermon My sermon's details (note here key words, explanations, illustrations and applications that will help you write notes or a full sermon):

Unit 15. Leaders of integrity (Action)

Overview

The module closes with a major emphasis of the pastorals and one that is central to the BUILD programme: integrity. And it provides an opportunity to review the module and the Pastoral Epistles from that perspective. Finally, it ends with a commitment to live out the truth of the gospel in ways that will build up other leaders and the churches.

Outline

- The meaning and importance of integrity
- Lessons on integrity in Module One
- Conclusion: Being leaders of integrity

Outcomes

By the end of the unit you will be able to

1. Define the meaning of the word integrity
2. Illustrate the meaning and importance of integrity from Module One
3. Repent of hypocrisy and commit to being a leader of integrity

15.1 INTRODUCTION: THE GOSPEL AND GODLINESS

"Preaching the Gospel and Godly Leadership" is this module's subtitle. From beginning to end the Pastoral Epistles are about the gospel and godliness. The gospel and godliness belong together: leaders must know and teach the true gospel and, strengthened by it, must live lives that illustrate the good news. The module's anchor verse makes that point:

> "Do your best to present yourself to God as one approved, a worker who does not need to be ashamed and who correctly handles the word of truth." (2 Tim 2:15)

- Memorise that verse if you have not done so already.

- In what ways does the verse emphasise both what we <u>believe</u> and how we <u>behave</u> (the gospel and godliness)?

'Godliness' is just one of the words in the Pastoral Epistles that describes character that is based on the gospel.

- What other words in the Pastoral Epistles can you think of that describe what we must be like as leaders? Make a list of these words.

- How do we measure up to this list and how do other leaders around us measure up?

15.2 THE MEANING AND IMPORTANCE OF INTEGRITY

'Integrity' might have been one of the words in your list. In the situations we face locally in leadership it is one of the most important ones. It is found in Titus 2:7-8, which is given below. We will explore the meaning and importance of integrity, based on that passage.

> "In everything set them an example by doing what is good. In your teaching show **integrity**, seriousness and soundness of speech that cannot be condemned, so that those who oppose you may be ashamed because they have nothing bad to say about us." Titus 2:7-8

Remember, we have learnt that we can discover the meaning of a word by looking at the context it is used in. We will therefore ask and answer this question:

- What light does the context of Titus 2:7-8 shed on the meaning of the word integrity?

We will answer that question by working outwards from the smallest unit to the largest: from the phrase the word is set in, to the sentence it is set in, to the paragraph that provides its context, to the section of teaching that gives a wider context, to the argument of the book so far.

1. What do we learn from the phrase the word 'integrity' is set in?

> "In your teaching show **integrity**, seriousness and soundness of speech..."

- What do you learn from this phrase?
  There is a connection between integrity and 'soundness' and 'seriousness'. 'Seriousness' means something is important, and 'soundness' means it is strong and well thought through. Integrity is about important things working well and making sense.

2. What do we learn from the sentence the word 'integrity' is set in?

> "In your teaching show **integrity**, seriousness and soundness of speech that cannot be condemned, so that those who oppose you may be ashamed because they have nothing bad to say about us."

- What do you learn from this sentence?
  If something has integrity it stands up to close scrutiny – there is nothing hidden and suspect, and there is nothing bad to say.

3. What do we learn from the paragraph the word 'integrity' is set in?

> "In everything set them an example by doing what is good. In your teaching show **integrity**, seriousness and soundness of speech that cannot be condemned, so that those who oppose you may be ashamed because they have nothing bad to say about us."

- What do you learn from this paragraph, including its first sentence?
  Integrity is about a life that is exemplary – it is a picture of the goodness of God.

4. What do we learn from the section of teaching the word 'integrity' is set in?

Look at Titus 2:1-10.

- What do we learn about integrity from that section of teaching?
  Integrity is about sound doctrine and life, working and connecting together. It is <u>not</u> about any form of immorality or dishonesty. It is all for a purpose: so that the Word of God will not be maligned (v. 5), so that no one will have anything bad to say about those who teach the gospel (v. 8) and ultimately so that the gospel will be "attractive" (v. 10).

5. What do we learn about integrity from the argument of the book so far?

Look at Titus 1:1-16, the passage that leads up to the one we have been studying.

- What do you learn from the argument of the book so far?
  We looked at this in the last unit – we can see that integrity is about the life of the home and the hands and the heart and the head all fitting together consistently. Leaders of integrity show integrity, in contrast to the false teachers who demonstrate hypocrisy (they say one thing and do another), and who do not stand up to close scrutiny.

- Sum up what you have learnt so far. What is integrity and why does it matter?

Integrity is all about life and doctrine fitting together (1 Timothy 4:16).

Integrity is about soundness and completeness.

Integrity matters because it demonstrates the gospel: forgiveness and justice and grace and mercy.

Integrity is therefore not about being perfect, but is about trusting Christ and growing in holiness.

15.3 LESSONS ON INTEGRITY IN MODULE ONE

Because the gospel and godliness are central to the Pastoral Epistles it is no surprise that the idea of integrity has come up repeatedly. Take a look back through the module with these questions in mind:

- Where do these ideas of integrity come earlier in the module?
- How do earlier units reinforce what we have already learnt?
- What new aspects of integrity do you notice?

Use the blank spaces below the list of units below to make notes:

Unit 1. Introducing BUILD

BUILD is all about leaders and lives and churches that are sound and exemplary.

Unit 2. How to hear God's voice today

Sound and healthy teaching comes from hearing God's voice.

Unit 3. Understanding 1 and 2 Timothy (Tools)

A main emphasis of 1 Timothy is the link between gospel ministry and gospel living: an integrity of life and doctrine (1 Tim 4:16).

Unit 4. How to encounter a passage of the Bible

The Bible is to be understood in the context of life – the context of the life of the local church – it is not abstract theory. It is also done under God's gaze.

Unit 5. Encountering 2 Timothy 1:8-12

Integrity is about continuing with gospel ministry even when the going gets tough.

Unit 6. What is the gospel?

The gospel itself is rooted in God's integrity: his commitment to his love, his mercy and his justice. In dealing with sin, rather than ignoring it, his own personal integrity is demonstrated.

Unit 7. Sharing the gospel

Evangelism involves not just the message but the messengers who demonstrate the gospel.

Unit 8. Encountering 2 Timothy 2:1-7

Gospel ministry is about being solid and faithful in Christ and training others who are faithful and reliable.

Unit 9. Gospel centred ministry

Understanding and practice must run together if we are to be effective in building God's church on the foundation of the gospel.

Unit 10. Encountering 2 Timothy 3:14-17

Scripture itself has integrity – it fits together, it is complete, it is everything we need for right thinking and right living.

Unit 11. The Bible and biblical ministry

Biblical ministry flows out of that and is all about leaders of integrity training other leaders of integrity to build a church with integrity. We saw, supremely, that public life and private life must match up consistently. It is important to know what a leader's wife think of him, rather than just what the church thinks of him. That includes in the area of personal prayer and study of God's word.

Unit 12. Encountering 2 Timothy 4:1-5

This passage underlines the fact that leadership is about working and thinking and praying in the light of God's presence and future kingdom. This perspective builds integrity.

Unit 13. How to preach a passage of the Bible

One thing we noted was the importance of non-verbal communication, which can either support a message or undermine it.

Unit 14. Encountering Titus 1:5-9

Finally we saw that in Titus integrity is all about consistency and soundness of life: blamelessness. The life of the leader's home, heart, hands and head all being sound and exemplary.

15.4 CONCLUSION: BEING LEADERS OF INTEGRITY

Give time individually or in a group to committing yourselves to lives of integrity for the sake of God and the gospel. This will involve both repentance – turning away from hypocrisy and habits that undermine our integrity, and faith – trusting in God's strength and the power of his Spirit to live lives that will point to Christ and his kingdom. You might like to read some of these verses as your make this commitment:

"As for you, if you walk before me in **integrity** of heart and uprightness, as David your father did, and do all I command and observe my decrees and laws ..." (1 Kings 9:4)

"… you test the heart and are pleased with **integrity**." (1 Chronicles 29:17)

"I put in charge of Jerusalem my brother Hanani... because he was a man of **integrity** and feared God more than most men do." (Nehemiah 7:2)

“[Job] is blameless and upright, a man who fears God and shuns evil. And he still maintains his **integrity** ...” (Job 2:3)

“Relent, do not be unjust; reconsider, for my **integrity** is at stake.” (Job 6:29)

“Judge me, O LORD, according to my righteousness, according to my **integrity**, O Most High.” (Psalm 7:8)

“May **integrity** and uprightness protect me, because my hope is in you.” (Psalm 25:21)

“In my **integrity** you uphold me and set me in your presence forever.” (Psalm 41:12)

“And David shepherded them with **integrity** of heart; with skilful hands he led them.” (Psalm 78:72)

“The man of **integrity** walks securely, but he who takes crooked paths will be found out.” (Proverbs 10:9)

“The **integrity** of the upright guides them, but the unfaithful are destroyed by their duplicity.” (Proverbs 11:3)

“No one calls for justice; no one pleads his case with **integrity**. They rely on empty arguments and speak lies; they conceive trouble and give birth to evil.” (Isaiah 59:4)

“They came to him and said, "Teacher, we know you are a man of **integrity**. You aren't swayed by men, because you pay no attention to who they are; but you teach the way of God in accordance with the truth. Is it right to pay taxes to Caesar or not?” (Mark 12:14)

“In everything set them an example by doing what is good. In your teaching show **integrity**, seriousness ...” (Titus 2:7)

Review questions for Module One

- Look back through the titles of the units in the module. Which units had the greatest impact on you and why is that the case?

- Think back to your time in and use of the module. In what ways has your leadership been challenged and changed as a result of the module?

- In a similar way, reflect on the ways in which your church has been influenced by any teaching from the module, which you have passed on in some way.

Contents of upcoming modules

Module Two **Genesis & the Pentateuch:**
Knowing God's Story & Leading by Faith

Unit 1. The Pentateuch and the Bible's story (Tools)
Unit 2. Genesis 12:1-9 and God's salvation plan (Tools)
Unit 3. Understanding Bible stories (Tools)
Unit 4. Genesis 1:1-2:3 (Encounter)
Unit 5. God's world and our worldviews (Reflection)
Unit 6. Stewardship and sustainability (Action)
Unit 7. Genesis 11:1-9 (Encounter)
Unit 8. Sin and evil (Reflection)
Unit 9. Genesis 15 (Encounter)
Unit 10. God's covenants and our covenants (Reflection)
Unit 11. Exodus 3:1-12 (Encounter)
Unit 12. Jesus and the Old Testament (Reflection)
Unit 13. Encountering the Law (Tools)
Unit 14. Deuteronomy 5:6-21 (Encounter)
Unit 15. Leading by faith (Action)

Module Three **Mark & the Gospels:**
The Servant King & Servant Leadership

Unit 1. Introducing Mark and the gospels (Tools)
Unit 2. Mark 2:1-12 (Encounter)
Unit 3. Understanding the kingdom of God (Reflection)
Unit 4. How to encounter parables (Tools)
Unit 5. Mark 4:26-33 (Encounter)
Unit 6. Proclaiming the kingdom of God (Action)
Unit 7. Matthew 5:1-12 (Encounter)
Unit 8. Poverty and prosperity (Reflection)
Unit 9. Matthew 6:5-15 (Encounter)
Unit 10. Praying for the kingdom of God (Action)
Unit 11. Mark 8:31-9:1 (Encounter)
Unit 12. The servant king and servant leadership (Reflection)
Unit 13. Mark 12:1-12 (Encounter)
Unit 14. The cross and the Lord's Supper (Reflection)
Unit 15. Making disciples (Action)

Module Four **Nehemiah & the Historical Books:**
Building God's People & Strategic Leadership

Unit 1. Building the Bible's story (Tools)
Unit 2. Encountering Ruth (Tools)
Unit 3. Nehemiah 1 (Encounter)
Unit 4. Intercession (Action)
Unit 5. Nehemiah 2:11-20 (Encounter)
Unit 6. Mobilising God's people (Action)
Unit 7. Nehemiah 4 (Encounter)
Unit 8. Facing opposition (Action)
Unit 9. Nehemiah 5 (Encounter)
Unit 10. Poverty alleviation (Action)
Unit 11. Nehemiah 8:1-12 (Encounter)
Unit 12. Expository preaching (Action)
Unit 13. Leading small groups (Action)
Unit 14. Building God's people (Reflection)
Unit 15. Strategic leadership (Action)

Module Five **Acts & the New Testament Story:**
The Mission of the Church & Missional Leadership

Unit 1. Encountering Acts and the NT Story (Tools)
Unit 2. Encountering Acts 2:1-13 (Encounter)
Unit 3. God's mission and our mission (Reflection)
Unit 4. Encountering Acts 2:42-47 (Encounter)
Unit 5. Mission shaped church (Action)
Unit 6. Encountering Acts 8:9-25 (Encounter)
Unit 7. The Holy Spirit and baptism (Reflection)
Unit 8. Deliverance and healing (Action)
Unit 9. Encountering Acts 15:36-41 (Encounter)
Unit 10. Handling conflict (Action)
Unit 11. Christian mission and local culture (Reflection)
Unit 12. Encountering Acts 17:16-34 (Encounter)
Unit 13. Christ's Lordship and other religions (Reflection)
Unit 14. Evangelistic speaking (Action)
Unit 15. Missional leadership (Action)

Module Six **Psalms & Poetry:**
Worshipping the King & Wholehearted Leadership

Unit 1. Encountering the Psalms and Poetry (Tools)
Unit 2. Psalm 23 (Encounter)
Unit 3. Guidance: How God leads his people (Reflection)
Unit 4. Psalm 51 (Encounter)
Unit 5. Wholehearted leadership (Reflection)
Unit 6. Kingship and Christ in the Psalms (Tools)
Unit 7. Psalm 73 (Encounter)
Unit 8. Reflection & action, learning & teaching (Tools)
Unit 9. Songs of suffering (Reflection)
Unit 10. Dying & death, burial & bereavement (Action)
Unit 11. Psalm 95 (Encounter)
Unit 12. Worshipping the King (Action)
Unit 13. Psalm 127 (Encounter)
Unit 14. The pastor's family and God's family (Action)
Unit 15. Learning from your church's story (Reflection)

Module Seven **Ephesians & the Epistles:**
God's Plan for the Church & Local Church Leadership

Unit 1. Understanding Ephesians and the Epistles (Tools)
Unit 2. Ephesians 1:3-10 (Encounter)
Unit 3. Confidence in Christ (Reflection)
Unit 4. Ephesians 3:7-13 (Encounter)
Unit 5. God's plan for the church (Reflection)
Unit 6. Ephesians 4:11-16 (Encounter)
Unit 7. Transforming church leadership (Action)
Unit 8. Ephesians 4:29-32 (Encounter)
Unit 9. Building a new community (Action)
Unit 10. Ephesians 5:25-33 (Encounter)
Unit 11. Building Bible interpretation skills (Tools)
Unit 12. Gender, marriage and ministry (Reflection)
Unit 13. Understanding the Trinity (Reflection)
Unit 14. Ephesians 6:10-17 (Encounter)
Unit 15. Spiritual warfare (Action)

Module Eight **Proverbs & Wisdom:**
The Fear of the Lord & Practical Leadership

Unit 1. Introducing wisdom (Tools)
Unit 2. Encountering Proverbs (Tools)
Unit 3. Proverbs 3:1-12 (Encounter)
Unit 4. Wisdom for leadership I (Reflection)
Unit 5. Proverbs 5:15-23 (Encounter)
Unit 6. The Song, sex and sexuality (Reflection)
Unit 7. Issues facing the church: HIV and AIDS (Action)
Unit 8. Proverbs 11:23-27 and 13:7-11 (Encounter)
Unit 9. Wisdom with funds (Action)
Unit 10. Proverbs 20:5-12 (Encounter)
Unit 11. Wise counsel (Action)
Unit 12. Proverbs 27:11-22 (Encounter)
Unit 13. Working with children and young people (Action)
Unit 14. Ecclesiastes 3:1-8 (Encounter)
Unit 15. Wisdom for Leadership II (Action)

Module Nine **Isaiah & the Prophets:**
The Sovereign King & Prophetic Leadership

Unit 1. Encountering the Prophets (Tools)
Unit 2. Introducing Isaiah (Tools)
Unit 3. Isaiah 6 (Encounter)
Unit 4. Preaching the Prophets (Action)
Unit 5. Isaiah 12 (Encounter)
Unit 6. Prophecy today (Reflection)
Unit 7. Isaiah 40:1-11 (Encounter)
Unit 8. “Here is your God!” (Reflection)
Unit 9. Isaiah 53:1-6 (Encounter)
Unit 10. Isaiah, Christ and the New Testament (Reflection)
Unit 11. Isaiah 58:6-9 (Encounter)
Unit 12. Advocacy and the local church (Action)
Unit 13. Isaiah 61:1-4 (Encounter)
Unit 14. A great commission (Reflection)
Unit 15. Prophetic leadership (Action)

Module Ten **Revelation & Apocalyptic:**
The Victorious Christ & Leaders that Endure

Unit 1. Introducing Revelation (Tools)
Unit 2. Exploring Revelation and Apocalyptic (Tools)
Unit 3. Revelation 1:12-18 (Encounter)
Unit 4. A leader’s vision of Christ (Reflection)
Unit 5. Revelation 2:1-7 (Encounter)
Unit 6. A leader’s vision of the church (Reflection)
Unit 7. Revelation 5:1-10 (Encounter)
Unit 8. Revelation 6:1-8 (Encounter)
Unit 9. A leader’s vision of history (Reflection)
Unit 10. Persecution and martyrdom (Action)
Unit 11. Revelation 19:11-21 (Encounter)
Unit 12. A leader’s vision of judgment (Reflection)
Unit 13. Revelation 21:1-8 (Encounter)
Unit 14. A leader’s vision of heaven (Reflection)
Unit 15. Leaders that endure (Action)